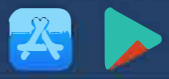
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Learners' Handbook of Tajweed

INTERMEDIATE

with exercises

A self-study reference and guide book to learn tajweed with & without a teacher

SECOND EDITION

Drs. Islam Fekry

Arabic 101

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Learners' Handbook of Tajweed

INTERMEDIATE

SECOND EDITION

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Contents

Acknowledgments	v
To the student	vi
Understand the book layout	ix
To the teacher	xii
1 Basic concepts	1
2 Qur'ānic Symbols	9
3 Stopping & Resuming	31
4 Madd I	43
5 Madd II	51
6 Hamzah	65
7 Lām Sākinah	75
8 Nūn Sākinah	87
9 Mīm Sākinah	103
10 Qalqalah	113
11 Assimilation	123
12 Heavy & Light Letters	135
13 Iltiqā' As-Sākinain	147
14 Disjointed Letters	155
15 Important Comparisons	163
16 Special Cases	169
Answer Key	175
Index	179
Bibliography	181

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Alḥamdulillāh - All praise is due to Allāh.
وَمَا تَوْفِيقِيٓ إِلَّا بِٱللَّهِۚ عَلَيْهِ تَوَكَّلْتُ وَإِلَيْهِ أُنِيبُ

To my wife, who helped me every step of the way.
To my family, my main supporter.
To my students, who have always supported me,
and helped me keep going.

Jazākum Allāhu khairan.
May Allāh accept my humble work, and make it
purely for His sake. Āmīn.

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To the student

In the name of Allāh, the Most Merciful, the Most Gracious.

I praise Allāh (SWT) the Most High, Most Knowledgeable and send blessings upon the best of creation prophet Muhammad ﷺ.

This book is for Muslims who need help with learning tajweed & the Qur'ān, following the riwāyah of Hafs 'an 'āsim. It is written for you to use without a teacher.

This handbook does NOT claim to replace your Qur'ān teacher, because there is nothing that possibly can. However, this handbook is the first attempt at offering an interactive learning method to learn the tajweed of the Qur'ān for those who cannot find a Qur'ān teacher, and without having to learn tajweed completely on their own. Using this book under the supervision of a teacher is the best option.

The book will be useful for you if you are not sure of the answers to questions like these:

- **What is tajweed? Is it mandatory?**
- **How can you perform a proper stop/ resume in the Qur'ān?**
- **What is Madd? What are the types of Madd? How long should you extend them?**
- **What is Idghām? Iqlāb? Ikh'fā'? What are their rules?**
- **How can I deal with letters with no diacritics?**

Level

The book is intended mainly for intermediate students (who have already completed **steps 1-3** of their Qur'ān Quest (see chart below). It concentrates on the tajweed rules following the **Riwāyah of Hafs 'an 'āsim**, and how students can apply and use them properly. Some advanced students might find this book useful too, though this book is not intended for advanced students who have a good grasp of the tajweed of the Qur'ān.

The book is *not* suitable for elementary learners who do not know how to read Arabic (literacy), and do not know how to pronounce the special Arabic sounds (makharij).

Please check the chart below to understand how each step of your Qur'ān Quest is built on the foundations of the previous one.



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It is, therefore, absolutely imperative that before you start learning a certain step, that you have grasped the step(s) under it.

This handbook represents **step 3** which means that you should be familiar with the special Arabic sounds, and how to pronounce them, this is also known by makhārij al-hurūf مَخَارِج الحُرُوف. And this should also mean that you have good knowledge of the Arabic alphabet system, as well as its vowel system, long and short. If that is not the case, or you want to be sure of your knowledge before embarking on this journey, please consider doing a quick revision on the basics of Arabic literacy and pronunciation before getting started. We also offer many free courses that can greatly help you through your journey in shā' Allāh. Visit https://arabic101.org/

What is different about this book?

- This handbook does not *only* offer an array of rules, explain what they mean and then give some examples (this has been made many many times before, and you have probably seen that already) but what is different about this book is that it offers a LEARNING METHOD through which you can learn tajweed on your own. This learning method is called the "layer method" which will be discussed further under **'How to use this book.'**
- This handbook comes with a **companion app**, which provides the interactive features of this learning method, and using it is very crucial to make the best out of this book, and learn properly.
- Along with this book, there is also a video course that you can follow along with the book to enhance your understanding of a certain topic, and to get to study more examples.
- This book also contains a set of exercises at the end of each chapter, which ensures that you have understood the chapter, and are able to apply the learned information on your recitation.
- At the end of each chapter, there is an info-graphic poster which highlights the most important points mentioned in that chapter, this is a very handy tool to use when applying a certain set of rules that you are trying to learn without having to go through the entire chapter again.

How to use the book

The chapters of the book are in a logical order; they are built on top of one another since they depend on one another. This means that the concepts or terms used in a certain chapter, will have been explained in an earlier chapter so that you don't get lost due to unfamiliar terms of key words. Therefore, it is not intended that you pick and choose which chapters to start with.

The book enables you to follow the "layer method". This means that each tajweed skill represents a 'layer', which you have to fully understand, practice and master, before you can move on to the next 'layer' (skill). In other words, you will not read through/ study the entire book or several chapters at once, and then try and apply everything you have learned simultaneously. Instead, when you have finished a chapter and are able to automatically apply and use the necessarily skills (and only then) you will be able to move on to the next layer (skill) and continue learning. That is why, at the end of each chapter, you will see that there is a set of exercises that can help you test your ability at following and applying the studied rules. If it turned out that a certain set of rules is not yet automatized, then you should go back and revise them before proceeding.

Here is an example road-map to show you how you can apply this method using this handbook:

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Getting started

Start following the chapters according to their order in the book, do not skip chapters, even if you think you know it.

01 Chapter One

Study the Rules

Get to know what the rules of the topic are, understand them, and make your own notes as you go. Note down the new information that you think is important to you.

01a Theory

Test Yourself

At the end of each chapter, there is a set of exercises. Take them seriously, and answer them fully to the best of your ability. It is better that there is not a long time gap between studying the chapter and taking the exercises.

01b Exercises

01c Practice

Recite

Use the newly learned skill to start reciting. (1) Open the relevant info-graphic page, and keep it open. (2) Open your Muṣ-ḥaf, and start reciting while applying the skill that you have just learned. If needed, use the info-graphic to make sure you are on the right track.

The longer this process takes, the better, and the more automatic your tajweed will become.

Take a break!

Do not learn two topics on the same day, or too close to each other. Give yourself the time to process and practice what you have learned

02 Chapter Two

Repeat

Start again with the same steps at chapter two.

02a Theory

Remember

When practicing for chapter two, you should always apply the skills you learned from chapter one. And when doing chapter 3, apply what you learned from chapter one & two, and so on...

02b Exercises

02c Practice

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Understand the book layout



This book is divided into 16 Chapters. At the beginning of each chapter, you see the main topic discussed in that chapter, along with the main objectives that you will have achieved by the end of this chapter. It is important to go through these objectives before getting started. It is also a quick way to take a peak at the main points of discussion in that chapter in case you are looking to learn/ revise a specific skill. It is also good practice to look back at these objectives after finishing the chapter to check if you achieved these goals.



Each page of this book is divided into explanation section, which takes up 3/4 of the page, and on its left, you see page notes, which takes up 1/4 of the page. This page notes section is used to give enriching information about certain points being discussed on the right, and also provide some questions that help you understand the topic even better. This section is also used to give some warnings and points that need more attention, and you will also see the codes of the recordings that you will use to listen to the provided fragments.



The majority of chapters end with a discussion page. This page is meant to be used for exercise to apply the tajweed rules that you have learned through this particular chapter. It is important to read the instructions and follow them through. At the end of this book, you will find an addendum for the answers of these exercises.

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At the end of each chapter, you will see an info-graphic poster that summarizes the chapter at hand in one single slide. This info-graphic poster is particularly useful. Pay attention: these info-graphics may not contain some smaller details that were explained in detail in the chapter. Use these info-graphics as a *reminder* to the rules you learned, but *not* at a source of information.

Āyāt or words from the Qur'ān will be given using the Uthmāni typeface:

ٱلْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ ٱلْعَٰلَمِينَ ۝٢

Other words that were not mentioned in the Qur'ān will be given in a generic typeface:

التِقَاءُ السَّاكِنَين

Icons used throughout the book and their meanings

*	A point of interest - pay attention
TIP	Advice on how to deal with a certain rule/ situation - explains a technique that can help the learner.
DID YOU KNOW ?	An extra piece of information that can be skipped, but is interesting to know.
! Remember	Reminding you of a certain rule or technique that was used once before in this book, or is an established fact that is related to the point at hand.
! CAUTION	A common problem that can potentially lead to a (clear) mistake if not being cautious. Therefore, be extra alert to avoid the common mistake.
WARNING HARAM Wrong Recitation	Making this mistake *deliberately* is not permissible (Harām) and must not be made.
EXCEPTION	An exception for the latest mentioned rule.
1201	Audio recording - Download *'Learners' Handbook of Tajweed'* app, then enter the code into the search bar to listen to the fragment and compare to your own recitation.

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This book contains many Arabic words that are transliterated. All the words that are transliterated follow this table in turning Arabic letters into English letters. There is a separate table for consonants, short vowels, and long vowels.

Consonants:

ء	’	د	d	ض	ḍ	ك	k
ب	b	ذ	dh	ط	ṭ	ل	l
ت	t	ر	r	ظ	ẓ	م	m
ث	th	ز	z	ع	‘	ن	n
ج	j	س	s	غ	gh	هـ	h
ح	ḥ	ش	sh	ف	f	و	w
خ	kh	ص	ṣ	ق	q	ى	y

Short Vowels:

ـَ	a	ـِ	i	ـُ	u

Long Vowels:

ا َ	ā	ى ِ	ī	و ُ	ū

Diphthongs:

و َ	aw	ى َ	ay

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To the teacher

Learners' Handbook of Tajweed (Intermediate) was written as a self-study handbook, but teachers may also find it useful as course material where in-depth tajweed, and Qur'ān chapters are given.

This handbook does NOT claim to replace your role as a Qur'ān teacher, because your role as a Qur'ān teacher is irreplaceable. However, this handbook offers an interactive learning method to those who have no access to a Qur'ān teacher, which is the next best thing in such situations. This means that supervising students using this book is always a better option.

This book is the second book in a three-book series that covers the tajweed of the Qur'ān from beginner to advanced. Depending on the level of student, each book has an area of focus that determines which rules are discussed, fused and what the scope of each book is. **This table highlights the differences between them:**

Beginner	Intermediate (This book)	Advanced
Major focus on literacy aspects and how to read Uthmāni script properly	Focusing on the common mistakes and exceptions of Uthmāni script & symbols	No Focus on literacy or how to read or decipher words & symbols
Major focus on Qur'ānic symbols, how the letters look like in the Muṣ-ḥaf, and less focus on the rules.	Balance between 'rasm' and the discussion of the rules of tajweed to simplify the rules.	Major focus on the theoretical aspects of tajweed, application of rules and their exceptions.
Fusing rules and concepts to introduce the idea to the beginner learner. e.g. Madd will be divided into Natural and Secondary Madd only.	Fusing some rules to simplify the more complex concepts without compromising the end result. e.g. The types of Madd Lāzim will be explained as one type of Madd.	Discussing all the rules of tajweed fully without any simplification. e.g. all nine types of Madd and sub-categories will be fully explained.
Chapters are ordered in a way that minimizes the chance of a learner making a 'clear mistake'	Chapters are ordered in a way that minimizes the chance of a learner making a 'clear mistake'	Classical order to the chapters according to al-Jazariyyah poem.

This book will probably be most useful at the beginner and intermediate levels (where all or nearly all of the material will be relevant), and can serve both as an introductory course to the basics of Tajweed and as a basis for revision and practicing the rules of tajweed. It will also be useful for some more advanced students who have problems with some basic theoretical aspects of tajweed and need a book for reference or refreshing their knowledge. Learners who can benefit from this book, are those who already have the ability to read Arabic using tashkīl, and have a good grasp of the pronunciation of special Arabic sounds like خ غ ض ر ص ظ ...etc.

The book is divided into chapters which are ordered according to their relevance and their dependency on one another. This order also minimizes the chances of a beginner making a clear mistake. Therefore, the book should be worked through from beginning to end in the given order. However, you can selectively and flexibly use it in accordance with the course syllabus being used and the difficulties students are having. Please contact me, if you have found a more logical, better order to this book.

The book can also be used for immediate consolidation or remedial work thanks to its themed one-topic chapters. For this purpose, using the topics/ chapters selectively can be very useful.

The best addition a teacher can have to this handbook is providing more examples to the ones given within the chapters of this book, and also demonstrating the pronunciation of the examples. The exercises at the end of each chapter can be done individually, in class or as homework. Importantly, listening to learners' recitation and providing feedback is key to enhancing the skills of the students. Alternatively (and additionally), individual learners can be directed to study a certain chapter of the book by themselves if they have particular difficulties not shared by other students in their class, and then practicing with the rest of the class.

Don't forget to utilize the info-graphics at the end of each chapter to help your students remember the most important aspects of each tajweed rule (see **To the student.**)

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In the name of Allāh, the Entirely Merciful, the Especially Merciful.

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Learners' Handbook of Tajweed

INTERMEDIATE

Arabic 101



A rare ancient Muṣ-ḥaf dating back 13th century

1

Basic Concepts

In this chapter you will learn:

- What is Tajweed?
- Types of errors/Laḥn - لَحن
- Qur'ān vs. Muṣ-ḥaf
- Sūrah - Āyah - verse
- What is Uthmāni script?
- When is Qur'ān recitation accepted?

Before you start learning how to recite the Qur'ān properly, there is a number of basic concepts that you have to learn. These concepts will help you start your learning process with a clear mind, and they also lay some important foundations to your understanding of the tajweed of the Qur'ān.

1. Tajweed

Tajweed (تَجوِيد) is an Arabic word, which literally means: *to beautify, embellish or perfect*. And in terms of Qur'ān recitation, it is not that far off. Tajweed is **the study of the rules which govern the way you recite the the Qur'ān and enable you to pronounce its words correctly.** So in essence, reciting the Qur'ān with tajweed means perfecting your Qur'ān recitation and making it as close to the way Prophet Muhammad ﷺ recited the Qur'ān as possible.



There is an important distinction to be made between *studying* tajweed rules, and *applying* its rules:

Studying tajweed	Applying tajweed
Studying tajweed, its rules, definitions and the in-depth understanding of how they work is (farḍ kifāyah) فَرض كِفَايَة which means that it is **NOT** mandatory for every single Muslim to know the rules of tajweed by name, and be able to tell what the definition is for each of them. It would suffice that a number of Muslims are able to do that so as to teach other Muslims how to recite the Qur'ān properly.	Applying tajweed, however, is (farḍ 'ain) فَرض عَين which means that it is **mandatory** for every single Muslim to learn how to recite the Qur'ān properly **(to the best of their abilities)** as it was revealed to the Prophet ﷺ. This means that if you cannot recite the Qur'ān, you have to do your best to learn how to recite the word of Allāh as it is meant to be.

This means that if someone is able to recite the Qur'ān with perfect tajweed, but is unable to tell the definition of what Idghām إِدغَام is or what the technicalities are of pronouncing ج, for example, then that would be perfectly acceptable.



It is always a good idea to know a thing or two about the names of rules and their definitions if you are able to. You may pass it down to other people and help them learn new things about the Qur'ān.

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2. Laḥn

The word (laḥn) لَحن means an error/ mistake in Qur'ān recitation. And there are two types of laḥn لَحن which you should avoid making:

1 Laḥn Jali

The phrase Laḥn jali (لَحن جَلِيّ) literally means a **clear mistake**, and in terms of tajweed it refers to any mistake that results in changing the meaning of an āyah.

Notice how the meaning of this āyah changes when making a small but clear mistake - Laḥn jali (لَحن جَلِيّ):

101

صِرَٰطَ ٱلَّذِينَ أَنۡعَمۡتَ عَلَيۡهِمۡ

..the path of those whom You have blessed.

صِرَٰطَ ٱلَّذِينَ أَنۡعَمۡتُ عَلَيۡهِمۡ

..the path of those whom I have blessed

WARNING HARAM Wrong Recitation

CAUTION

Reciting the Qur'ān like the second example is not only wrong, but it is also not allowed. Making such mistakes is in fact **Harām** since it changes the meaning of the āyah completely. This is the case if one does not exert enough effort to learn how to read the Qur'ān properly and seek the right help. However, if someone tried to the best of their abilities, but they still made mistakes, then it is not a problem in shā' Allāh and cannot be considered a sin.

How can you avoid making clear mistakes in the Qur'ān?

Clear mistakes (لَحن جَلِيّ) in the Qur'ān are mostly caused by mispronouncing or changing the tashkīl on words (like the example mentioned above), or mixing between long and short vowels. Mispronouncing consonants can also lead to changing the meaning of a word. Therefore, the first and most essential step in learning tajweed is knowing how to pronounce consonants and vowels before starting to learn the other beautifying rules of tajweed.

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2 Laḥn Khafi

The term 'Laḥn khafi' (لَحن خَفِي) means a **hidden/ subtle mistake**, and in terms of tajweed it refers to the type of mistakes which do not affect or change the meaning of the āyah. However, it makes the recitation less beautiful, and less perfect:

102

وَلَقَدْ زَيَّنَّا ٱلسَّمَآءَ ٱلدُّنْيَا بِمَصَٰبِيحَ [1]

And We have certainly beautified the nearest heaven with stars

In this āyah, the word ٱلسَّمَآءَ should be extended for 5 counts. If you extend the Madd in that word for 2 counts only, for example, it would be a hidden mistake (لَحن خَفِي), because the meaning of the āyah is still intact.

Unlike clear mistakes, making subtle mistakes is NOT Harām. However, it is still better to avoid them at all times since they make your recitation less perfect.

Is it mandatory to follow the tajweed rules?

It is mandatory to be able to apply the minimum amount of tajweed to your recitation which includes the following elements:

(1) Pronounce letters clearly and properly

(2) Pronounce the diacritics (tashkīl) correctly

(3) Reciting the Qur'ān without making any major/ clear mistakes.

Other tajweed skills like, Qalqalah, Secondary Madd, idghām, Ikhfā' are **not** obligatory to apply, but it is better to apply them.

In short, the correct view is that one must be able to apply the tajweed rules that enable you to read the Qur'ān without making major mistakes that can potentially change the meaning of an āyah. Therefore, if a Muslim reads and pronounces every letter with its vowel correctly and as indicated in the Muṣ-ḥaf, then this is sufficient.

TIP

Many learners cannot differentiate between clear & hidden mistakes in the Qur'ān, probably because they cannot understand Arabic yet, and know the implications of each mistake. Therefore, it is always best to learn every tajweed rule and know how to apply it, then you know for sure, that you are not making any type of mistakes, and most importantly, you will be reciting like the Prophet ﷺ did, and this in shā' Allāh will multiply your rewards.



1 Al-Mulk, 5

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3. Qur'ān vs. Muṣ-ḥaf

In this book, we will use both of these words to explain the different ways to deal with the book of Allāh. It is important to understand that these words are not synonyms, and understanding the distinction between them will improve your overall grasp of tajweed, *in shā' Allāh*. Here is the difference between these two words:

Qur'ān	Muṣ-ḥaf
'Qur'ān' refers to the word of Allāh no matter how little or how much of it is mentioned. So this āyah: ٱلْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ ٱلْعَٰلَمِينَ is called 'Qur'ān'. It also refers to the revealed words to the Prophet ﷺ whether it is written down or spoken.	The word Muṣ-ḥaf مُصحَف refers to the physical copy of the **entire** Qur'ān from Al-Fātiḥah to An-Nās. This means that sūrah Al-Baqarah is Qur'ān, but not the Muṣ-ḥaf.

Can we describe the Qur'ān as 'Holy'?

It is not Harām to say the 'Holy' Qur'ān since Holy means 'from Allāh', but it is better **not** to use the word Holy with the Qur'ān just to be different from using the word 'Holy' with the Bible which cannot be compared to the Qur'ān. It is, therefore, better describe the Qur'ān using the words that Allāh has used to described it:

103

إِنَّهُۥ لَقُرْءَانٌ كَرِيمٌ [2]

Indeed, it is a noble Qur'ān

104

بَلْ هُوَ قُرْءَانٌ مَّجِيدٌ [3]

But this is an honored Qur'ān

105

وَٱلْقُرْءَانَ ٱلْعَظِيمَ [4]

and the great Qur'ān

Allāh has described the Qur'ān in other ways than the ones mentioned in these examples.

2 Al-Wāqi'ah, 77
3 Al-Burūj, 21
4 Al-Hijr, 87

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4. Uthmāni Codex

The word ṣaḥābah صَحَابَة refers to the companions of the Prophet ﷺ

The Muṣ-ḥaf is written using what we call the ***Uthmāni Codex*** (اَلرَّسمُ العُثمَانِي). This refers to the way the ṣaḥābah (May Allāh be pleased with all of them) used to write down the Qur'ān when it was revealed to the Prophet ﷺ. Uthmānic Codex is named after the Khalifah Uthmān ibn 'Afān (may Allāh be pleased with him) for his efforts to compile the Qur'ān in one Muṣ-ḥaf, and because it happened during his reign as khalīfah.

It is important to know that Uthmānic Codex does not refer to the letter face or font used, but it refers to the system used to write each word.

So the word الصَّلَاة is written like this according to the Uthmāni Codex:

106

ٱلصَّلَوٰةَ

So this version of the word, is called Uthmāni Codex regardless of which style, font, or type face used by the calligraphist and also regardless of which Muṣ-ḥaf (Urdu, Turkish ..etc) is used; they are all still written using the same system and same order of letters.

Here are some examples for Uthmāni Codex that look different according to each Muṣ-ḥaf:

107



All of these examples are for āyah number (43) from Sūrah Al-Baqarah, and they all come from different Muṣ-ḥafs. Although it is the very same āyah, the differences are purely aesthetic, but when it comes to how words are written, they are the exact same because they are all written using Uthmāni Codex.

Remember

When writing or citing āyāt from the Qur'ān, you should always use the Uthmāni Codex too, and you should not spell the words differently.

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5. Qur'ān Recitation

The word 'ibādah عِبَادَة means an act of worship to Allāh like prayer, fasting ..etc

The recitation of the Qur'ān is an 'ibādah عِبَادَة which means that you will, ***in shā' Allāh***, be rewarded for doing it, even when you are busy learning how to do it properly like you are doing right now. However, not everyone that recites the Qur'ān or tries to learn how to recite it properly, gets that reward. The reason is that there are **TWO** conditions that you have to fulfill, in order to get your Qur'ān recitation accepted and rewarded ***in shā' Allāh***.



The first condition is also the most important, but it is surely the easiest one to skip or forget about.

Condition #1:
Intention

Intention is the purpose of your action, what/ who you are doing it for. Your intention for reciting the Qur'ān should be solely and exclusively for the sake of Allāh, and no one else. That is why, it is very important to remember and evoke your intention (without saying it out loud; only keep it in your heart) every time you commence reciting or learning the Qur'ān.

Here are some examples of **wrong** intentions:

What other examples of bad intentions that you can think of?

I want to recite the Qur'ān ...
- Because I have a nice voice and want to use it.
- So that people like my voice.
- To impress my peers/ people praying behind me.
- To lead people in prayer and show off my skills.
- To recite in people's gatherings and make money.

Here are some examples of **good** intention for reciting that Qur'ān:

All acts of a Muslim should be purely for the sake of Allāh.

I want to recite the Qur'ān ...
- To ponder over the word of Allāh.
- Because Allāh asked us to recite it.
- So that Allāh is pleased with me.
- To follow the sunnah of the Prophet ﷺ
- Because I love the Qur'ān
- Because I am afraid of Hell Fire.
- Because I am afraid of being a deserter of the Qur'ān.

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Condition #2:
Sunnah

Following the Sunnah of the Prophet ﷺ is the second condition that you should fulfill in order to perform the 'ibādah of reciting the Qur'ān correctly. And to do that, you need to do these three things:

1. **Recite the Qur'ān properly, using the tajweed.**

For more information about what is 'minimum' amount of tajweed required, please revisit the provided explanation about 'what is tajweed/ what is laḥn' – page 3 - 4)

The word tartīl also refers to the medium speed at which one can recite the Qur'ān.

2. **Applying tarteel** (تَرتِيل)

This refers to your speed of recitation. In other words, you are not supposed to recite the Qur'ān too fast to the point that you cannot follow what you are saying, or if someone is listening to you that they would not understand what you are reciting. Allāh says in the Qur'ān: وَرَتِّلِ ٱلْقُرْءَانَ تَرْتِيلًا

3. **Beautify your voice**

Our Prophet ﷺ told us to make our voices beautiful when reciting the Qur'ān. Naturally, not everyone has the voice of Shaikh Al-Huṣary, but the intended meaning here, is to recite the Qur'ān with your most beautiful voice, without exaggeration or singing the āyāt.

6. SŪRAH - ĀYAH - VERSE

The word **sūrah** سُورَة refers to a chapter in the Qur'ān. The Noble Qur'ān consists of 114 sūrahs.

The word **Āyah** refers to a single verse of a sūrah. The plural or āyah is (Āyāt - ءايَات). The Qur'ān consists of **6236** āyāt in total. The smallest sūrah contains only three āyāt, while the longest sūrah has 286 āyāt which is Sūrah Al-Baqarah.

Which sūrahs contain only 3 āyāt?

Of course, we can use chapter and verse to refer to sūrah and āyah; however, it is better to use the Arabic versions since they represent the intended meaning much more accurately than the English translation. Moreover, the word 'verse' can also be used in different contexts like, lyrics and poetry, while āyah is only used with the Qur'ān. Throughout this handbook, the Arabic versions and also their transcribed versions are used, so you also know what you can expect.

TIP

To easily remember the number of āyāt of the Qur'ān, simply recall that the duration of the mission (Daʿwah) of the Prophet ﷺ took 23 years. Now simply add one 6 before 23 and one 6 after, and now you have the total number of āyāt in the Noble Qur'ān: 6236.

So, before we get started with the next chapter .. remember what you have learned about your intention, and focus your intention towards Allāh only ..

Bismillah...

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Picture by artist: Savannah Fekry

2

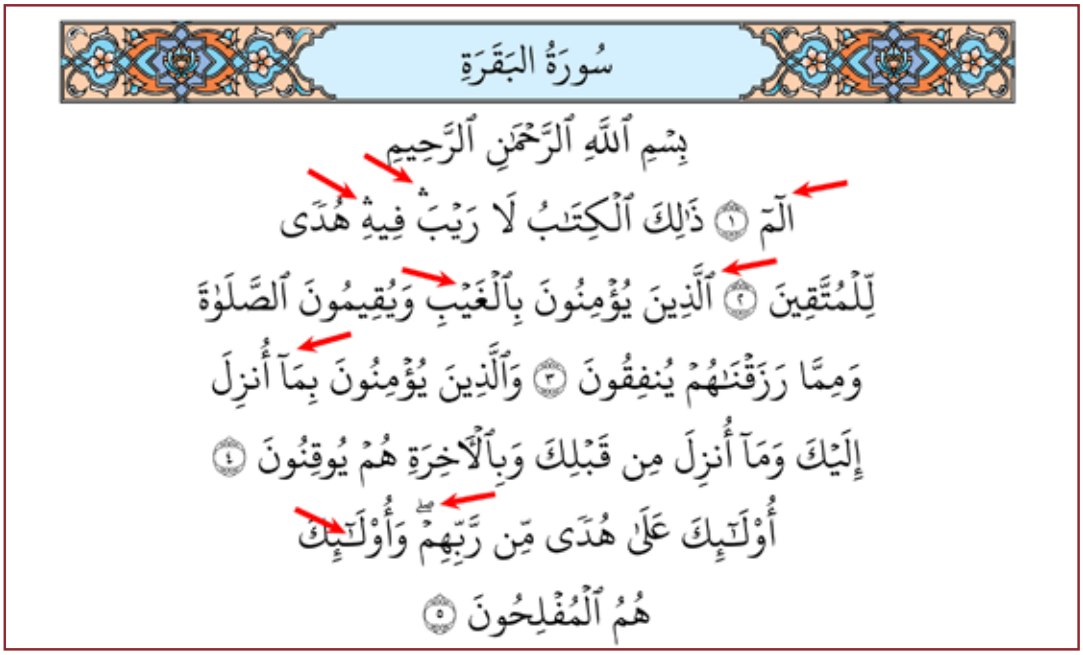
Qur'ānic Symbols

In this chapter you will learn:

- Why should we learn Qur'ān Symbols
- Stopping symbols
- Uthmāni Codex symbols
- MISC symbols
- Symbols found in Turkish & Urdu Muṣ-ḥaf

ORIENTATION

After studying the Arabic Alphabet, the tashkīl system (long and short vowels) and then learning how to decipher Arabic words and finally actually reading the Qur'ān, you will still see some 'unfamiliar' symbols when you open your Muṣ-ḥaf for the first time, see image.



Without knowing what these symbols mean, you will not be able to know where to stop, how to stop, and even how to pronounce some letters in certain cases or exceptions. That is why your first step should be understanding these signs and symbols. When this happens, you will be able to decipher everything you see on each page of the Muṣ-ḥaf, in shā' Allāh.

The word Ijtihādāt [Arabic: (اجتِهَادَات)] means the attempts of scholars of Islām to derive rulings in order to solve problems or come up with solutions to make it easy for Muslims.

These symbols, and their placement are all from the ***ijtihādāt*** of the scholars of Qur'ān. They are mainly derived from how the Prophet ﷺ used to recite the Noble Qur'ān, where he would stop in reading, and how he would resume. This knowledge was taught to the ṣaḥabah ,and then the ṣaḥabah in turn passed it down to the next generation till it reached us today. It also depends on the Arabic sentence structure, where sentences end and how to make sure that stopping and resuming does not change the intended meaning or cause ambiguity in understanding the word of Allāh.



Since these symbols are from the Ijtihādāt of scholars, you might see that your Muṣ-ḥaf has different symbol placement. These differences are mostly observed when comparing, for example, the Arabic Muṣ-ḥaf to the Urdu one which typically contains more symbols. These differences could be to help non-Arab readers, and it could also be because of following a different school of thought. However, these differences do not affect the meaning, and therefore, should not be a point of concern.

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1- Stopping Symbols

Stopping symbols refer to the symbols that are related to stopping and resuming while reciting the Qur'ān; it also indicates where you may and may not end your recitation. This concept is important since stopping or linking sentences in Arabic can change their meaning. Here are the symbols that will guide you to stop/ pause your recitation:

1 ۝ | **End of an** āyah

According to the Riwāyah of Hafs 'an 'āṣim, there are 6236 āyāt in the entire Qur'ān.

This is the most important and most used symbol in the Qur'ān: the end of an āyah. Stopping at each of these symbols is how the Prophet ﷺ used to recite the Qur'ān. Therefore, It is better to follow the sunnah at all times even if the āyāt are very short or close to one another. You should **always** stop at the end of the āyah regardless of the situation or the existence of other symbols.

Not stopping at the end of the āyah is **not** harām or prohibited, but it is unlike what the Prophet ﷺ used to do when he recited the Qur'ān.

2 مـ | You **must stop**

This mīm symbol refers to the phrase Al-Waqf Al-Lāzim (الوَقفُ اللَّازِمُ) which literally translates into **'mandatory stop'**. In order to understand how important and effective this symbol is, let us see the difference in meaning if we ignored the highlighted stopping symbol in this āyah:

201

إِنَّمَا يَسْتَجِيبُ ٱلَّذِينَ يَسْمَعُونَ ۘ وَٱلْمَوْتَىٰ يَبْعَثُهُمُ ٱللَّهُ ثُمَّ إِلَيْهِ يُرْجَعُونَ [1]

NOT Stopping at مـ	Stopping at مـ
Those who listen as well as the dead will respond, Allāh will resurrect them; then to Him they will be returned.	*Only those who listen will respond. As for the dead, Allāh will resurrect them; then to Him they will be returned.*
WARNING HARAM Wrong Recitation	✓

Reciting the Qur'ān in a wrong way deliberately with the intent of changing its meaning, puts any Muslim in grave danger; it is, therefore, no trivial matter.

1 Al-An'ām, 36

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Why is it 'Harām'?

When comparing the two possibilities, you will see how ignoring the symbol changed the meaning of āyah completely from what it was originally intended to be. That is why, it is prohibited to **'deliberately'** recite the Qur'ān like that with the intention of changing or corrupting its meaning. Therefore, this is among the more important symbols that you should not skip when reciting the Qur'ān.

How should you recite āyah 65 (Yūnus)?

However, if you made a genuine mistake with **no deliberation**, then it is no problem and is forgiven in shā' Allāh. Our Prophet ﷺ said "*Allāh has forgiven my nation for mistakes and forgetfulness, and what they are forced to do.*"[2]. So, as long as you are still learning and are trying to improve yourself, you are on the right path.

3 ❖ ❖ You **must stop at either**, not both

This symbol is called Al-waqf Al-mutaʿāniq (الوَقفُ المُتَعانِقُ) which translates to **'interconnected stopping'**. The reason for being called interconnected is that they are mutually exclusive; i.e., **if you stop at one you cannot stop at the other**. This symbol also underlines the beauty of the Noble Qur'ān and its perfection since often times you will see that stopping at the first symbol generates a meaning, while stopping at the second could generate another meaning that enhances the message miraculously. Consider this example:

202

ذَٰلِكَ ٱلۡكِتَٰبُ لَا رَيۡبَۛ فِيهِۛ هُدٗى لِّلۡمُتَّقِينَ ٢ [3]

This symbol is much more commonly used in Urdu/ Turkish Muṣ-ḥafs than Arabic Muṣ-ḥaf. This phenomenon is discussed further in page 23.

Stopping at رَيۡبَۛ	Stopping at فِيهِۛ
This is the book no doubt, in it, there is guidance for those who fear Allāh. ✓	*This is the book in which there is no doubt, it is guidance for those who fear Allāh.* ✓

In this āyah, you can get two variations of the meaning for this sentence, depending on whether you stop at the first or at the second symbol.

2 (Sahīh) Sunan Ibn Mājah, 2045
3 Al-Baqarah, 2

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Notice that 'ending' your recitation is not the same as 'stopping/ pausing,' which we do between āyāt to take a breath and follow the sunnah.

4 لا You **mustn't end** your recitation at this point

This symbol speaks for itself, because the symbol is actually the word لا which means 'No' and it is an indication that you may not **end** your recitation at this point. In certain instances, like the example below, the symbol will be observed at the end of an āyah. And since it is a sunnah to stop at each āyah, pausing (and then resuming afterwards) at this symbol is not a problem as long as you do not **end** your recitation at that point, or (if you are in prayer) go to rukū' at this āyah. The reason is that the meaning of the āyah will be incomplete or will deliver the wrong message.

Let us study the following example:

203

Some Arabic Muṣ-ḥafs do not have this symbol at all since it is clearer for Arabic speakers to detect such situations in the Qur'ān.

فَوَيْلٌ لِّلْمُصَلِّينَ ۝٤ لا ٱلَّذِينَ هُمْ عَن صَلَاتِهِمْ سَاهُونَ ۝٥ [4]

Stopping & Ending at ٤	Pausing at ٤ then continuing to ٥
Woe on those who pray.	*Woe on those who prayer, who are heedless of their prayer –*
WARNING HARAM Wrong Recitation	✓

This example shows how much of a difference it makes when stopping and ending at two different positions in this sūrah. Just like the previous case in page 11, **deliberate** mistakes like this are prohibited, and must not be made.

This symbols could be best compared to 70% go | 30% stop

5 صلے You **should continue** reading.

The word 'ṣila' is an acronym from the phrase: الوَصلُ أولَى which means it is better to keep going.

This symbol is referred to as 'ṣila' which spells this symbol out. This is not a mandatory symbol of stopping, and as it happens, the instructions of this specific symbol entails that it is better to keep on reading and ignore the symbol. However, if you need to take a breath in the middle of the āyah, then this is a perfect spot to do so without having to repeat any words from before you have stopped; you can just simply continue reading from after the symbol.

Let us study the following example:

4 Al-Mā'ūn, 5

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204

كَلَّا صلى لَيُنۢبَذَنَّ فِي ٱلۡحُطَمَةِ ٤ [5]

No! He will surely be thrown into the Crusher.

In this example, the meaning does not change, it is still better to keep on reading.

This symbols could be best compared to 30% go | 70% stop

6 قلى You **should stop** then continue.

The word 'qila' is an acronym from the phrase: الوَقفُ أولَى which means it is better to stop.

This symbol is referred to as 'qila', which, like the previous symbol, spells out the symbol itself. In its function, this symbol is very similar to the previous one except this is the opposite. This means that this symbol is not mandatory, but it is better to stop at it rather than keep on reading. This symbol is best compared to a 'period' at the end of a sentence, and a new sentence starts afterwards.

205

وَأَيَّدۡنَٰهُ بِرُوحِ ٱلۡقُدُسِۗ قلى أَفَكُلَّمَا جَآءَكُمۡ رَسُولُۢ بِمَا لَا تَهۡوَىٰٓ أَنفُسُكُمُ ٱسۡتَكۡبَرۡتُمۡ [6]

And supported him with the Pure Spirit. But is it [not] that every time a messenger came to you, [O Children of Israel], with what your souls did not desire, you were arrogant?

In this example, the meaning will not necessarily change whether you keep on reading, or you stop at it. However, it would be better if the meaning of the first sentence is completed first before moving to the second sentence which is why the interruption is a better choice here.

This symbols could be best compared to 50% go | 50% stop

7 ج You **may stop/ continue**

This symbol represents the word waqf jā'iz وَقفٌ جَائِز which translates to **"a permissible stop."** Stopping at this symbol and keeping on reading are essentially equally good. The meaning does not become clearer or more ambiguous if you stopped or kept on reading. That is why, it is can be considered as a good spot for taking a breath if you need to. Study the following example:

206

فَسَبِّحۡ بِحَمۡدِ رَبِّكَ وَٱسۡتَغۡفِرۡهُۚ ج إِنَّهُۥ كَانَ تَوَّابَۢا ٣ [7]

5 Al-Humazah, 4
6 Al-Baqarah, 87
7 An-Nasr, 3

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8 س | Momentary pause

This symbol, which looks like the letter س , refers to the word (سَكتَة) which means a **'short/ momentary pause.'** This symbol only applies if you want to continue reading without stopping which then instructs you to take a short pause without taking a breath before you keep on going. However, it is also possible to stop and take a breath, then continue from after the symbol. This means that the main function of this symbol is to **prevent the reader from connecting the words** before س and after س.

The most famous example is found in the beginning of sūrah Al-Kahf:

207

ٱلۡحَمۡدُ لِلَّهِ ٱلَّذِيٓ أَنزَلَ عَلَىٰ عَبۡدِهِ ٱلۡكِتَٰبَ وَلَمۡ يَجۡعَل لَّهُۥ عِوَجَاۜ ١ قَيِّمًا لِّيُنذِرَ بَأۡسٗا شَدِيدٗا مِّن لَّدُنۡهُ وَيُبَشِّرَ ٱلۡمُؤۡمِنِينَ [8]

This symbol was used in three other places in the Qur'ān in juz' 23, 29 & 30 - Can you find them?

In this example, if you **did not** stop after the first āyah linked between the words عِوَجَاۜ ١ قَيِّمًا, the meaning of the example will become:

CAUTION

[All] praise is [due] to Allāh, who has sent down upon His Servant the Book and has not made therein any deviance or value, to warn of severe punishment from Himself; and to deliver good news to the believers

This is, of course, not the intended meaning from this āyah. However, upon stopping at the end of the first āyah, or momentarily stopping, the correct meaning of the āyah will be realized:

[All] praise is [due] to Allāh, who has sent down upon His Servant the Book and has not made therein any deviance. (1) [He has made it] straight, to warn of severe punishment from Him and to give good tidings to the believers

Remember

Stopping and resuming الوَقف و الابتِدَاء is a separate branch of knowledge with different opinions and schools of thought on the placement of some symbols. So, the symbols in Arabic Muṣ-ḥafs might differ from Urdu Muṣ-ḥaf or Turkish Muṣ-ḥaf depending on the school of thought. Also, Arab readers require less assistant on that matter than readers who cannot understand Arabic.

8 Al-Kahf, 1-2

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2- Uthmāni Codex Symbols

The Muṣ-ḥafs that we have today, are all written in the Uthmāni codex. This system of writing has some differences from regular Arabic texts. In order to be able to read this Uthmāni codex easier and without making mistakes, there are a number of symbols used which refer to letters that are pronounced, but not spelled in the word or they are referred to using different symbols.

Remember

Following these Uthmāni Codex symbols is NOT optional. Every Qur'ān reciter MUST follow these symbols, and pronounce them because ignoring them means skipping a sound in the Qur'ān which is always a 'clear mistake.'

1 ١ **Pronounce alif** = ا



An Arabian Dagger

This is one of the most common symbols in the Qur'ān. It is called Al-alif Al-khinjariyyah (الأَلِف الخِنجَرِيّة) which literally means **"dagger alif"**. The reason why it is so called, is because it looks like an Arabian dagger (with picture) when compared to it. Seeing this symbols in a word means that you must pronounce an alif.

208

ذَٰلِكَ ٱلْكِتَٰبُ لَا رَيْبَ[9]

This symbol of alif must always be pronounced exactly as a normal alif.

Reading this āyah without pronouncing the **"dagger alif"** is 'clear mistake', since it changes the meaning of the āyah.

2 و **Pronounce wāw** = و

This symbol is a tiny و that you will see both within words, and even between words. This symbol will cause the exact same pronunciation as the و letter as a long vowel, and much like the previous symbol, this one is also mandatory to follow since it is an inherent part of the word. This can be observed in this example:

209

وَإِنَّ مِنْهُمْ لَفَرِيقًا يَلْوُۥنَ أَلْسِنَتَهُم بِٱلْكِتَٰبِ[10]

9 Al-Baqarah, 2
10 Āl-i-ʿimrān, 78

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This symbol occurs much more commonly between words rather than in the same word.

In this example, the و symbol occurs inside the word يَلْوُۥنَ which means that in this case you will pronounce two و - one after one another.

However, when this symbol occurs between two words, it will only be pronounced if you keep on reading and link between the two words that are before and after the و symbol, like in this example:

210

11 فَلَمَّآ أَضَآءَتْ مَا حَوْلَهُۥ ذَهَبَ ٱللَّهُ بِنُورِهِمْ

Notice the difference in symbol pronunciation when stopping and continuing recitation.

In this example, the و symbol came between the word حَوْلَه and ذَهَبَ. This means that if you stop at the former word: حَوْلَه, you will not pronounce the symbol since you did not link the two words, while if you connected the two words and kept on reading, you will have to pronounce a full و in that case.

3 ے | **Pronounce yā'** = ى

This symbol stands for the third long vowel which is ى. This means that whenever you come across this symbol, you will pronounce a long vowel ى.

Like in this example:

211

12 لِإِيلَٰفِ قُرَيْشٍ ۝١ إِۦلَٰفِهِمْ رِحْلَةَ ٱلشِّتَآءِ وَٱلصَّيْفِ ۝٢

This symbol also functions in the same way as the previous one, which means that when this symbol occurs between two words, you pronounce it only when you keep on reading.

Like in this example:

212

13 فَأْتُوا۟ بِسُورَةٍ مِّن مِّثْلِهِۦ وَٱدْعُوا۟ شُهَدَآءَكُم

Notice the difference in symbol pronunciation when stopping and continuing recitation.

In this example, stopping at the word مِّثْلِهِ means that you will not pronounce the ـۦ symbol, but if you link the two words مِّثْلِهِۦ وَٱدْعُوا۟ when keeping on reading, then you must pronounce yā' because of the ـۦ symbol.

11 Al-Baqarah, 17
12 Quraish, 2
13 Al-Baqarah, 23

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4 ـــ Elongate/ extend

This topic will be discussed in detail even more in chapter 5.

This symbol refers to the Arabic word مَدّ which literally means to extend or elongate the sound. This symbol means that you should extend the sound of the letter on which it occurs, and this extension will range from 4 counts up to 6 counts.

213

14 صِرَٰطَ ٱلَّذِينَ أَنۡعَمۡتَ عَلَيۡهِمۡ غَيۡرِ ٱلۡمَغۡضُوبِ عَلَيۡهِمۡ وَلَا ٱلضَّآلِّينَ

In this particular example, the alif in the word ٱلضَّآلِّينَ will be extended for 6 counts, which is the longest you will even extend a letter in the Qur'ān.

5 ◌ْ Sukūn/ No vowel

sukūn is another way of indicating that a certain letter has no vowels (in a consonant state)

This symbol is usually mistaken for this symbol ◌ٰ because in regular Arabic, sukūn is given this symbol ◌ٰ. However, **in the Qur'ān**, this symbol ◌ْ stands for **sukūn**, or that there are no short vowels applied on the letter.

214

15 وَإِن تُصِبۡكُمۡ سَيِّئَةٞ يَفۡرَحُواْ بِهَاۖ

The word sākin (سَاكِن) refers to a letter that has sukūn

It is important to know that sukūn in the Qur'ān is not **only** indicated using ◌ْ symbol. However, if a letter is **completely free from any tashkīl symbols**, then this is also an indication of a letter being a consonant or without a vowel (sākin).

Study this example:

215

16 أَيۡنَمَا تَكُونُواْ يُدۡرِككُّمُ ٱلۡمَوۡتُ

This is a special type of sukūn which will be fully explained in Chapter 11

In this example, the first kaaf ك has no tashkīl symbols on top or under it, which indicates that this is a (sākin) consonant; in other words, it has sukūn.

14 Al-Fātihah, 7
15 Āl-i 'imrān, 120
16 An-Nisā', 78

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6 ۥ Silent letter/ Do not pronounce

This symbol means that the letter on which it appears, is a silent letter. In other words, you will completely ignore this letter and read the word without it. Observe the following example, and how they are pronounced.

216

17 وَإِن تُصِبْكُمْ سَيِّئَةٌ يَفْرَحُواْ بِهَا ۖ

So in this example, the alif at the end of the word يَفْرَحُواْ is a silent alif, and the word is then read as يَفْرَحُو without the alif. Here are the most important examples that cause confusion to many learners:

It is advisable to learn how to pronounce these words properly, as they might confuse some beginners

Where to find	The word	How it is pronounced	Where to find	The word	How it is pronounced
51- 47	بِأَيْيْدٍ	بِأَيْدٍ	27- 21	لَأَأْذْبَحَنَّهُ	لَأَذْبَحَنَّهُ
18-23	لِشَأْىْءٍ	لِشَىْءٍ	3- 144	أَفَإِيْن	أَفَإِن
12- 87	تَأْيْئَسُواْ	تَيْئَسُو	6- 34	نَّبَإِىْ	نَّبَإِ
27- 33	أُوْلُواْ	أُلُو	28- 76	أُوْلِى	أُلِى
7- 103	مَلَإِيْهِ	مَلَإِهِ	2- 259	مِأْئَةَ	مِئَةَ

Regardless of stopping at these words, or keeping on reading, the letters with the symbol ۥ on them will **not** be pronounced. The way these words are written is unique to the Qur'ān only, and it is part of the Uthmāni Codex that every muṣ-ḥaf follows.

CAUTION

These two symbols:

ۥ ≠ 0

are not the same, and must not be confused with one another.

17 Āl-i 'imrān, 120

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7 ٥ Conditional silent alif

'Silent' = not pronounced

This symbol appears **only at the end of words, on top of the letter alif**, like this = أٰ. This symbol means that the alif is **silent** in case you keep on reading. However, if you stop at a word that has that ending أٰ, then it means that you will pronounce the alif normally.

217

18 قَالَ أَنَاْ خَيۡرٞ مِّنۡهُ

In this example, we apply the following rule:

Stopping at أَنَاْ	**Not stopping at** أَنَاْ
Alif will be fully pronounced, and we read	Alif will be dropped, and we read
أَنَا	أَنَ

The phrase (الأَلِفاتُ السَّبع) *literally means 'the seven alifs' in reference to the seven cases of alif that follow this rule.*

The rule of (الأَلِفاتُ السَّبع) helps you identify all the cases in which this symbol is used.

الأَلِفاتُ السَّبع	أَنَاْ	لَّكِنَّاْ	ٱلظُّنُونَاْ	ٱلرَّسُولَاْ	ٱلسَّبِيلَاْ	سَلَٰسِلَاْ	قَوَارِيرَاْ
		18-38	*33-10*	*33-66*	*33-67*	*76-4*	*76-15*
NOT Stopping at أٰ	أَنَ	لَّكِنَّ	ٱلظُّنُونَ	ٱلرَّسُولَ	ٱلسَّبِيلَ	سَلَٰسِلَ	قَوَارِيرَ
Stopping at أٰ	أَنَا	لَّكِنَّا	ٱلظُّنُونَا	ٱلرَّسُولَا	ٱلسَّبِيلَا	سَلَٰسِلَا	قَوَارِيرَا

Every instance of the word أَنَاْ *ends with this symbol*

CAUTION

"Stopping at 'x' word" should not suggest that it is acceptable to randomly stop at any word if you didn't have to. In fact, stopping and resuming in the Qur'ān is a separate branch of knowledge of the Qur'ān with its own rules. The basics of this branch will be explained in the next chapter. However, following the Qur'ān symbols can ensure that you will not be making any stopping/ resuming mistakes.

18 Sād, 76

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8 م | **Pronounce** mīm = م

This is the symbol of 'Iqlāb' which will be explained in detail in Chapter 8

This symbol is may be found on top of the letter nūn ن which signifies that this nūn should be pronounced as mīm. This refers to the phenomenon of Iqlāb (Arabic: إِقْلَاب) which happens when /n/ comes before /b/ (ن + ب) and the result is that the nūn will not be pronounced anymore.

218 ذَٰلِكَ بِأَنَّهُمْ كَانُوا۟ يَكْفُرُونَ بِـَٔايَـٰتِ ٱللَّهِ وَيَقْتُلُونَ ٱلْأَنۢبِيَآءَ بِغَيْرِ حَقٍّ [19]

This means that the word ٱلْأَنۢبِيَآءَ is **not** pronounced as /Al-Anbiā'/ but rather as /Al-Ambiā'/

This symbol also appears on top of tanwīn, with the same effect: the tanwīn will be pronounced as mīm.

Like in these examples:

219 وَأَخَذْنَا ٱلَّذِينَ ظَلَمُوا۟ بِعَذَابٍۭ بَـِٔيسٍۭ [20]

Don't forget: *tanwīn (like any tashkīl symbol) is **only** pronounced when you keep on reading, if you stop at the word, tanwīn is not pronounced at all.*

In this example, if we stop at the word بَـِٔيسٍۭ we will not pronounce the tanwīn or the symbol of Iqlāb. But, we will pronounce the word بِعَذَابٍۭ as /bi'adhābim/ with mīm at the end instead of tanwīn.

220 وَٱللَّهُ رَءُوفٌۢ بِٱلْعِبَادِ [21]

221 كَلَّا لَئِن لَّمْ يَنتَهِ لَنَسْفَعًۢا بِٱلنَّاصِيَةِ [22]

19 Āl-i 'imrān, 112
20 Al-A'rāf, 165
21 Al-Baqarah, 207
22 Al-'alaq, 15

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3- Other Qur'ān Symbols

1 ۩ **Preform** Sujūd (prostration)

Performing sujūd (prostration) at such āyāt is not mandatory, but it is the sunnah (whether in prayer or not) so it is better to perform sujūd if possible.*

This symbol means that you will do sujūd (prostrate) to Allāh after you have read the āyah with which this symbol ends.

222

23 إِنَّ ٱلَّذِينَ عِندَ رَبِّكَ لَا يَسْتَكْبِرُونَ عَنْ عِبَادَتِهِۦ وَيُسَبِّحُونَهُۥ وَلَهُۥ يَسْجُدُونَ ۩ ﴿٢٠٦﴾

You can also notice that this is a line above the word يَسْجُدُونَ. This line refers to the reason where there is a sujūd in this āyah, and it is the word which triggers the requirement of sujūd.

2 ❊ **Do Nothing**

The shape of this symbol may vary from Muṣ-ḥaf to another. So, this symbol ❊ is not universal in all Muṣ-ḥafs.

This symbol does not require any action from you; it only signifies the end of a quarter of a ḥizb. This is related to the division of the Muṣ-ḥaf itself, and it has no relation how you should read the words of the Qur'ān.

The Muṣ-ḥaf has 30 juz' (parts). Every juz' is divided into 2 ḥizb (Arabic: حِزب). And every ḥizb is divided into 4 quarters. This symbol just lets you know that you have reached the beginning of a new quarter of a ḥizb. Their main purpose is to easily divide, read, and memorize the Qur'ān.

223

24 ❊ أَتَأْمُرُونَ ٱلنَّاسَ بِٱلْبِرِّ وَتَنسَوْنَ أَنفُسَكُمْ

DID YOU KNOW?

Every quarter in the Qur'ān has a name. The name of each quarter is the first word/ two words of that quarter.
So the name of the quarter here above is called: the quarter of أَتَأْمُرُونَ

23 Al-A'rāf, 206
24 Al-Baqarah, 44
* According to Hanafi Madhab, it is mandatory.

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If you only use 'Arabic' Muṣ-ḥafs, then you may skip this part.

4- Qur'ān Symbols (Urdu/ Turkish)

Urdu and Turkish Muṣ-ḥafs use by default Qur'ānic symbols much more frequently than Arabic Muṣ-ḥafs. The reason is that most users of Urdu and Turkish Muṣ-ḥafs do not typically understand Arabic, so it would be more challenging to them to make a correct **stop/ resume** without changing or ruining the meaning of the āyah. Added to the more frequent use of Qur'ānic symbols, there are a number of symbols that are not used in Arabic Muṣ-ḥafs at all. Here are the most important symbols only found in non-Arabic Muṣ-ḥafs:

Why Urdu/ Turkish Muṣ-ḥafs use symbols much more frequently than other Arabic Muṣ-ḥafs.

1 ع | **End of story/ teaching**

This symbol refers to the word رُكُوع . So stopping at this symbol (especially in case of prayer) is good because with it, the story or the teaching is concluded, and therefore, it is suitable to end recitation and go to rukū'. That's why you can observe this symbol at the end of shorter surahs found in juz' 30 and also at the end of each story of a Prophet:

وَلَمْ يَكُنْ لَّهٗ كُفُوًا اَحَدٌ ۝٤ ع [25]

If you are in prayer or just reciting the Qur'ān, ending your recitation at the symbol ع is a good option.

*Ending your recitation at this symbol is **not mandatory**. You can to end the recitation/ go to rukū without reading the full story/ teaching. More on how to end your recitation in Chapter 3.*

ثُمَّ يَمَسُّهُمْ مِّنَّا عَذَابٌ اَلِيْمٌ ۝٤٨ تِلْكَ مِنْ اَنْۢبَآءِ
الْغَيْبِ نُوْحِيْهَآ اِلَيْكَ ۚ مَا كُنْتَ تَعْلَمُهَآ اَنْتَ وَلَا
قَوْمُكَ مِنْ قَبْلِ هٰذَا ۛ فَاصْبِرْ ۛ اِنَّ الْعَاقِبَةَ
لِلْمُتَّقِيْنَ ۝٤٩ ع وَاِلٰى عَادٍ اَخَاهُمْ هُوْدًا ۛ قَالَ يٰقَوْمِ [26]

In this example, the story of Nūḥ is concluded at āyah 49, which is then followed by the ع symbol. We also notice that the āyah that follows (āyah 50), is the start of the story of Hūd. So the better place to end your recitation would be 49 rather than 50. Of course, you can always choose to keep on reading till the end of the sūrah.

25 Al-Ikhlās, 4
26 Hūd, 49

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2 ص | Licence to pause

This symbol stands for the word رُخصَة and it literally means 'a license to stop.' This symbol is found in longer āyāt so that it gives the reader the possibility to pause half way to take a breath and then continue from after this symbol without having to repeat words. However, you mustn't **end** your recitation at that spot since the meaning is not yet complete.

27 قَلِيلًا فَكَثَّرَكُمْ ۖ وَٱنظُرُوا۟ كَيْفَ كَانَ عَٰقِبَةُ

It is possible to stop at the word, فَكَثَّرَكُمْ and then continue at the word وَٱنظُرُوا۟ after taking a breath without changing or affecting the meaning. However, you may not end your recitation at the word فَكَثَّرَكُمْ.

3 ق / ز | Better keep going

These two symbols are essentially the same. Both of them indicate a bad spot for stopping since the meaning gets weaker. It is, therefore, better to keep on reading and not to stop at this symbol.

28 ٱلتَّوْرَىٰةِ وَٱلْإِنجِيلِ يَأْمُرُهُم بِٱلْمَعْرُوفِ وَيَنْهَىٰهُمْ

29 قَالُوا۟ سَمِعْنَا وَعَصَيْنَا ۖ وَأُشْرِبُوا۟ فِى قُلُوبِهِمُ ٱلْعِجْلَ

4 ط | Better to stop

The symbol of ط refers to the end of a sentence. This means that whatever comes after this symbol is not grammatically related to what comes before it. Therefore, you can safely stop at ط and then continue reciting from after the symbol.

However, ط also means that there is a point that is yet to be added to the topic in question which would develop the meaning even further. That's why, you can**not** 'end' your recitation at that point since what comes after, brings in important information.

This symbol is very commonly used in Urdu Muṣ-ḥafs. It is always better to stop at it.

27 Al-A'rāf, 86
28 Al-A'rāf, 157
29 Al-Baqarah, 93

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Study this example:

وَقَالُوا كُونُوا هُودًا أَوْ نَصَارَىٰ تَهْتَدُوا ۗ قُلْ بَلْ مِلَّةَ
إِبْرَاهِيمَ حَنِيفًا ۖ وَمَا كَانَ مِنَ الْمُشْرِكِينَ ﴿١٣٥﴾ [30]

They say, "Be Jews or Christians [so] you will be guided." Say, "Rather, [we follow] the religion of Abraham, inclining toward truth, and he was not of the polytheists."

Here we notice that after every instance of ط there is another thing said that adds important information to what was said before it. That's why, it is better to stop at these symbols to separate the sentences from one another, and at the same time, do not end your recitation there to complete the point made.

5 ۵ **Qirā'ah difference**

The symbol ۵ refers to a difference in the division of the āyāt according to the ten confirmed Qirā'āt of the Qur'ān. This means you can treat this symbol as an ayah indicator, since it is indeed the end of the ayah in another Qirā'ah (Riwāyah).

Here is the most famous example:

صِرَاطَ الَّذِينَ أَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ ۙ ﴿٥﴾ غَيْرِ
الْمَغْضُوبِ عَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا الضَّالِّينَ ﴿٧﴾ [31]

This means that in other Riwāyah, for example, Warshʿan Nāfiʿ, this is indeed an āyah:

ٱلصِّرَٰطَ ٱلْمُسْتَقِيمَ ﴿٥﴾ صِرَٰطَ ٱلَّذِينَ
أَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ ﴿٦﴾ غَيْرِ ٱلْمَغْضُوبِ
عَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا ٱلضَّآلِّينَ ﴿٧﴾

30 Al-Baqarah, 135
31 Al-Fātihah, 7

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Another example:

وَ اَنْزَلَ التَّوْرٰىةَ وَالْاِنْجِيْلَ ۙ﴿۳﴾ مِنْ قَبْلُ هُدًى
لِّلنَّاسِ وَاَنْزَلَ الْفُرْقَانَ ؕ﴿۵﴾ اِنَّ الَّذِيْنَ كَفَرُوْا
بِاٰيٰتِ اللّٰهِ لَهُمْ عَذَابٌ شَدِيْدٌ ؕ وَاللّٰهُ عَزِيْزٌ

32

Therefore, it is possible to stop at this symbol and continue from the point after it.

6 ۙ﴿۷﴾ **Stop + Do not End**

When an āyah ends with this symbol ۙ, it means that you can**not end** at this āyah. In other words, it is the sunnah to stop at the end of every āyah, but when this symbol ۙ is on top of the āyah symbol, then you may stop normally (since it is the sunnah), but you may **not** 'end' your recitation there, or, if in prayer, go to rukū'. So in the example indicated below, you may stop normally at the end of each āyah, but you may only end your recitation or go to rukū' at āyah (7) or āyah (10).

*If one decides not to stop at the end of the āyah, it is **not** harām or a sin. But you did not do what the Prophet ﷺ used do when reciting the Qur'ān.*

وَالَّيْلِ اِذَا يَغْشٰى ۙ﴿۱﴾ وَالنَّهَارِ اِذَا تَجَلّٰى ۙ﴿۲﴾ وَمَا
خَلَقَ الذَّكَرَ وَالْاُنْثٰى ۙ﴿۳﴾ اِنَّ سَعْيَكُمْ لَشَتّٰى ؕ﴿۴﴾ فَاَمَّا
مَنْ اَعْطٰى وَاتَّقٰى ۙ﴿۵﴾ وَصَدَّقَ بِالْحُسْنٰى ۙ﴿۶﴾ فَسَنُيَسِّرُهٗ
لِلْيُسْرٰى ؕ﴿۷﴾ وَاَمَّا مَنْۢ بَخِلَ وَاسْتَغْنٰى ۙ﴿۸﴾ وَكَذَّبَ
بِالْحُسْنٰى ۙ﴿۹﴾ فَسَنُيَسِّرُهٗ لِلْعُسْرٰى ؕ﴿۱۰﴾

33



32 Āl-i 'imrān, 3 -4
33 Al-Layl, 1-10

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CHAP

QUR'ĀN

PRONOUNCE (ALIF) ← ا

PRONOUNCE (WĀW) ← و

PRONOUNCE (YĀ') ← ے

PRONOUNCE (MĪM) ← م

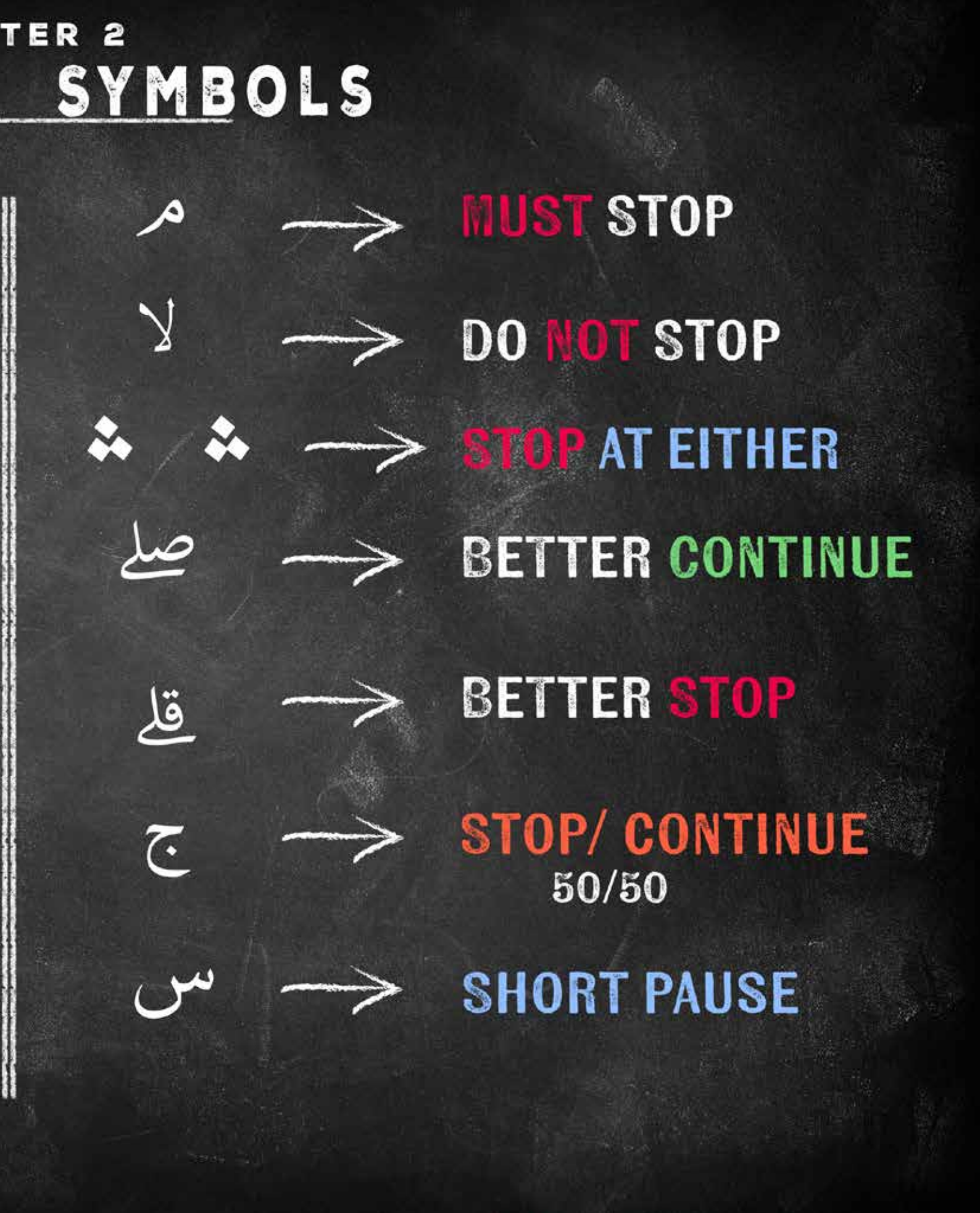
ELONGATE ← ـــ

END OF 1/8 JUZ' ←

DO SUJŪD ←

TER 2

SYMBOLS



DISCUSSION

Follow these steps to learn Chapter 2 effectively:

1. Learn the meaning of each symbol by heart; use pen and paper if necessary.
2. Browse through your Muṣ-ḥaf and look for the different symbols, try to remember what each symbol means.
3. Use the attached poster as practising the Qur'ānic symbols in the coming exercises.
4. Check your answers in the answer key (page 176)

Task 1: Match the symbols with the appropriate action (there are three actions too many).

1.	صلے	a.	better stop
2.	لا	b.	better keep going
3.	❊	c.	you must stop
4.	م	d.	stop at either
5.	ج	e.	momentary pause
6.	ه	f.	don't end here
7.	ح	g.	do nothing
8.	قلے	h.	pronounce Mīm
9.	ے	i.	pronounce sin
10.	س	j.	pronounce lām
11.	م	k.	stop/ keep on reading
12.	❖ ❖	l.	sukūn
		m.	do not pronounce
		n.	pronounce yā'
		o.	end of the sūrah

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Task 2: Recite aloud the following excerpts from the Qur'ān, while following the Qur'ānic symbols rules as much as you can.

1. قَالَ يَٰٓـَٔادَمُ أَنۢبِئۡهُم بِأَسۡمَآئِهِمۡۖ فَلَمَّآ أَنۢبَأَهُم بِأَسۡمَآئِهِمۡ قَالَ أَلَمۡ أَقُل لَّكُمۡ إِنِّيٓ أَعۡلَمُ غَيۡبَ ٱلسَّمَٰوَٰتِ وَٱلۡأَرۡضِ وَأَعۡلَمُ مَا تُبۡدُونَ وَمَا كُنتُمۡ تَكۡتُمُونَ

2. وَأَقِيمُواْ ٱلصَّلَوٰةَ وَءَاتُواْ ٱلزَّكَوٰةَ وَٱرۡكَعُواْ مَعَ ٱلرَّٰكِعِينَ ﴿٤٣﴾ ۞ أَتَأۡمُرُونَ ٱلنَّاسَ بِٱلۡبِرِّ وَتَنسَوۡنَ أَنفُسَكُمۡ وَأَنتُمۡ تَتۡلُونَ ٱلۡكِتَٰبَۚ أَفَلَا تَعۡقِلُونَ

3. هُوَ ٱلَّذِي خَلَقَكُم مِّن طِينٖ ثُمَّ قَضَىٰٓ أَجَلٗاۖ وَأَجَلٞ مُّسَمًّى عِندَهُۥۖ ثُمَّ أَنتُمۡ تَمۡتَرُونَ ﴿٢﴾

4. وَذَرِ ٱلَّذِينَ ٱتَّخَذُواْ دِينَهُمۡ لَعِبٗا وَلَهۡوٗا وَغَرَّتۡهُمُ ٱلۡحَيَوٰةُ ٱلدُّنۡيَاۚ وَذَكِّرۡ بِهِۦٓ أَن تُبۡسَلَ نَفۡسُۢ بِمَا كَسَبَتۡ لَيۡسَ لَهَا مِن دُونِ ٱللَّهِ وَلِيّٞ وَلَا شَفِيعٞ وَإِن تَعۡدِلۡ كُلَّ عَدۡلٖ لَّا يُؤۡخَذۡ مِنۡهَآۗ أُوْلَٰٓئِكَ ٱلَّذِينَ أُبۡسِلُواْ بِمَا كَسَبُواْۖ لَهُمۡ شَرَابٞ مِّنۡ حَمِيمٖ وَعَذَابٌ أَلِيمُۢ بِمَا كَانُواْ يَكۡفُرُونَ ﴿٧٠﴾

Challenge Question **Browse the first quarter of juz' number 29 (Sūrah Al-Mulk) from beginning to end. Find the symbols, and think of the meaning of each symbol. Afterwards, recite Sūrah Al-Mulk using the proper application of Qur'ān symbols**



- Recite to a teacher to get constant feedback on your recitation, you can also send your recitation through arabic101.org/ask-a-teacher
- Do not move to the next chapter till you have mastered the current one (the symbols of the Muṣ-ḥaf).
- Check your answers using the answer key, on page 176.

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3

Stopping & Resuming

In this chapter you will learn:

- The four actions of reciting the Qur'ān.
- Where you can start/ resume your recitation
- How to use 'stop & continue' technique
- How to use 'stop & repeat' and what to avoid.
- How to properly end your recitation.



Mamluk Muṣ-ḥaf dating back to 14th-century - British Museum

ORIENTATION

When you recite the Qur'ān, you will have to alternate between **four** actions:

Start	Pause/ Stop
This refers to starting or initiating your Qur'ān recitation whether from Muṣ-ḥaf or in prayer.	This refers to pausing your recitation (with the intent of resuming) either for taking a breath or another reason.
Resume	**Discontinue**
This refers to continuing your recitation after having paused/ stopped.	This refers to ending your recitation either for going to rukū (when in prayer) or if you simply end your recitation.

Each one of these four actions has to be performed properly, so that you do not start reciting at a point where the meaning makes no sense, or end at a point where the meaning is incomplete or distorted. In this chapter, we will tackle each of these actions and learn how to execute them properly.

1 Start

When you start reciting the Qur'ān, you may do so at any point **as long as** it is not connected to what was mentioned before it semantically[1] or grammatically. However, if you cannot understand the Qur'ān in Arabic yet, or if you are not sure, then following these instructions works best:

1. **Always** make sure to start at the beginning of an āyah.
2. **Never** start after an āyah with ۙ symbol on the previous āyah.

301

لَعَلَّكُمْ تَتَفَكَّرُونَ ۙ ﴿٢١٩﴾ فِي ٱلدُّنْيَا وَٱلْآخِرَةِ ۗ [2]

Āyah number 219, ends with the symbol ۙ which means that the meaning is not yet completed and continues to the next āyah. That is why you should not start reciting at فِي ٱلدُّنْيَا since this is the middle of the sentence, and starting to read at āyah 220 will not convey a complete meaning.

1 Semantics: refer to the meaning of a certain sentence.
2 Al-Baqarah, 219-220

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3. **You should not** start reciting at a word ending with kasrah (ِ) whether it is at the beginning of an āyah, or in the middle of an āyah.

إِلَىٰ صِرَٰطِ ٱلۡعَزِيزِ ٱلۡحَمِيدِ ١ ٱللَّهِ ٱلَّذِي لَهُۥ مَا فِي
ٱلسَّمَٰوَٰتِ وَمَا فِي ٱلۡأَرۡضِۗ [3]

In this example, āyah number (2) starts with the word ٱللَّهِ. However, it is grammatically impossible for a sentence to start with a word that has kasrah as case ending. This means that this word is related "grammatically" to the sentence before it, which happens to be āyah number (1).

Case ending *refers to the tashkīl that words receive based on their grammatical function in the sentence.*

2 Pause/ Stop

After starting your recitation, you have **two options** when it comes to pausing/ stopping:

1. **Stopping at the end of each āyah.**

This should be your first priority to make a stop when reciting the Qur'ān. This is because it is the sunnah and that is how the Prophet ﷺ used to recite the Qur'ān.

If it is the sunnah to stop at the end of each āyah, then how can the reciter stop at the end of an āyah with ۜ symbol right at the end of it?

If the ۜ symbol came at the end of an āyah, like in this example:

فَوَيۡلٞ لِّلۡمُصَلِّينَ ۜ ٤ ٱلَّذِينَ هُمۡ عَن صَلَاتِهِمۡ سَاهُونَ ٥ [4]

then you may normally stop at the end of that āyah **as long as you do not discontinue/ end your recitation** at that point altogether. So, you may pause, then continue from afterwards.

2. **Stopping at one of the other stopping symbols**

When the āyah is very long, or you run out of breath before you could pause/ stop at the end of the āyah, then using the stopping symbols is your next best option.

Remember these stopping symbols from Chapter 2? What other stopping symbols are there?



أَمۡ يَقُولُونَ ٱفۡتَرَىٰهُۖ قُلۡ إِنِ ٱفۡتَرَيۡتُهُۥ فَلَا تَمۡلِكُونَ لِي مِنَ ٱللَّهِ شَيۡـٔٗاۖ
هُوَ أَعۡلَمُ بِمَا تُفِيضُونَ فِيهِۖ كَفَىٰ بِهِۦ شَهِيدَۢا بَيۡنِي وَبَيۡنَكُمۡۖ وَهُوَ
ٱلۡغَفُورُ ٱلرَّحِيمُ ٨ [5]

3 Ibrāhim, 1-2
4 Al-Mā'ūn, 4-5
5 Al-Ahqāf, 8

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3 Resume

When you stop/ pause while reciting the Qur'ān, you have **two options** to be able to resume your recitation correctly:

1. **Resume at the beginning of the next āyah ﴿٣٣﴾.**

*Compare **resuming** to **starting** recitation - any differences?*

This option will always work even if the āyah you stopped at ended with ۙ symbol, it would still be acceptable to resume your recitation at the beginning of the next āyah.

2. **Resume after any stopping symbol.**

This option is the next best thing after the first option, since you can safely resume your recitation at **any** stopping symbol, without worrying about changing the meaning of the āyah.

What should you do if you can't stop at the end of an āyah or at a stopping symbol?

If you find yourself wanting to stop and then resume at a spot other than at the end of the āyah or at a stopping symbol, **then you need to follow one of these two methods to avoid unsound stopping/ resuming:**

☑ Stop & Continue

This method is used only if you are able to understand Arabic, and follow the meaning of the āyah. Using this method means you are allowed to stop in the middle of the āyah *(not at a certain symbol)* and then resume from after where you had stopped. This is possible as long as you do not split one sentence into two, which might change its intended meaning.

303

إِن تَمۡسَسۡكُمۡ حَسَنَةٞ تَسُؤۡهُمۡ وَإِن تُصِبۡكُمۡ سَيِّئَةٞ يَفۡرَحُواْ بِهَاۖ [6]

If good touches you, it distresses them; but if harm strikes you, they rejoice at it.

This example demonstrates a proper **stop & continue**. In this āyah, we may stop in the middle of the āyah after the word تَسُؤۡهُمۡ and then continue from the word وَإِن without affecting the meaning of the āyah as you can see in the translation of its meaning.

However, if you stopped in the middle of an āyah before the sentence is completed, you will make an unsound **stop & continue** like in this example:

إِنَّ ٱلَّذِينَ كَفَرُواْ سَوَآءٌ عَلَيۡهِمۡ ءَأَنذَرۡتَهُمۡ أَمۡ لَمۡ تُنذِرۡهُمۡ لَا يُؤۡمِنُونَ [7]

Indeed, those who disbelieve - it is all the same for them whether you warn them or do not warn them - they will not believe.

Unsound beginning (الابتِدَاءُ القَبِيح) *is starting / resuming your recitation in the middle of a sentence which does not deliver a full meaning.*

In this example, while stopping at that point عَلَيۡهِمۡ is not harām or prohibited, starting right after it, would be an **unsound beginning** since the entire āyah is only one sentence, and stopping without repeating anything from before you stopped, would distort the message of the āyah.

6 Āl-i 'imrān, 120
7 Al-Baqarah, 6

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So what is the solution if I want to stop anywhere in the āyah where the sentence is not yet completed or if I am not sure if it is the end of the sentence?

The solution is: Stop & Repeat

☑ Stop & Repeat

This method works whether you understand Arabic, or you read the Qur'ān without understanding it at all. So if you run out of breath or you have to make an emergency stop where it is not the end of the āyah or at a certain stopping symbol, then you may stop anywhere in the āyah, as long as you **repeat two or three words from before you had stopped.** When you do this, you make sure that the sentence is linked to what you have already read.

Notice how you can stop and resume in this longer āyah; check the overlapping colors to understand the concept of stopping & repeating.

These overlapping colors represent the parts which you will be repeating. So the first stop will be at the word تَجۡرِي, but you will resume your recitation starting from وَٱلۡفُلۡكِ , and so on.

304

إِنَّ فِي خَلۡقِ ٱلسَّمَٰوَٰتِ وَٱلۡأَرۡضِ وَٱخۡتِلَٰفِ ٱلَّيۡلِ وَٱلنَّهَارِ وَٱلۡفُلۡكِ ٱلَّتِي
تَجۡرِي فِي ٱلۡبَحۡرِ بِمَا يَنفَعُ ٱلنَّاسَ وَمَآ أَنزَلَ ٱللَّهُ مِنَ ٱلسَّمَآءِ مِن مَّآءٖ
فَأَحۡيَا بِهِ ٱلۡأَرۡضَ بَعۡدَ مَوۡتِهَا وَبَثَّ فِيهَا مِن كُلِّ دَآبَّةٖ وَتَصۡرِيفِ ٱلرِّيَٰحِ
وَٱلسَّحَابِ ٱلۡمُسَخَّرِ بَيۡنَ ٱلسَّمَآءِ وَٱلۡأَرۡضِ لَأٓيَٰتٖ لِّقَوۡمٖ يَعۡقِلُونَ[8]

Indeed, in the creation of the heavens and earth, and the alternation of the night and the day, and the [great] ships which sail through the sea with that which benefits people, and what Allāh has sent down from the heavens of rain, giving life thereby to the earth after its lifelessness and dispersing therein every [kind of] moving creature, and [His] directing of the winds and the clouds controlled between the heaven and the earth are signs for a people who use reason.

Stopping & repeating, specially in longer āyāt, ensures that despite splitting the sentence, it would still make sense and be understandable. This is because you have repeated parts from before you stopped, so the meaning will be linked to each other.

8 Al-Baqarah, 164

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CAUTION

The Qur'ān contains many āyāt containing the word قَالَ or قَالُوا (said/ they said) which means that the sentence that follows is a quote that Allāh is telling us about. Therefore, you should not isolate that statement; otherwise, it would deliver a corrupt meaning.

305

لَّقَدْ سَمِعَ ٱللَّهُ قَوْلَ ٱلَّذِينَ قَالُوٓاْ إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ فَقِيرٌ وَنَحْنُ أَغْنِيَآءُ [9]

Allāh has certainly heard the statement of those [Jews] who said, "Indeed, Allāh is poor, while we are rich."

Ideally, in this example, you will read it all in one breath, but if you must stop, you have to be sure that when you resume your recitation, you **do not begin from after the word** قَالُوٓاْ, like this:

لَّقَدْ سَمِعَ ٱللَّهُ قَوْلَ ٱلَّذِينَ قَالُوٓاْ إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ فَقِيرٌ وَنَحْنُ أَغْنِيَآءُ

Stopping at the word فَقِيرٌ is **acceptable**, but if you resumed your recitation at the word إِنَّ , the meaning that you are delivering is corrupt and wrong:

"Indeed, Allāh is poor, while we are rich."

because you took the quotation from its context and isolated it, while it is a quote that the Jews said about Allāh.

*The word **acceptable** here means that if you had to stop and had no other choice, that it will not necessarily change the meaning. Not stopping at all is the better option.*

Alternatively, you could apply the following **stop & continue**, so that you avoid isolating the statement after the word قَالُوٓاْ:

306

لَّقَدْ سَمِعَ ٱللَّهُ قَوْلَ ٱلَّذِينَ قَالُوٓاْ إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ فَقِيرٌ وَنَحْنُ أَغْنِيَآءُ

When you resume your recitation at the word قَالُوٓاْ it would be clear that the statement "***Indeed, Allāh is poor, while we are rich.***" is what they say about Allāh, and not what Allāh is saying about Himself, may He be exalted.

Some instances containing the word قَالُوٓاْ do not deliver an unsound meaning if they are isolated, but if you do not understand Arabic yet, it is better to avoid starting **after** the word قَالُوٓاْ as indicated before:

This examples shows that starting after the word قَالُوٓاْ is not always bad, but should be avoided for beginners.

ٱلَّذِينَ إِذَآ أَصَٰبَتْهُم مُّصِيبَةٌ قَالُوٓاْ إِنَّا لِلَّهِ وَإِنَّآ إِلَيْهِ رَٰجِعُونَ [10]

Who, when disaster strikes them, say, "Indeed we belong to Allāh, and indeed to Him we will return.

9 Āl-i 'imrān, 181
10 Al-Baqarah, 156

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4 Discontinue

When ending your recitation, you should keep the following points in mind:

1. **Never end your recitation at the لا symbol.**

فَوَيۡلٞ لِّلۡمُصَلِّينَ ٤ ٱلَّذِينَ هُمۡ عَن صَلَاتِهِمۡ سَاهُونَ ٥ [11]

Woe on those who prayer, who are heedless of their prayer –

In this example, ending your recitation at āyah number (4) would conclude your recitation with a warning to those who pray! And that is surely not the intended meaning.

2. **Never end your recitation in the middle of a sentence.**

DID YOU KNOW?

Many learners end their recitation with the phrase صَدَقَ اللَّهُ العَظِيم ; however, it was never reported that the Prophet ﷺ had ended his recitation with that phrase. When he ﷺ wanted to end his recitation, he would just stop reciting.

How can you perform a proper stop?

In Arabic, every word must have a **case ending**:

ٱلۡعَٰلَمِينَ يَسۡتَهۡزِئُۜ جَنَّٰتٍ عَلِيمٌ بَعۡضُكُمۡ

This case ending (the highlighted diacritic) indicates the grammatical function of the word in the sentence. However, when you stop at any Arabic word in the Qur'ān, regardless of which case ending it has (fat-ḥah, ḍammah, kasrah, tanwīn) then this case ending will turn into **sukūn**. Like this:

*This type of sukun is called **'Temporary Sukūn'** and in Arabic سُكُون عَارِض since it is not an original part of the word.*

ٱلۡعَٰلَمِينْ يَسۡتَهۡزِئۡ جَنَّتۡ عَلِيمْ بَعۡضُكُمۡ

Study this example:

307

وَمَا عَلَى ٱلرَّسُولِ إِلَّا ٱلۡبَلَٰغُ ٱلۡمُبِينُ [12]

In this example, if you stop at the word ٱلرَّسُولِ then the kasrah at the end of the word turns into sukūn ٱلرَّسُولْ. However, if you completed the fragment of the āyah till the end and you stopped at the word ٱلۡمُبِينُ instead, then the word ٱلرَّسُولِ will normally be pronounced with kasrah, and the word ٱلۡمُبِينُ will lose its ḍammah at its end since you are then stopping at it, and you would then pronounce it as ٱلۡمُبِينْ.

EXCEPTION

There is however, one exception to this rule, which is when the word ends with **alif** or **hamzah** with **tanwīn fat-ḥah** on it, like these words:

11 Al-Mā'ūn, 4-5
12 Al-'ankabūt, 18

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أَوْثَٰنًا مَآءً شُكْرًا كِسَفًا بِنَآءً

In this case, you will **always** add an alif at the end of the word, even if the word does not end with alif. Observe the following examples:

308

13 ٱللَّهُ ٱلَّذِى جَعَلَ لَكُمُ ٱلْأَرْضَ قَرَارًا وَٱلسَّمَآءَ بِنَآءً

Stopping at	قَرَارًا بِنَآءً	**Pronounce as:**	قَرَارَا بِنَآءَا
Keep on reading	قَرَارًا بِنَآءً		قَرَارَن بِنَآءَن

In this example, if you are stopping at tanwīn fat-ḥah (قَرَارًا | بِنَآءً) it means you will pronounce full alif at the end of the word, even if there is no alif at the end of the word (بِنَآءً).

14 وَإِذَا حُشِرَ ٱلنَّاسُ كَانُوا۟ لَهُمْ أَعْدَآءً وَكَانُوا۟ بِعِبَادَتِهِمْ كَٰفِرِينَ

Stopping at	أَعْدَآءً	**Pronounce as:**	أَعْدَآءَا
Keep on reading	أَعْدَآءً		أَعْدَآءَن

How can you perform a proper stop at ـة or ـه***?***

If a word ends with ـة or ـه and you want to stop at them, you will pronounce both of them as ـه which is the /h/ sound in Arabic. Consider these examples:

309

15 وَمِن قَبْلِهِۦ كِتَٰبُ مُوسَىٰٓ إِمَامًا وَرَحْمَةً ۚ

In this example, stopping at the word قَبْلِهِ means you will turn the kasrah to sukūn, and it will be pronounced as قَبْلِهْ.
If you keep on reading, however, the kasrah will be pronounced normally قَبْلِهِ. However, stopping at the word وَرَحْمَةً means it will be pronounced as رَحْمَهْ (with /h/ as the last letter) since you are stopping at it.

Chapter 15 contains more detailed explanation about this topic.

13 Ghāfir, 64
14 Al-Aḥqāf, 6
15 Al-Aḥqāf, 12

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CHAP

STOP /

إِنَّآ أَعۡطَيۡنَٰكَ ٱلۡكَوۡثَرَ ١ فَصَلِّ لِرَبِّكَ وَٱنۡحَرۡ ٢
إِنَّ شَانِئَكَ هُوَ ٱلۡأَبۡتَرُ ٣

STOP AT THE END OF EACH ĀYAH ١

30% 50% 70% 100%
م قلے ج صلے

STOP AT THESE SYMBOLS

WHERE?

NO SYBMOLS OR ١ **?**

STOP & REPEAT

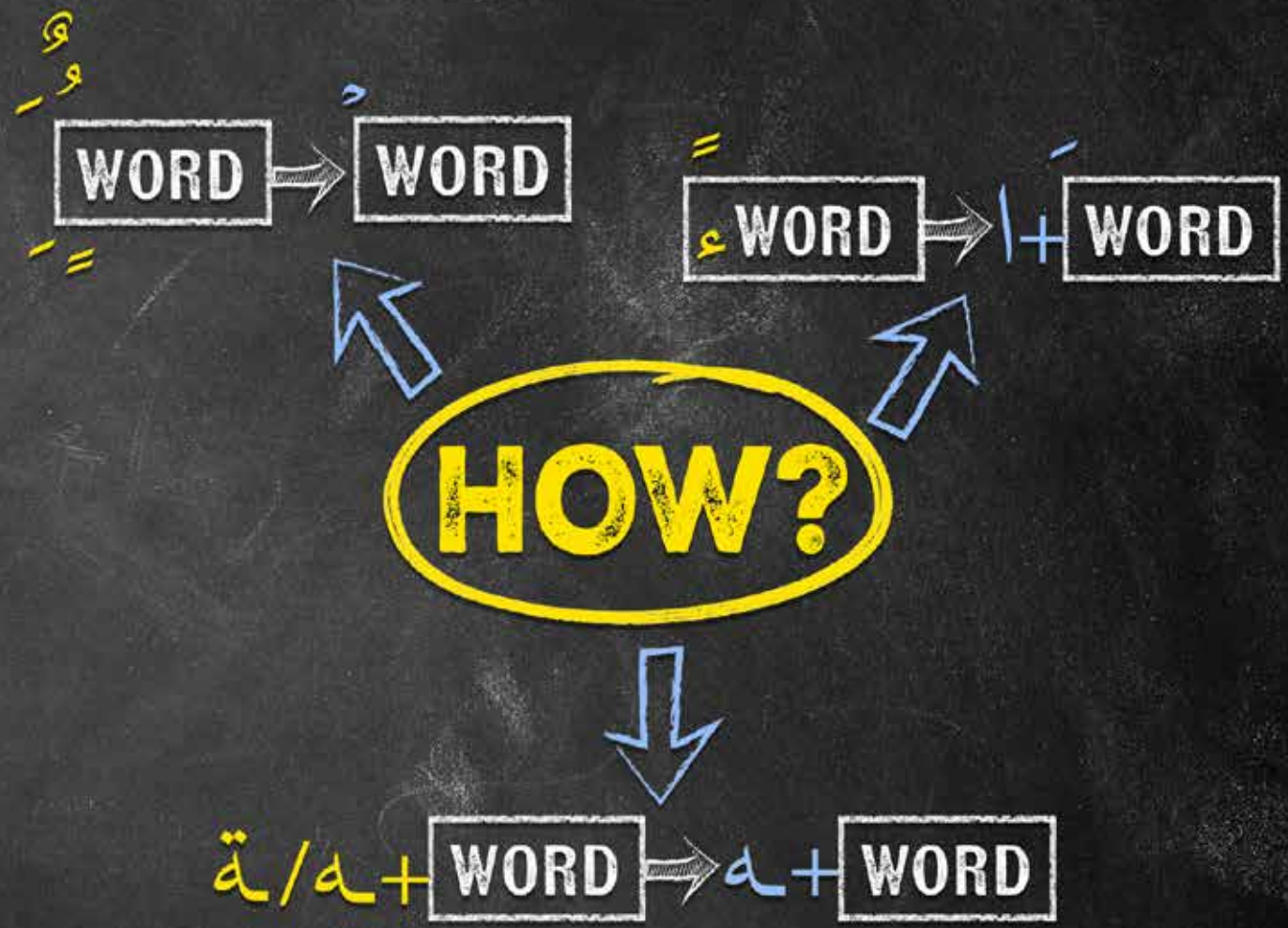
إِنَّ ٱلَّذِينَ كَفَرُواْ سَوَآءٌ عَلَيۡهِمۡ ءَأَنذَرۡتَهُمۡ أَمۡ لَمۡ تُنذِرۡهُمۡ لَا يُؤۡمِنُونَ ٦

REPEAT 2-3 WORDS

STOP &

TER 3

RESUME



CONTINUE

(ADVANCED)

إِن تَمْسَسْكُمْ حَسَنَةٌ تَسُؤْهُمْ وَإِن تُصِبْكُمْ سَيِّئَةٌ يَفْرَحُواْ بِهَا ۖ

- DO NOT SPLIT SENTENCES



Follow these steps to learn Chapter 3 effectively:

1. Study the rules of starting/ resuming one more time.
2. Use the attached poster as practicing the Qur'ānic symbols in the coming exercises.
3. Check your answers in the answer key (page 176)

Task 1: Study this āyah.

صِرَٰطَ ٱلَّذِينَ أَنۡعَمۡتَ عَلَيۡهِمۡ غَيۡرِ ٱلۡمَغۡضُوبِ عَلَيۡهِمۡ وَلَا ٱلضَّآلِّينَ ۝٧

According to the Riwāyah of Hafs ‘an ‘asim, this is the last āyah of Al-Fātihah. Many learners pause their recitation at the word عَلَيۡهِمۡ, and then resume at the word غَيۡرِ. Is this a sound stop/ resume? Why? Why not?

Task 2: In this āyah.

وَإِذَا لَقُواْ ٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوٓاْ قَالُوٓاْ ءَامَنَّا وَإِذَا خَلَا بَعۡضُهُمۡ إِلَىٰ بَعۡضٖ قَالُوٓاْ
أَتُحَدِّثُونَهُم بِمَا فَتَحَ ٱللَّهُ عَلَيۡكُمۡ لِيُحَآجُّوكُم بِهِۦ عِندَ رَبِّكُمۡۚ أَفَلَا تَعۡقِلُونَ

If you have to apply the stop & repeat technique when reading this āyah, which words will you avoid starting after? why?

Task 3: Study these two āyāt.

وَجَعَلَ فِيهَا رَوَٰسِيَ مِن فَوۡقِهَا وَبَٰرَكَ فِيهَا وَقَدَّرَ فِيهَآ أَقۡوَٰتَهَا فِيٓ أَرۡبَعَةِ
أَيَّامٖ سَوَآءٗ لِّلسَّآئِلِينَ ۝١٠

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قَالُواْ سَوَآءٌ عَلَيۡنَآ أَوَعَظۡتَ أَمۡ لَمۡ تَكُن مِّنَ ٱلۡوَٰعِظِينَ ١٣٦

If you must stop at the highlighted words, how would you pronounce it? And if you want to link them to what comes after, and how would you pronounce them?

Task 4: Sūrah Al-Mā'ida is known for its longer āyāt, it is, therefore, a very good place to practice your skills with stop/resume skills. Read this āyah while applying the proper stop/ resume techniques.

يَٰٓأَيُّهَا ٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوٓاْ إِذَا قُمۡتُمۡ إِلَى ٱلصَّلَوٰةِ فَٱغۡسِلُواْ وُجُوهَكُمۡ وَأَيۡدِيَكُمۡ إِلَى ٱلۡمَرَافِقِ وَٱمۡسَحُواْ بِرُءُوسِكُمۡ وَأَرۡجُلَكُمۡ إِلَى ٱلۡكَعۡبَيۡنِۚ وَإِن كُنتُمۡ جُنُبٗا فَٱطَّهَّرُواْۚ وَإِن كُنتُم مَّرۡضَىٰٓ أَوۡ عَلَىٰ سَفَرٍ أَوۡ جَآءَ أَحَدٞ مِّنكُم مِّنَ ٱلۡغَآئِطِ أَوۡ لَٰمَسۡتُمُ ٱلنِّسَآءَ فَلَمۡ تَجِدُواْ مَآءٗ فَتَيَمَّمُواْ صَعِيدٗا طَيِّبٗا فَٱمۡسَحُواْ بِوُجُوهِكُمۡ وَأَيۡدِيكُم مِّنۡهُۚ مَا يُرِيدُ ٱللَّهُ لِيَجۡعَلَ عَلَيۡكُم مِّنۡ حَرَجٖ وَلَٰكِن يُرِيدُ لِيُطَهِّرَكُمۡ وَلِيُتِمَّ نِعۡمَتَهُۥ عَلَيۡكُمۡ لَعَلَّكُمۡ تَشۡكُرُونَ ٦

Challenge Question **Sūrah Al-Baqarah contains the longest āyah in the Qur'ān.**

Which āyah is it? Try and read it completely while applying the Qur'ān symbols as well as the stop/ resume techniques.

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4

Madd (Elongation) - I

In this chapter you will learn:

- What is a Madd letter and a līn letter.
- The symbols of Madd letters.
- The two main types of Madd.
- What is Natural Madd.
  - » How to estimate the length of Madd.
  - » Important rules related to Madd letters.



A rare muṣ-ḥaf written in Kufi style, which goes back to nearly the 9th century - British Museum

ORIENTATION

Madd is a very important skill to learn, and it is perhaps the only tajweed term explicitly mentioned in the sunnah. Imām al-Bukhārī in his Ṣaḥīḥ entitled a chapter with مَدُّ القِرَاءَة (The Madd of recitation) in which he reported the following narration:

> *Qatādah narrates that he asked Anas b. Mālik about the recitation of the Prophet, and Anas replied:*
> *'He would stretch the words when reciting.'* (كَانَ يَمدُ مَدًّا) [1]

What does 'Madd' actually mean?

The word (مَدّ) 'Madd' is an Arabic word which literally means **'extend'** or **'elongate.'** In terms of tajweed, it refers to the elongation of three letters but only under certain conditions. In this chapter, we'll majorly focus on these three basic letters:

ا و ى

What is the difference between Madd letters, or līn letters?

These letters, in the state of sukūn, will either function as **Madd letters**, or **līn letters**.

Madd letter (حَرفُ مَدّ)			**Līn letter** (حَرفُ لِين)		
When any of these three letters: • Have no short vowel on them. • Are preceded by a short vowel of the same nature. They may function as **Madd letters.**			When the two letters ى or و: • Have no short vowel on them. • Are preceded by fat-ḥah. They may function as **līn letter.**		
ـِـى	ـُـو	ـَـا	ـَـى	ـَـو	Alif can't be a līn letter.
عِيسَىٰ	مُوسىٰ	مَا	قُرَيش	مَوت	–
In Uthmāni Codex, they could come in form of symbols.			There do not have equivalent symbols in the Uthmāni Codex.		
ے	و	ا			
إِۦلَفِهِمْ	يَلُوُنَ	مَلِكِ			
Madd letters and their associated symbols can receive Madd.			Līn letters cannot receive Madd except for one case. (Chapter 4)		

Short vowel = tashkīl/ diacritics

Līn letters will be further explained at the end of the next chapter.

1 (Sahīh) Hadīth of Anas b. Mālik related by al-Bukhārī 4657, al-Nasā'ī 1004, Abū Dāwūd 1253, Ibn Mājah 1343 and Ahmad 11753, 11835, 11891, 12532, 12577, 13562.

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There is an easy way to remember the three madd letters and their conditions, which are summarized into one single word:

401

نُوحِيهَا[2]

In this word we can see the following:

- (نُو) The و is preceded by ن with ḍammah **[which is the same sort of vowel as و]**
- (حِي) The ى is preceded by ح with kasrah **[which is the same sort of vowel as ى]**
- (هَا) The ا was preceded by هـ with fat-ḥah **[which is the same sort as ا]**

So, these three letters function as Madd letters **only** under these conditions. This chapter deals with these three letters when they are in the state of Madd.

DID YOU KNOW?

These are some key facts about Madd letters which will help you understand their work even better:

- Madd letters are essentially the long vowels in Arabic. They are the longer version of the short vowels.

- Since Madd letters have to be preceded by a letter that has a short vowel of the same nature, it is impossible to start a word with a Madd letter.

- Madd letters having no short vowels on them actually means that they are in a state of sukūn. This, however, does not mean that they are consonants.

- In Arabic, it is not possible to start a word with a letter with sukūn. And this is another reason why Madd letters may never come at the beginning of a word.

To be able to pronounce Madd letters properly in the Qur'ān, you must apply one of two main types of Madd on these letters:

☑ Natural Madd المَدّ الطَّبِيعِي

☑ Secondary Madd المَدّ الفَرعِي

In this chapter, we'll focus on the first kind: Natural Madd, and in the next chapter, we'll highlight Secondary Madd.

2 Hūd, 49

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Natural Madd

In Arabic, Natural Madd is المَدُّ الأَصلِي *or* المَدُّ الطَّبِيعِي

Natural Madd is the first and most important type of Madd. It is also called 'basic Madd' because it is the basic component of the Madd letters themselves, and without this characteristic, the letter cannot be pronounced properly, which may potentially change the meaning of the word, and as a result the āyah.

What is لَحنٌ جَلِيّ*?*

That is why, applying this type of Madd **is mandatory**, and it cannot be skipped or shortened. If this Madd is not properly applied, it is considered as لَحنٌ جَلِيّ or a clear mistake that is Harām to make because it will change the meaning of the āyah.

How long should you extend 'Natural Madd' for?

We measure the length of Madd by using a measurement unit called حَرَكَات (ḥarakāt), or in English (counts) and in singular حَرَكَة. A single ḥarakah (count) is how long it takes you to pronounce one letter with a short vowel, for example بَ - which is about half a second.[3]

The duaration of a single ḥarakah depends on the speed at which you are reciting, and so it affects the length of madd.

This means that 2 ḥarakāt = بَ + بَ (which is about 1 second)

And 4 ḥarakāt = بَ + بَ + بَ + بَ (which is about 2 seconds)

The duration of a single count (ḥarakah) could be linked to a hand movement, like the time it takes to hold or extend a finger, which makes it easier to keep track of how long your Madd should be while reciting the Qur'ān.

This method is less reliable because it might differ from one person to another. That's why, learning the length of madd by listening to a shaikh is the best practice.



One harakah (One count)



Two ḥarakāt (Two counts)

The duration of elongating Natural Madd.

Natural Madd is extended for 2 ḥarakāt (حَرَكَات) / **counts.**

This means that saying بَا (containing a Natural Madd) should take about the same as (بَ + بَ) in length.

To understand how important Natural Madd is, let us consider the following comparison between when you properly extend the Natural Madd, and when you do not extend it long enough:

3 Strictly speaking, we do not measure Madd in seconds, but these are only estimations to help you understand since they can differ slightly from one person to another.

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402

Notice the difference in the meaning of this āyah

يَقُولُواْ قَدْ أَخَذْنَا أَمْرَنَا مِن قَبْلُ	يَقُولُواْ قَدْ أَخَذْنَ أَمْرَنَا مِن قَبْلُ
they say "We took our matter [in hand] before,"	*they say "the women took our matter [in hand] before,"*
Here, the word أَخَذْنَا ends with a Natural Madd, which is the alif, that must be extended for two counts.	If the highlighted word didn't receive the proper Natural Madd, and you extended shorter than 2 counts, it will change the meaning.

CAUTION

Natural Madd should not be over-extended either. Over-extending means that you extend the Natural Madd letter for more than 2 counts (حَرَكَات). While this mistake will not change the meaning of the āyah, it should still be avoided:

403

This is actually a common mistake that should be avoided in Al-Fātiḥah

صِرَٰطَ ٱلَّذِينَ أَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ	صِرَٰطَ ٱلَّذِينَ أَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ
The path of those upon whom You have bestowed favor,	*The path of those upon whom You have bestowed favor,*
The word صِرَٰطَ should receive a Natural Madd of 2 counts only, not more.	If you did indeed extend longer, it will not change the meaning of the āyah but it should still be avoided.

Check if the two conditions are met in the highlighted cases in this āyah

Let us study the following examples to understand this even more:

404

4 وَلَهُمْ عَذَابٌ عَظِيمٌ

405

5 وَمِنَ ٱلنَّاسِ مَن يَقُولُ ءَامَنَّا بِٱللَّهِ وَبِٱلْيَوْمِ ٱلْءَاخِرِ وَمَا هُم بِمُؤْمِنِينَ

In this examples we notice the following:

- Natural Madd cases are highlighted in **Green**.
- The Madd letters themselves are free from any **short vowels/ diacritics**.
- Every Madd letter is preceded by a letter carrying a short vowel (tashkīl) of the same sort.
- This means that all the highlighted cases are cases of Natural Madd, so they must be extended for exactly 2 ḥarakāt (counts).

4 Al-Baqarah, 7
5 Al-Baqarah, 8

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Before reading the explanation of the example; do the highlighted letters meet the Natural Madd conditions?

Now compare the previous examples, to the following one to see the difference:

فَعَمِيَتۡ عَلَيۡهِمُ ٱلۡأَنۢبَآءُ يَوۡمَئِذٖ فَهُمۡ لَا يَتَسَآءَلُونَ ٦٦ [6]

406

In this example, we can observe the following:

- In the word فَعَمِيَتۡ: Although the letter before the ى does have a kasrah, the ى does have a diacritic (fat-ḥah)on top of it. **That is why we cannot extend ى in this case.**

What do we call yā' in the word عَلَيۡهِمُ?

- In the word عَلَيۡهِمُ: Although the ى does have a sukūn, the letter before it does **not** have kasrah; it has fat-ḥah, **so there is no Natural Madd here.**
- In the word يَوۡمَئِذٖ and يَتَسَآءَلُونَ : There is no Natural Madd because you cannot extend a Madd letter at the beginning of a word. Also, it has fat-ḥah on it.

Remember

If a word **ends** with a Madd letter (in the case of wāw or yā'), but this Madd letter has fat-ḥah on it, you should **not** elongate it as a Natural Madd since it should have sukūn not fat-ḥah for it to be elongated. However, if you decided to stop at that word, **this fat-ḥah will turn into sukūn** which means that you should now elongate that letter for 2 counts as a Natural Madd.

This is particularly famous for the words هُوَ and هِيَ, but it may occur with other words too. Study the following examples:

407

Stopping at the highlighted words in the second and third example can only be an emergency stop - revise Chapter 3.

لَآ إِلَٰهَ إِلَّا هُوَۚ سُبۡحَٰنَهُۥ عَمَّا يُشۡرِكُونَ [7]

فَقُل لَّن تَخۡرُجُواْ مَعِيَ أَبَدٗا وَلَن تُقَٰتِلُواْ مَعِيَ عَدُوًّاۖ [8]

408

409

إِنَّهُۥ يَبۡدَؤُاْ ٱلۡخَلۡقَ ثُمَّ يُعِيدُهُۥ لِيَجۡزِيَ ٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُواْ [9]

In these examples, we can observe the following:

*This case does not apply to the letter alif, simply because it cannot function as anything other than a Madd letter, so every alif in the Qur'ān receives Natural Madd, **at all times**.*

- If you do **NOT** stop at these words: هُوَ - مَعِيَ - لِيَجۡزِيَ you may **not** treat the highlighted letters as Madd letters, since they have fat-ḥah on them.
- If you do **stop** at the words: هُوَ - مَعِيَ - لِيَجۡزِيَ you must treat them as Madd letters and elongate them as Natural Madd for **2 counts.**

6 Al-Qasas, 66
7 At-Tawbah, 31
8 At-Tawbah, 83
9 Yūnus, 4

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DISCUSSION

Follow these steps to learn Chapter 4 effectively:

1. Study the rules of starting/ resuming one more time.
2. Use your notes on this chapter to answer the questions correctly.
3. Check your answers in the answer key (page 176)

Task 1: Determine if these statements are 'true' or 'false', and correct the sentence when applicable.

1. The letters alif, wāw and yā' can both function as Madd letters and līn letters. ( )
2. It is not possible to end a word with a Madd letter. ( )
3. Līn letters may be extended in some cases. ( )
4. Every case of alif is a case of Natural Madd. ( )
5. Sometimes Madd letters will not be extended as Natural Madd. ( )
6. Madd letters must have a sukūn symbol on them. ( )
7. Natural Madd is a mandatory Madd of exactly 2 counts. ( )
8. The word هُوَ does not contain Natural Madd. ( )

Task 2: Study Sūrah Al-Ma'ūn, and answer the following questions:

بِسْمِ ٱللَّهِ ٱلرَّحْمَٰنِ ٱلرَّحِيمِ

أَرَءَيْتَ ٱلَّذِى يُكَذِّبُ بِٱلدِّينِ ﴿١﴾ فَذَٰلِكَ ٱلَّذِى يَدُعُّ ٱلْيَتِيمَ ﴿٢﴾ وَلَا يَحُضُّ عَلَىٰ طَعَامِ ٱلْمِسْكِينِ ﴿٣﴾ فَوَيْلٌ لِّلْمُصَلِّينَ ﴿٤﴾ ٱلَّذِينَ هُمْ عَن صَلَاتِهِمْ سَاهُونَ ﴿٥﴾ ٱلَّذِينَ هُمْ يُرَآءُونَ ﴿٦﴾ وَيَمْنَعُونَ ٱلْمَاعُونَ ﴿٧﴾

1. How many cases of Natural Madd can you find in this sūrah?
2. Find two instances of līn letters.

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Task 3: Which of the following contains a Madd letter:

جُوعٍ	عَالِيَةٍ	قُوَّةٍ	فَأَمَّا	قَالُواْ	حَتَّىٰ
ٱلْقَوْمَ	فَعَّالٌ	يَلْوُۥنَ	لَيْلَةٍ	فَكَيْفَ	إِلَٰهِهِمْ

Task 4: Which of the following contains a līn letter:

غَضْبَٰنَ	إِلَيْهِ	يَٰمُوسَىٰ	شَىْءٍ	قَالُواْ	ٱلْغَيِّ
يُؤْمِنُواْ	ٱصْطَفَيْتُكَ	قَالَ	سَأُوْرِيكُمْ	فَكَيْفَ	مَّوْعِظَةٌ

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5

Madd (Elongation) - II

In this chapter you will learn:

- What is Secondary Madd?
- What are the types of Secondary Madd
  - » Madd caused by Hamzah
  - » Madd caused by Sukūn
- How to deal with Madd letter symbols.
- How to deal with līn letters properly.



A rare muṣ-ḥaf written using Kufi Calligraphy - date uknown

Secondary Madd

What are the conditions for ا و ى to be used as Madd letters? Revise Chapter 4

While Natural Madd is the basic component in any Madd letter, *in certain situations*, **Madd letters** should be extended for more than their basic Natural Madd of 2 counts. When this happens, the rules of Secondary Madd should apply.

Unlike Natural Madd, Secondary Madd is easier to find because it is, *in most cases*, used along with the Madd symbol ~ which appears on top of the Madd letter. This would then be an indication that this Madd letter should be extended for more than 2 counts.

DID YOU KNOW?

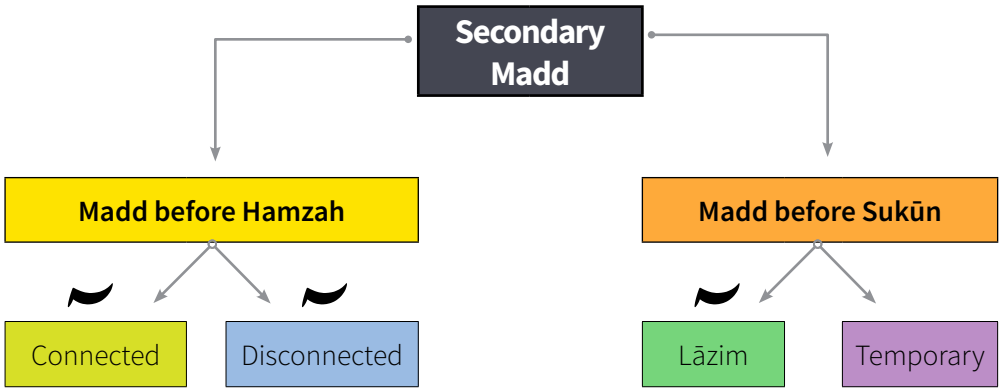
The symbol of Madd ~ has actually evolved from the word مَدّ :



A Madd letter will acquire Secondary Madd, when it is used:

1. Before Hamzah
2. Before Sukūn

This chart maps out the types of Secondary Madd that we'll discuss in this chapter:



The Madd symbol lets you know which types of Secondary Madd use the symbol ~ and which do not.

In this chapter, we'll highlight the two main divisions of Secondary Madd: Secondary Madd caused by hamzah, and Secondary Madd caused by sukūn.

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1 Madd Before Hamzah

When a Madd letter comes **before** hamzah, this Madd letter must get extended for 4 – 5 counts. This means that you will extend the Madd letter for twice as much as its natural state (2 counts). And since you will not have to hold a stopwatch while reciting the Qur'ān, you should keep track of these counts, using the methods we referred to in chapter 4.

There are two types of Madd caused by hamzah:

Connected Madd المَدُّ المُتَّصِلُ	**Disconnected Madd** المَدُّ المُنفَصِلُ
As the name suggests, **connected Madd** means that both of the Madd components (Madd letter & hamzah) occur within the same word. In other words, both Madd letter and hamzah are connected, like: 501 جَآءَ ٱلسُّوٓءَ 502 أُوْلَٰٓئِكَ حَلَٰٓئِلُ This means, if you pronounce a word with a connected Madd on its own, you will still have to elongate the Madd letter in it.	**Disconnected Madd** is a type of Madd in which Madd components occur across two words, which means that the Madd letter is at the end of the first word, and the hamzah is at the beginning of the following word that follows it, like: مَآ أَغۡنَىٰ بِمَآ أُنزِلَ يُرِيدَآ إِصۡلَٰحَا حَتَّىٰٓ إِذَا In these examples, reading the word containing the Madd letter alone, is not enough to extend the Madd letter longer than its Natural Madd.
You extend this type of Madd for **5 Harakāt**	You extend this type of Madd for **4 Harakāt**
It is Mandatory That is why one of the names of this type of Madd is مَدٌّ وَاجِبٌ Which directly translates to **mandatory Madd**.	**It is Optional** Another name for this type of Madd is مَدٌّ جَائِزٌ Which directly translates to **Optional Madd**.

TIP

As a beginner, you should always extend all types of Madd, connected and disconnected, since it trains you on getting the length of Madd right, and it gives you a good pace for your recitation.

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Let us consider the following examples for both types of **Madd before hamzah**:

Can you find two instances of Natural Madd in these mentioned examples?

503

504

505

1 ٱلَّذِينَ إِذَآ أَصَٰبَتۡهُم مُّصِيبَةٞ قَالُوٓاْ إِنَّا لِلَّهِ وَإِنَّآ إِلَيۡهِ رَٰجِعُونَ

2 يَٰبَنِيٓ إِسۡرَٰٓءِيلَ ٱذۡكُرُواْ نِعۡمَتِيَ ٱلَّتِيٓ أَنۡعَمۡتُ عَلَيۡكُمۡ

3 وَجَآءُوٓ أَبَاهُمۡ عِشَآءٗ يَبۡكُونَ

In this example we can see the following:

Observing the Madd symbol ~ is an easy way to locate these two types of Madd.

- Madd letters **always** have ~ symbol when followed by hamzah.
- Hamzah does not only look like ء but it can take other shapes too, like إ or أ.
- The disconnected Madd: {إِذَآ أَصَٰبَتۡهُم}, {قَالُوٓاْ إِنَّا}, {إِنَّآ إِلَيۡهِ}, {ٱلَّتِيٓ أَنۡعَمۡتُ}, happens accross two words where the first word ends with a Madd letter, and the next word starts with hamzah. They are all elongated (optionally) for **4 counts**.
- The connected Madd: {عِشَآءٗ} happens within one word, and is **always** elongated for **5 counts.**
- Certain cases contain both connected and disconnected Madd: {جَآءُوٓ أَبَاهُمۡ}, {يَٰبَنِيٓ إِسۡرَٰٓءِيلَ}, which means that the alif in {جَآءُوٓ} and {إِسۡرَٰٓءِيلَ} are **always** elongated **for 5 counts** while the wāw in {جَآءُوٓ} and the yā' in {يَٰبَنِيٓ} are (optionally) elongated **for 4 counts.**

CAUTION

When we say that 'disconnected Madd' is optional, it means that if you choose not to elongate the disconnected Madd, you should still treat it as 'Natural Madd' and elongate it for 2 ḥarakāt.

Saying that disconnected Madd is 'Optional' does NOT mean that you may apply it in one āyah, and then in the next you drop it. That is not allowed in one recitation. You have to be consistent in your recitation, whether you choose to extend it for 4 counts, or to drop it and only extend for 2 counts, you have to keep your choice until the end of your recitation/ session.

1 Al-Baqarah, 156
2 Al-Baqarah, 40
3 Yūsuf, 16

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There is a number of frequently occurring phrases in the Qur'ān that **seem** like they are connected Madd, while they are in fact **disconnected Madd**. It is highly advisable to study this set of phrases and know that they belong to the category of disconnected Madd:

يَـٰٓأَيُّهَا	
يَآ	أَيُّهَا

This very common phrase which means "O! who you ..". This phrase is actually made up of two separate words, and not one. Both components of the Madd (Madd letter and hamzah) are **not** in the same word. This word is written in this way since this is part of the Uthmāni Codex.

This particular phrase has other variations as well, and all involve the use of the vocative particle يَا added to a word starting with hamzah. And in terms of the type of Madd applied, they all share the same feature - disconnected Madd:

What other examples can you find in the Qur'ān? Can you find another in Sūrah Al-Ḥijr and Sūrah Maryam.

يَـٰٓـَٔادَمُ يَـٰٓأَهْلَ يَـٰٓأَسَفَىٰ يَـٰٓأَيُّهَ

يَـٰٓأَبَتِ يَـٰٓأَبَانَآ يَـٰٓأُولِى يَـٰٓإِبْرَٰهِيمُ يَـٰٓأَرْضُ

هَـٰٓؤُلَآءِ	
هَآ	أُولَآءِ

This phrase contains two cases of Madd: the first case is disconnected Madd, and the second case is connected Madd. The first case is a disconnected Madd because it occurs across two different words.

هَـٰٓأَنتُمْ	
هَآ	أَنتُمْ

This is a less common phrase, but it also belongs to this list of phrases that are written as one word. Similar to the previous word هَـٰٓؤُلَآءِ, this one contains هَآ as the first word. This means that this Madd can be extended to 4 counts.

How many Natural Madd cases can you find in this āyah?

506

وَقَالَ فِرْعَوْنُ يَـٰٓأَيُّهَا ٱلْمَلَأُ مَا عَلِمْتُ لَكُم مِّنْ إِلَـٰهٍ غَيْرِى فَأَوْقِدْ لِى يَـٰهَـٰمَـٰنُ عَلَى ٱلطِّينِ فَٱجْعَل لِّى صَرْحًا لَّعَلِّىٓ أَطَّلِعُ إِلَىٰٓ إِلَـٰهِ مُوسَىٰ [4]

In this example, we see the following:

- There are three instances of disconnected Madd.
- If you decided to **elongate** the first one يَـٰٓأَيُّهَا you must elongate every other disconnected Madd until you end your recitation.
- However, if you **did not elongate** the first one يَـٰٓأَيُّهَا you must still elongate them **for 2 counts, as Natural Madd,** and you should also not elongate any other disconnected Madd until the end of your recitation.

4 Al-Qasas, 38

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2 Madd Before Sukūn

Secondary Madd can also be caused by sukūn, which means that if a Madd letter is followed by a letter with **sukūn** then a Secondary Madd is generated.

What does a letter with sukūn look like?

There are two types of sukūn that can trigger this type of Secondary Madd:

1. Sukūn symbol ْ : This is the most common type of sukūn in the Qur'ān - It was discussed in chapter 2.

ءَآلْـَٰٔنَ

2. Shaddah symbol ّ : Although shaddah itself is not a symbol of sukūn, it necessarily contains sukūn within. The reason is that shaddah is produced by doubling the same letter, and first of two letters must have sukūn.

Notice how the shaddah looks like when it is broken down to it original form.

قَّ		Shaddah	ٱلْحَآقَّةُ
قَ	قْ	broken down	ٱلْحَآقْقَةُ

There are two types of Madd caused by sukūn: Madd Lāzim and Temporary Madd.

1 Madd Lāzim

This type of Secondary Madd is then called مَدٌّ لَازِم which is translated into **Binding/ Necessary Madd** to indicate that applying this type of Madd is **mandatory**, so it cannot be skipped, shortened or considered as Natural Madd. When this Madd is applied, you elongate the Madd letter for **6 counts**.

DID YOU KNOW?

Extending a letter for 6 counts is the longest you will ever have to extend any letter in the entire Qur'ān. So if anything was extended for more than 6 counts, then you will be certain that this is a mistake.

Let us study the following examples to understand this type of Madd even more:

507 صِرَٰطَ ٱلَّذِينَ أَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ غَيْرِ ٱلْمَغْضُوبِ عَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا ٱلضَّآلِّينَ [5]

508 قُلْ أَتُحَآجُّونَنَا فِى ٱللَّهِ وَهُوَ رَبُّنَا وَرَبُّكُمْ [6]

5 Al-Fātihah, 7
6 Al-Baqarah, 139

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In these two examples, we can observe the following:

- We elongate the Madd letter (alif in both cases) for 6 counts because there is a **'necessary/ binding Madd.'**
- We see both components of necessary Madd are present: Madd letter followed by sukūn (which is integrated into the shaddah)

509 ءَآلْـَٔـنَ وَقَدْ عَصَيْتَ قَبْلُ وَكُنتَ مِنَ ٱلْمُفْسِدِينَ ﴿٩١﴾ [7]

510 ءَآللَّهُ أَذِنَ لَكُمْ [8]

In these two examples we can further observe two more cases of Madd which must be extended for 6 ḥarakāt (6 counts) since alif in this case is followed by a sukūn.

DID YOU KNOW?

Madd Lāzim is impossible to occur across two words (unlike disconnected Madd), and the reason is that is that there are no words in Arabic that start with sukūn or shaddah. This means that the trigger of necessary Madd will have to occur within the word but never at the beginning.

2 Temporary Madd

What is 'Temporary Sukūn'? See page 37.

This type of Secondary Madd is called temporary because it is caused by the **temporary sukūn** that occurs when you stop at a certain word. For the Madd to happen, the Madd letter must be the **letter before last**. When Temporary Madd is applied, you either **elongate it for 2, 4 or 6 counts.** Study the following example:

511 ٱلْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ ٱلْعَٰلَمِينَ [9]

512 وَبِٱلْـَٔاخِرَةِ هُمْ يُوقِنُونَ [10]

513 وَإِذْ ءَاتَيْنَا مُوسَى ٱلْكِتَٰبَ وَٱلْفُرْقَانَ لَعَلَّكُمْ تَهْتَدُونَ [11]

Temporary Madd is most common at the end of āyāt since we stop at the end of each āyah.

7 Yūnus, 91
8 Yūnus, 59
9 Al-Fātihah, 1/2
10 Al-Baqarah, 4
11 Al-Baqarah, 53

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In these examples, we observe the following:

- We notice that the highlighted words وَٱلْفُرْقَانَ , ٱلْعَٰلَمِينَ , يُوقِنُونَ , تَهْتَدُونَ all have a Madd letter in the before to last position. Stopping at any of these words means that you will extend them for 2, 4 or 6 ḥarakāt.
- In the third example, if you did **not** stop at the word وَٱلْفُرْقَانَ then you will extend it as a case of Natural Madd for 2 ḥarakāt.



Saying that you have the option to choose between 2, 4 or 6 counts in the case of temporary Madd, does not mean that you are allowed to choose a different length of Madd in the same recitation. Staying consistent in your recitation is very important. So if you started with extending temporary into 6 counts. You should keep this choice until you end your recitation.

Proper use of Madd letter symbols

In certain cases, the Madd letter symbols و ے may occur **between two words.** When that happens, these symbols are pronounced only when you **connect the two words**, if you stop at the first of the two, there will be no Madd whatsoever.

These are the two cases for this type of situation:

Not followed by hamzah	**Followed by hamzah**
و ے When these symbols are **not** followed by a hamzah:	وَۤ ےَۤ When these symbols are followed by a hamzah, they will have a Madd symbol on them:
بِهِۦ وَذِكْرَىٰ خَلَقْتَهُو مِن إِنَّهُو يَرَىٰكُمْ	بِهِۦٓ إِيمَٰنُكُمْ أَضْطَرُّهُۥٓ إِلَىٰ مُلْكِهِۦٓ أَن
Extend them for 2 counts (If you stop at the first word, then there is no Madd)	**Extend them for 2 or 4 counts** (If you stop at the first word, then there is no Madd)

To understand this concept even better, study the following examples:

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514

إِذْ قَالَ لَهُۥ رَبُّهُۥٓ أَسْلِمْ ۖ [12]

In these example, we observe the following:

- We may read and extend the symbols only if we keep on reading.
- We can extend them both for 2 counts.
- We must extend the first لَهُۥ for 2 counts, and the second رَبُّهُۥٓ we can extend it for 2 or 4 counts.
- If we stop at either of these words لَهُۥ and/ or رَبُّهُۥٓ, then we ignore the symbols and apply no Madd.



When symbols are used within the word itself, they are part of the word, and cannot be skipped or shortened. They are treated exactly like any other Madd letter: extend for two counts.

Study and compare the cases of these examples:

515

أَلَمْ تَرَ إِلَى ٱلَّذِى حَآجَّ إِبْرَٰهِـۧمَ فِى رَبِّهِۦٓ أَنْ ءَاتَىٰهُ ٱللَّهُ ٱلْمُلْكَ [13]

516

ٱلْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ ٱلْعَٰلَمِينَ [14]

517

لَا يَسْتَوُۥنَ عِندَ ٱللَّهِ [15]

In these examples, we observe the following:

- The symbols highlighted in green are always extended for 2 counts since they are part of the word itself, and didn't occur between words.
- The case of رَبِّهِۦٓ أَنْ can be extended for 2 or 4 counts, but only if you link it to the word the follows it. If you stop at it, there is no Madd.

12 Al-Baqarah, 131
13 Al-Baqarah, 258
14 Al-Fātihah, 2/1
15 At-Tawbah, 19

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Līn Letters

*The word **sākinah** means: in a state of sukūn, which also means that they do not have tashkīl symbols on them.*

Līn letters literally means 'easy letters' and they are given that name to refer to the easiness with which one pronounces them. Līn letters are **wāw sākinah** and **yā' sākinah** when they are preceded by a letter with **fat-ḥah**.

Līn letters [ـَـو ـَـي] are pronounced normally without any Madd or applying any special rule, **except** for one single case:

When the līn letter is the letter before last in a word, and you stop at that word, then you will have to extend that līn letter for 2, 4, or 6 counts.

Study the following examples:

518 16 قَالَ لَبِثْتُ يَوْمًا أَوْ بَعْضَ يَوْمٍ ۖ

519 17 وَمَا تُنفِقُوا۟ مِنْ خَيْرٍ فَلِأَنفُسِكُمْ ۚ

520 18 لِإِيلَٰفِ قُرَيْشٍ ۝١ إِۦلَٰفِهِمْ رِحْلَةَ ٱلشِّتَآءِ وَٱلصَّيْفِ ۝٢

Compare this case of Madd to temporary Madd. What is the difference?

In these examples, we notice the following:

- The word يَوْمًا contains a līn letter. But even if we stopped at the word, we will not extend the lin letter at all, because the līn letter is not the letter before last.
- Stopping at these words: ٱلصَّيْفِ , قُرَيْشٍ , خَيْر , يَوْمِ means that you may extend them for 2, 4 or 6 counts.
- If you decided not to stop, and to keep on reciting, then there is no Madd whatsoever.

DID YOU KNOW?

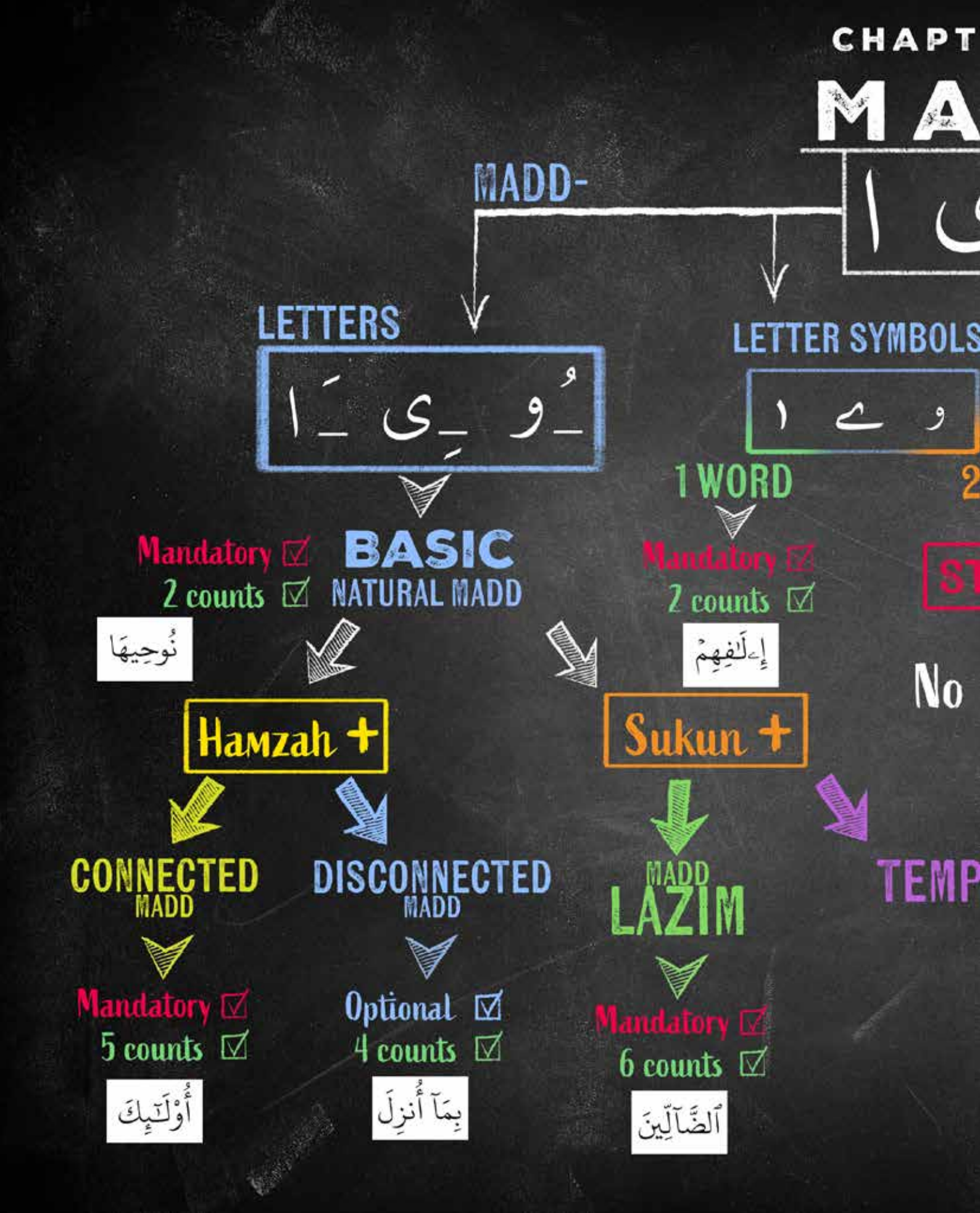
These are some key facts about līn letters which will help you understand their work even better:

- Līn letters cannot come at the beginning of the word, simply because they have to be preceded by a letter that has **fat-ḥah.**

- Alif cannot be a līn letter because if alif is preceded by **fat-ḥah** it will be considered a Madd letter, since **fat-ḥah** is the same nature as alif.

16 Al-Baqarah, 259
17 Al-Baqarah, 272
18 Quraish, 1-2

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CHAPT
MA
MADD-
ى ا
LETTERS
ـُو ـِي ـَا
LETTER SYMBOLS
و ے ا
1 WORD
2
Mandatory ☑
2 counts ☑
BASIC
NATURAL MADD
نُوحِيهَا
Mandatory ☑
2 counts ☑
إِۦلَٰفِهِمْ
ST
No
Hamzah +
Sukun +
CONNECTED
MADD
DISCONNECTED
MADD
MADD
LAZIM
TEMP
Mandatory ☑
5 counts ☑
أُوْلَٰٓئِكَ
Optional ☑
4 counts ☑
بِمَآ أُنزِلَ
Mandatory ☑
6 counts ☑
ٱلضَّآلِّينَ

ER 4+5

D D

و ى

LĪN LETTERS

ـَو ـَى

CONTINUE

STOP

No Madd

ٱلۡبَيۡتِ ۝٣ ٱلَّذِى

2 , 4, 6 counts

هَٰذَا ٱلۡبَيۡتِ

WORDS

TOP

Madd

بِهِۦ

CONTINUE

Optional ☑
4 counts ☑

إِلَىٰٓ أُمِّ

Mandatory ☑
2 counts ☑

بِهِۦ عَن جُنُبٍ

PORARY
MADD

Mandatory ☑
2,4,6 counts ☑

نَسۡتَعِينُ



DISCUSSION

Follow these steps to learn Chapter 4 & 5 effectively:

1. Revise the basic rules of Natural Madd in Chapter 4
2. Study the rules of Secondary Madd and their application
3. Use the attached info-graphic to easily remember the types of Madd.
4. Check your answers in the answer key (page 177)

Task 1: Study the following āyah.

وَأَمَّا مَنْ أُوتِيَ كِتَٰبَهُۥ بِشِمَالِهِۦ فَيَقُولُ يَٰلَيْتَنِي لَمْ أُوتَ كِتَٰبِيَهْ

- First: circle all the Madd letters you can see in this āyah:
- Second: recite the verse in a beautiful way while extending the Natural Madd letters by two ḥarakāt.

Task 2: There are three types of Madd present in this āyah.

قَالُوا۟ سَوَآءٌ عَلَيْنَآ أَوَعَظْتَ أَمْ لَمْ تَكُن مِّنَ ٱلْوَٰعِظِينَ

- Which types of Madd are they?

Task 3: Study this āyah, and answer the following questions:

ٱلَّذِينَ يُؤْمِنُونَ بِٱلْغَيْبِ وَيُقِيمُونَ ٱلصَّلَوٰةَ وَمِمَّا رَزَقْنَٰهُمْ يُنفِقُونَ ﴿٣﴾

- Find a word containing a līn letter. Can this word receive Madd if we stopped at it?
- Does this āyah contain temporary Madd? Receite it accordingly.

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Task 4: Which rule of Madd should be applied on highlighted letters ?

1. هَلۡ ءَامَنُكُمۡ عَلَيۡهِ
2. قُولُوٓاْ ءَامَنَّا بِٱللَّهِ
3. مَآ أَنَاْ بِبَاسِطٍ
4. إِنَّ رَبَّكَ مِنۢ بَعۡدِهَا لَغَفُورٞ رَّحِيمٞ
5. مَالُهُۥ وَمَا كَسَبَ
6. لِيَزۡدَادُوٓاْ إِيمَٰنَا مَّعَ إِيمَٰنِهِمۡۗ

Task 5: Study the following āyah from sūrah Taha.

إِنَّمَآ إِلَٰهُكُمُ ٱللَّهُ ٱلَّذِي لَآ إِلَٰهَ إِلَّا هُوَۚ وَسِعَ كُلَّ شَيۡءٍ عِلۡمَا

- The word هُوَۚ can be pronounced in two ways. What are they?
- Why is there a difference in how we pronounce it?

Challenge Question **Highlight each Madd case (including Madd generated from līn letters) found in this āyah. How do you pronounce it?**

يَٰٓأَيُّهَا ٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُواْ ٱسۡتَعِينُواْ بِٱلصَّبۡرِ وَٱلصَّلَوٰةِۚ إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ مَعَ ٱلصَّٰبِرِينَ ١٥٣ وَلَا تَقُولُواْ لِمَن يُقۡتَلُ فِي سَبِيلِ ٱللَّهِ أَمۡوَٰتُۢۚ بَلۡ أَحۡيَآءٞ وَلَٰكِن لَّا تَشۡعُرُونَ ١٥٤ وَلَنَبۡلُوَنَّكُم بِشَيۡءٖ مِّنَ ٱلۡخَوۡفِ وَٱلۡجُوعِ وَنَقۡصٖ مِّنَ ٱلۡأَمۡوَٰلِ وَٱلۡأَنفُسِ وَٱلثَّمَرَٰتِۗ وَبَشِّرِ ٱلصَّٰبِرِينَ ١٥٥

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6

Hamzah

In this chapter you will learn:

- The two types Hamzah.
- What is Hamzat Al-Qat'?
  - » The different forms of Hamzat Al-Qat'
- What is Hamzat Al-Waṣl?
- Adding tashkīl on Hamzat Al-Waṣl
  - » Exceptions of Hamzat Al-Waṣl



A rare ancient Muṣ-ḥaf dating back 13th century

Orientation

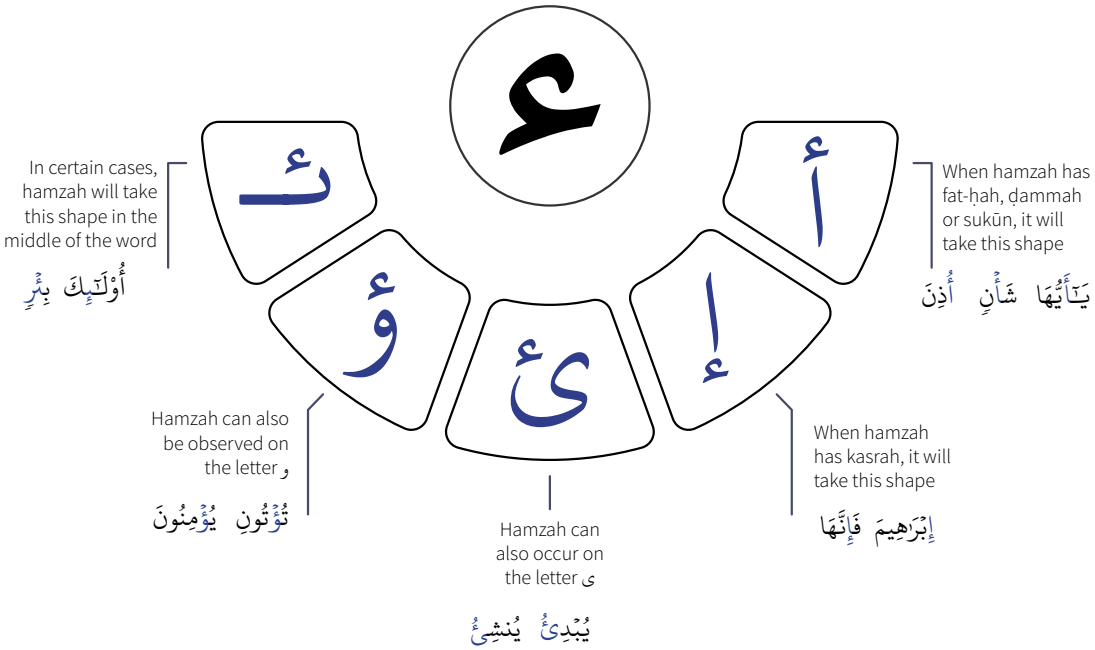
More on the difference between alif and hamzah, go to page 164

Hamzah is the first letter of the Arabic alphabet; it is a consonant and it must not be confused with alif, which is one of the long vowels or Madd letters. In order to know how to pronounce hamzah correctly, you have to know the difference between the two types of hamzah:

1. **Hamzat Al-Qaṭ‘** هَمزَةُ القَطعِ
2. **Hamzat Al-Waṣl** هَمزَةُ الوَصلِ

1 Hamazah Al-Qat‘

Hamzat Al-Qaṭ‘ involves using the symbol **ء**, but that is not the only variation of Hamzat Al-Qaṭ‘, here are the other possible variations of hamzah Al-Qaṭ‘ in the Qur’ān:



DID YOU KNOW?

Hamzat Al-Qaṭ‘ is literally translated into “cutting hamzah.” The reason why it was given this name is because of the word [qat‘] refers to the nature of pronouncing the sound: stopping/ cutting air to produce it.

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Hamzat Al-Qat‘ ***(including all its variations)*** **must always be pronounced at all times, whether you start with it at the beginning of the word, or you are continuing reading from a preceding word. Like these examples:**

601

1 ٱلَّذِينَ إِذَآ أَصَٰبَتْهُم مُّصِيبَةٌ قَالُوٓاْ إِنَّا لِلَّهِ وَإِنَّآ إِلَيْهِ رَٰجِعُونَ ﴿١٥٦﴾

602

2 أُوْلَٰٓئِكَ عَلَيْهِمْ صَلَوَٰتٌ مِّن رَّبِّهِمْ وَرَحْمَةٌ ۖ وَأُوْلَٰٓئِكَ هُمُ ٱلْمُهْتَدُونَ

In both of these examples, every hamzat Al-Qat‘ with the symbol of ء will be pronounced at all occasions.

2 Hamzah Al-Wasl

In the Muṣ-ḥaf, Hamzat Al-Waṣl will always look like this[3]:

Which tashkeel symbol should be used with Hamzat Al-Waṣl depends on some rules that are explained further in this chapter.

Notice that hamzah Al-Waṣl will always have no diacritics on top or under it. Hamzat Al-Waṣl will always be written without any tashkeel on/ under them.

ٱ صـ

This little sign on top of Hamzat Al-Waṣl is the letter صـ which stands for the word صِلَة which means ‘connection’ to show that this is a Hamzat Wasl which translates to ‘connecting hamzah.’

These are the most distinguishing characteristics of Hamzat Al-Waṣl:

- ☑ Hamzat Al-Waṣl is **only** used at the beginning of words, it will never occur in the middle or at the end of words. Its most common occurance is as part of the definite article ٱلْـ .
- ☑ Hamzat Al-Waṣl is pronounced normally (just like Hamzat Al-Qaṭ‘) **only** when you start reading the word containing Hamzat Al-Waṣl. If you continued reading from a preceding word, it will be completely dropped, and will not be pronounced.

1 Al-Baqarah, 156
2 Al-Baqarah, 157
3 Note: in Urdu/ Turkish Mus-haf, Hamzat Al-Wasl will not have the tiny صـ on top.

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Let us study this example:

603

فَمَنْ حَجَّ ٱلْبَيْتَ أَوِ ٱعْتَمَرَ فَلَا جُنَاحَ عَلَيْهِ أَن يَطَّوَّفَ بِهِمَا ۚ [4]

In this example, we observe the following facts:

- The word ٱلْبَيْتَ starts with Hamzat Al-Waṣl, and this means that you can pronounce the hamzah in this word in two ways **depending on whether you start at it or continue reading from before it:**
  - » **If you started reading at it**, you will pronounce the hamzah normally ٱلْبَيْتَ /albeit/.
  - » **If you started reading from the beginning**, then you will drop Hamzat Al-Waṣl at the beginning and read it like this فَمَنْ حَجَّ لْبَيْتَ. This means that the first letter you are pronouncing in that word is لـ
- The word ٱعْتَمَرَ also starts with Hamzat Al-Waṣl, and it can also be pronounced in two ways:
  - » **If you started reading at it**, you will pronounce the hamzah normally ٱعْتَمَرَ and say /i'tamar/
  - » **If you continued reading from before the word,** Hamzat Al-Waṣl will be dropped, and it will not be pronounced at all, and you will say: فَمَنْ حَجَّ لْبَيْتَ أَوِ عْتَمَرَ without any hamzah whatsoever.

Tashkīl of Hamzat Al-Wasl

In the Uthmāni Codex, the diacritics (Tashkīl) are not be given on top or under Hamzat Al-Waṣl. So, if we want to start at a word that is starting with Hamzat Al-Waṣl, which tashkīl should it receive?
There are rules depending on if the word is **a noun or a verb**:

1 Nouns

Nouns in Arabic can either be: Indefinite or Definite nouns

▷ **If it is an indefinite noun,** then it will **always**[5] receive **kasrah**, and there are only four nouns in the Qur'ān that belong to this rule:

604

How they look in the Muṣ-ḥaf	ٱسْمُهُ	ٱبْنَ	ٱمْرَأَةُ	ٱثْنَانِ
How they are pronounced	اِسْمُهُ	اِبْنَ	اِمْرَأَةُ	اِثْنَانِ

▷ **If it is a definite noun,** then it will **always** start with ٱلـ**,** which always has fat-ḥah on Hamzat Al-Waṣl, so it is always pronounced as اَلـ**.**

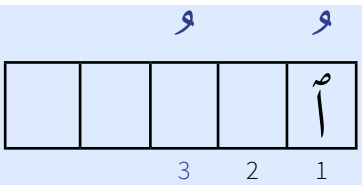
4 Al-Baqarah, 158
5 Note: this rule applies only to the Qur'ān, and not regular (MSA) Arabic.

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2 Verbs

▷ **If it is a verb** (which is much more common in the Qur'ān), you will have to **check the diacritic/ Tashkīl on the third letter** regardless of how many letters this verb has. This means that there will be three possible outcomes for the diacritic on the third letter:

1 **If the third letter has (ḍammah), then Hamzat Al-Waṣl will receive (ḍammah)**



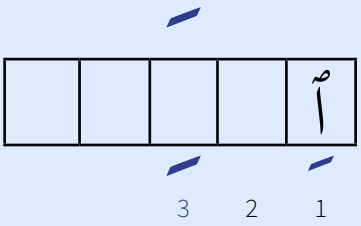
For example:

605

How it looks in the Muṣ-ḥaf	ٱنظُرّ	ٱضْطُرَّ	ٱرْكُضْ	ٱدْعُ
How it is pronounced	اُنظُرّ	اُضْطُرَّ	اُرْكُضْ	اُدْعُ

There is no rule for verbs having sukūn on their third letter because such verbs do not exist.

2 **If the third letter has (fat-ḥah) or (Kasrah), then Hamzat Al-Waṣl will receive (Kasrah)**



For example:

606

How it looks in the Muṣ-ḥaf	ٱرْكَب	ٱشْتَرَوُاْ	ٱذْهَبُواْ	ٱقْتَرَبَتِ
How it is pronounced	اِرْكَب	اِشْتَـرَوُاْ	اِذْهَبُواْ	اِقْتَـرَبَتِ

607

How it looks in the Muṣ-ḥaf	ٱهْدِنَا	ٱتَّبِعْ	ٱتَّبِعُواْ	ٱرْجِعُوٓاْ
How it is pronounced	اِهْدِنَا	اِتَّبِعْ	اِتَّبِعُواْ	اِرْجِعُوٓاْ

Verbal Nouns starting with Hamzat Al-Waṣl, like ٱسْتِكْبَارًا and ٱسْتِغْفَارُ also follow the same rule. This means, when we start at them, we use kasrah as well.

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EXCEPTION

There are five verbs that do not follow these three rules of Hamzat Al-Waṣl:

ٱبْنُواْ ٱقْضُوٓاْ ٱمْشُواْ ٱئْتُونِي ٱئْتُواْ

All these five verbs have (ḍammah) on the third letter. However, they will not follow the rule of receiving (ḍammah) on Hamzat Al-Waṣl, but instead, they will all receive (kasrah):

608

اِبْنُواْ اِقْضُوٓاْ اِمْشُواْ اِئْتُونِي اِئْتُواْ

This means that whenever you start at these words, you will pronounce hamzah with kasrah.

CAUTION

Giving instructions on starting at certain verbs, does NOT mean that you may choose to start there if you didn't have to. However, you may need to apply these rules in an emergency or if you are being tested by your teacher.

Remember

All the rules pertaining to Hamzat Al-Waṣl only apply when you start at recitation at it. But, when you read a word before it, and you continue reading, then Hamzat Al-Waṣl will be completely dropped, and these rules will, therefore, not apply.

Q: Why aren't the diacritics of Hamzat Al-Waṣl indicated on the letter instead of all of these rules?

Well .. The problem with putting the tashkīl/ diacritic on Hamzat Al-Waṣl is that it gives a false premise that you will also be able to pronounce that letter, while that is not the case. As a matter of fact, Hamzat Al-Waṣl is dropped far more often than it is pronounced. So the letter is left without tashkīl to indicate that it can eventually be dropped, and that it is not always pronounced.

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HAMZAT AL-QAT' vs

LOOKS LIKE → أ ← إ

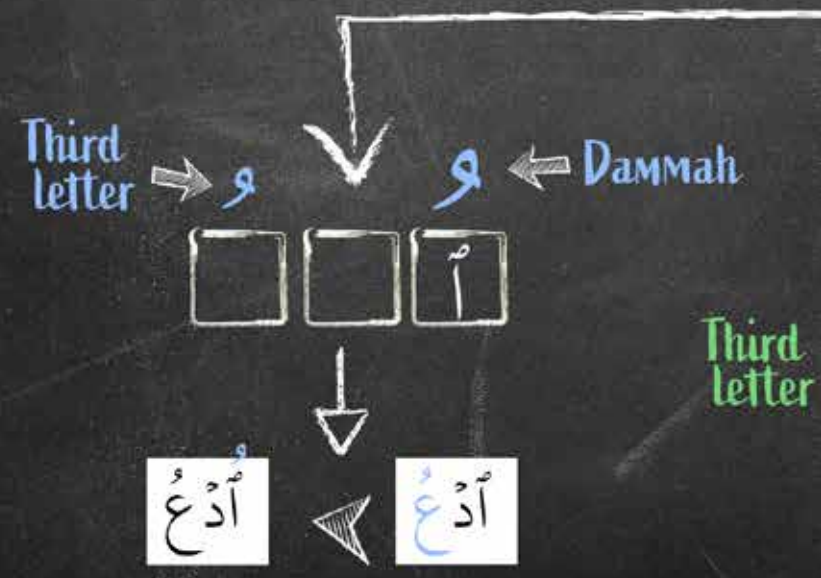
☑ ALWAYS PRONOUNCED

KEEPING ON

قُلْ هُوَ ٱللَّهُ أَحَدٌ

STARTING

إِنَّآ أَعْطَيْنَٰكَ ٱلْكَوْثَرَ



EXCEPTIONS

ٱئْتُونِى ٱمْشُوا۟ ٱقْضُوا۟

ٱبْنُوا۟ ٱئْتُوا۟

HAMZAT AL-WASL

LOOKS LIKE → ٱ صـ → refers to ص of the word صِلَة

☑ PRONOUNCED WHEN STARTING

ٱهْدِنَا ٱلصِّرَٰطَ ٱلْمُسْتَقِيمَ

starting here

☒ DROPPED WHEN KEEPING ON

يَٰبَنِيٓ إِسْرَٰٓءِيلَ ٱذْكُرُوا۟

when you keep on reading

CHECK 3RD LETTER

Third letter

ـِ ـَ ـُ

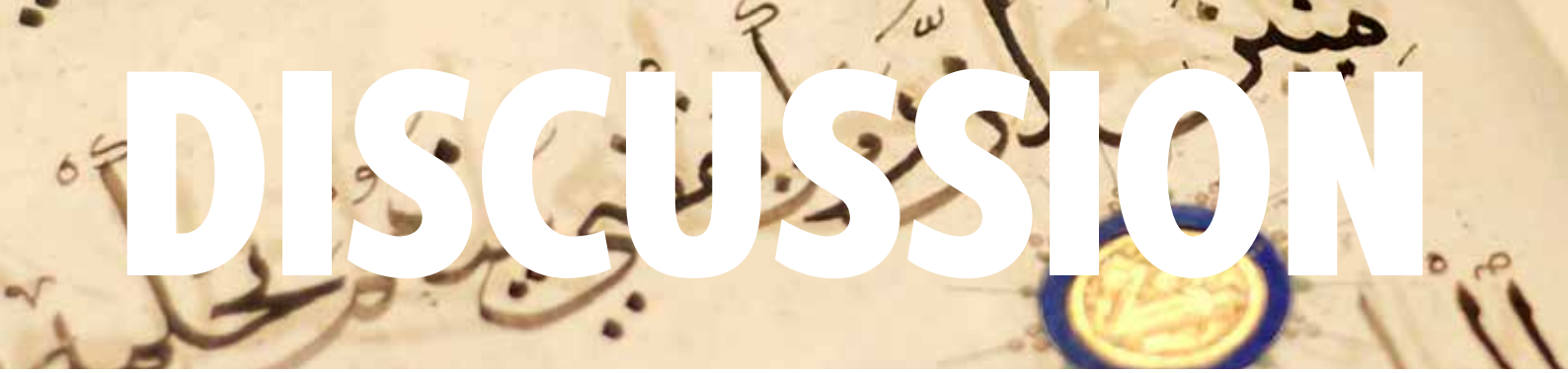
ـِ ـَ ـُ ٱ

Kasrah

Kasrah

ٱقْتَرَبَتِ ← اِقْتَرَبَتِ

ٱذْهَبُوا۟ ← اِذْهَبُوا۟



DISCUSSION

Follow these steps to learn Chapter 6 effectively:

1. Study the rules of Hamzah carefully.
2. Use the attached poster to easily detect the two types of hamzah.
3. As you apply the rules of this lesson, remember to apply all the previous rules that you learned so far.

Task 1: Read this āyāt from Sūrah Al-Qiyāmah, and answer the following questions.

كَلَّآ إِذَا بَلَغَتِ ٱلتَّرَاقِيَ ﴿٢٦﴾ وَقِيلَ مَنْۜ رَاقٍ ﴿٢٧﴾ وَظَنَّ أَنَّهُ ٱلْفِرَاقُ ﴿٢٨﴾
وَٱلْتَفَّتِ ٱلسَّاقُ بِٱلسَّاقِ ﴿٢٩﴾ إِلَىٰ رَبِّكَ يَوْمَئِذٍ ٱلْمَسَاقُ ﴿٣٠﴾

1. Find and identify every hamzah in these āyāt.
2. What is the best way to recite āyah 27.
3. We should pronounce the word ٱلتَّرَاقِ in two different ways, depending on whether we stop or keep on reading. What are these two ways?

Task 2: Decide which words have Hamzat Al-Waṣl, and which have Hamzat Al-Qat'. Then pronounce them accordingly.

ٱلصَّٰبِـُٔونَ مَلَٰٓئِكَة ٱلْإِنجِيلَ ٱلْأَاخِرِ يُؤْفَكُونَ

أُوْلَٰٓئِكَ لَبِئْسَ تَفْتَؤُاْ أَخْطَأْنَا بِٱلْمَعْرُوفِ

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Task 3: Read this āyah from Sūrah Hūd.

ٱرۡكُضۡ بِرِجۡلِكَۖ هَٰذَا مُغۡتَسَلُۢ بَارِدٞ وَشَرَابٞ

1. How can you start reciting at the word ٱرۡكُضۡ

Task 4: Decide which short vowel should Hamzat Al-Waṣl receive at the beginning of these verbs.

ٱرۡتَضَىٰ ٱشۡكُرُواْ ٱشۡمَأَزَّتۡ ٱرۡتَقِبُوٓاْ ٱرۡكَب

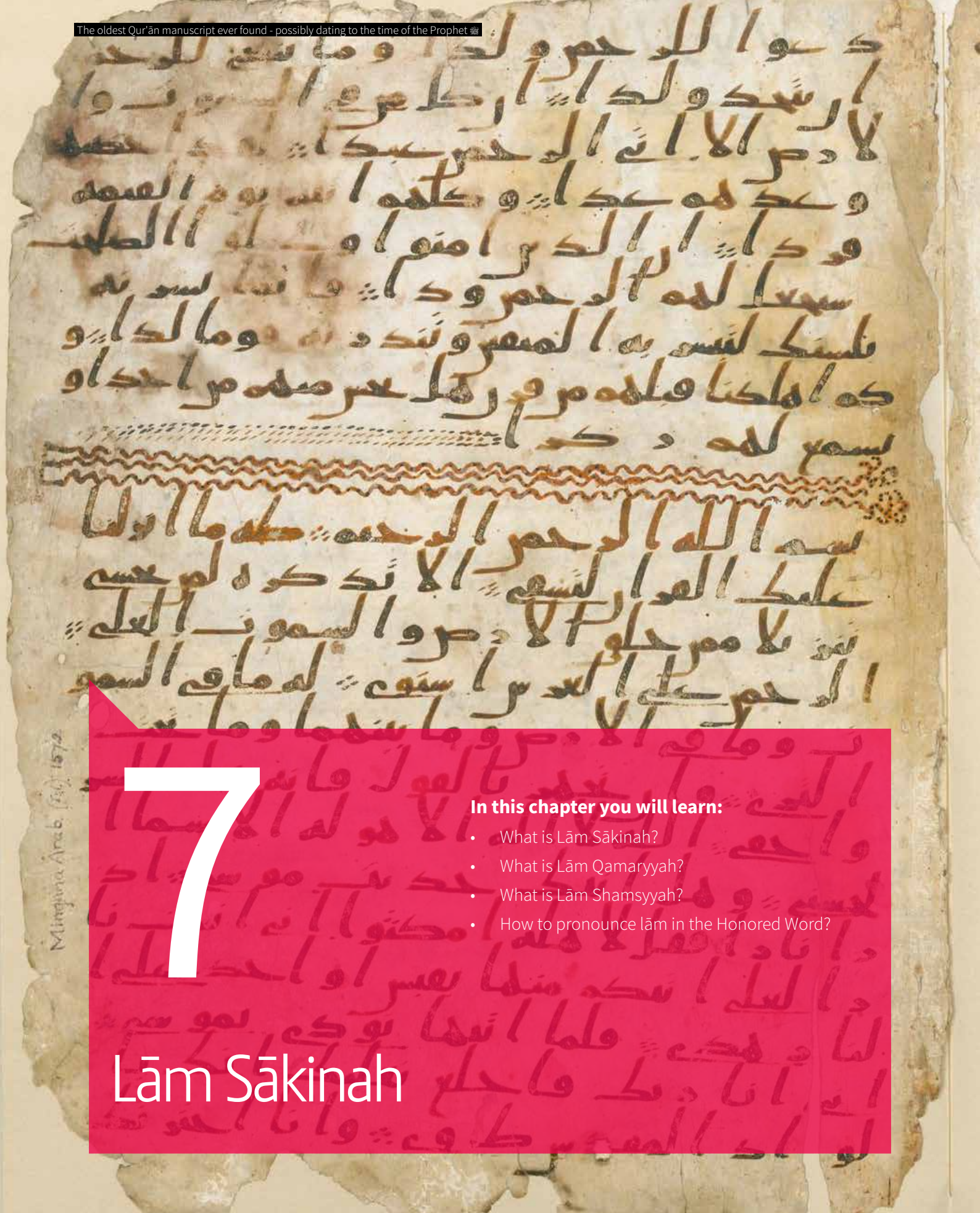
ٱجۡعَلۡ ٱدۡخُلُواْ ٱصۡطَفَىٰٓ ٱغۡفِرۡ ٱسۡتَزَلَّهُمُ

Challenge Question **Study these āyāt and follow the given instructions:**

- فَلَمَّا جَآءَهُمۡ نَذِيرٞ مَّا زَادَهُمۡ إِلَّا نُفُورًا ٤٢ ٱسۡتِكۡبَارٗا فِي ٱلۡأَرۡضِ وَمَكۡرَ ٱلسَّيِّئِۚ
- وَلَا تَسۡتَوِي ٱلۡحَسَنَةُ وَلَا ٱلسَّيِّئَةُۚ ٱدۡفَعۡ بِٱلَّتِي هِيَ أَحۡسَنُ
- أَمۡ لَهُمۡ شِرۡكٞ فِي ٱلسَّمَٰوَٰتِۖ ٱئۡتُونِي بِكِتَٰبٖ مِّن قَبۡلِ هَٰذَآ أَوۡ أَثَٰرَةٖ مِّنۡ عِلۡمٍ
- وَجَنَّةٍ عَرۡضُهَا ٱلسَّمَٰوَٰتُ وَٱلۡأَرۡضُ أُعِدَّتۡ لِلۡمُتَّقِينَ ١٣٣ ٱلَّذِينَ يُنفِقُونَ فِي ٱلسَّرَّآءِ وَٱلضَّرَّآءِ
- وَنُخۡرِجُ لَهُۥ يَوۡمَ ٱلۡقِيَٰمَةِ كِتَٰبٗا يَلۡقَىٰهُ مَنشُورًا ١٣ ٱقۡرَأۡ كِتَٰبَكَ

- **Recite these āyāt in one breath <u>without</u> pausing - Record your voice.**
- **Recite them one more time while pausing at each āyah/ stopping symbol - Record again.**
- **What changed in your recitation? - Compare both recordings.**
- **Now compare your recitations to a recording of your choice from your favorite Qāri'. Do you notice any differences?**

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7

Lām Sākinah

In this chapter you will learn:

- What is Lām Sākinah?
- What is Lām Qamaryyah?
- What is Lām Shamsyyah?
- How to pronounce lām in the Honored Word?

Orientation

In Arabic, there are only three types of words: Nouns (اسم)*, Verbs* (فِعل) *and Particles* (حَرف)

‘**Lām Sākinah**’ is an unvowelled lām, which means it has sukūn. For certain grammatical purposes, Lām Sākinah can be added to the beginning of **nouns** or **verbs**. However, this chapter will only focus on adding Lām Sākinah to nouns, and how you can properly deal with it.

In Arabic, ‘Lām Sākinah’ is اللَّامُ السَّاكِنة

In most cases, pronouncing Lām Sākinah does not require knowing any special rules to do it properly. It can best be compared to the English /l/ pronounced in the word ‘list’. However, more attention should be paid when Lām Sākinah is used in the following contexts:

- **Lām of definite article**
- **Lām of the Honored Word** ٱللَّهُ

Lām of Definite Article

A definite article is a word that defines the noun. In English, the definite article is ‘the’.

In Arabic, the lām of definite article is an extra lām added to the basic makeup of a noun which turns an indefinite noun into a definite noun. However, since we cannot start any word in Arabic with a sākin, we also add Hamzat Al-Waṣl to the beginning of the noun, which gives us the familiar definite article in Arabic: ٱلْـ

Which tashkīl should Hamzat Al-Waṣl receive in this poistion? *See page 68*



Lām of Definite Article Pronunciation

Lām of definite article can be pronounced in two ways depending on the letter that comes after it. When the lām of definite article is clearly pronounced with no assimilation or applying any special rules, we call it: **Lām Qamaryyah (Moon Lām)**.

However, it can sometimes get assimilated (fused) with the first letter that comes after it; and when that happens, we then call that type of lām: **Lām Shamsyyah (Sun Lām)**.

Study the following comparison between **Lām Qamaryyah** and **Lām Shamsyyah:**

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Moon Lām

Lām Qamaryyah (which is literally translated to Moon Lām) is the a type of a definite lām that is normally pronounced, and this happens when any of these fourteen letters come after the lām:

أ ب غ ح ج ك و خ ف ع ق ي م ه

These letters form the mnemonic:

إِبغِ حَجَّكَ وَ خَف عَقِيمَه

DID YOU KNOW?

These letters are also called 'Moon Letters'. They got their name from the fact that they, like the stars during the presence of the Moon, shine clearly at night time.

Study the following examples and notice how Moon Lām is clearly pronounced when any of these letters come after it:

701

ٱلْكِتَٰبُ	ٱلْحَمْدُ	ٱلْمَلَٰٓئِكَةِ	ٱلْأَرْضِ
/Al-kitāb/	Al-Ḥamd	Al-Malā'ikah	Al-'arḍ

Sun Lām

Lām Shamsyyah (Sun Lām) is the a type of a definite lām that is not pronounced, or rather it becomes fully assimilated with the letter that comes after it. This happens when any of the remaining fourteen letters come after the lām. These remaining letters are:

ط ث ص ر ت ض ذ ن د س ظ ز ش ل

DID YOU KNOW?

These letters are also called 'Sun Letters'. They got their name from the fact that they, like the stars during the presence of the sun, disappear completely at day time.

Let us study the following examples:

702

ٱلصَّلَوٰةَ	ٱلدِّينِ	ٱلضَّآلِّينَ	ٱلرَّحِيمُ
/As-Ṣalāh/	/Ad-Dīn/	/Ad-ḍālīn/	/Ar-Rahīm/

In these examples, we can clearly notice that the lām is not pronounced at all, and that it is fully assimilated into the letter that follows it.

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TIP

An easy way to remember which rule applies to which, remember that the word 'Moon' means القَمَر and this Arabic word /Al-Qamar/ is in fact the prime example for Moon Lām and its rule. Similarly, Sun in Arabic means الشَّمْس /Ash-Shams/, and this is also the prime example for Sun Lām and its rule.

One easy way to identify 'Moon Lām' and 'Sun Lām' while reciting the Qur'ān, is checking how the lām is written:



Moon Lām

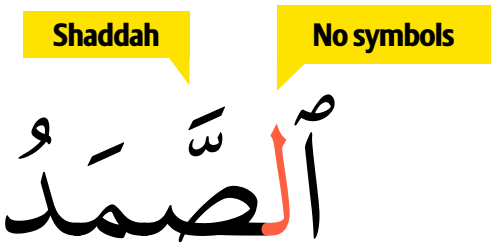
When words start with a 'Moon Lām', the words will look like this:

- The lām sākinah will have the sukūn symbol on top of it.
- The first letter after the lām sākinah will have no shaddah on top of it.

Sun Lām

When words start with a 'Sun Lām', the words will look like this:

- The lām sākinah will have no sukūn symbol or any other tashkīl symbol.
- The first letter after the lām sākinah will always have shaddah on top of it.



TIP

To easily remember the letters that trigger the rule of 'Sun Lām', is to memorize the mnemonic of 'Moon Lām' إِبغِ حَجَّكَ وَ خَف عَقِيمَه , and any letter that isn't found in that phrase, is automatically a letter that triggers the rule of 'Sun Lām'.

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The combination ٱلـ starts with Hamzat Al-Waṣl. So, when words starting with Sun Lām come in the middle of your recitation, both Sun Lām and Hamzat Al-Waṣl will be dropped, since both of them are not pronounced as long as you are continuing your recitation.
So..

703 مَـٰلِكِ يَوۡمِ ٱلدِّينِ is pronounced as مَـٰلِكِ يَوۡمِدِّينِ

704 وَٱلشَّمۡسِ وَضُحَىٰهَا is pronounced as وَشَّمۡسِ وَضُحَىٰهَا

705 ذَٰلِكَ ٱلدِّينُ ٱلۡقَيِّمُ is pronounced as ذَٰلِكَدِّينُ لَقَيِّمُ

Typically, Sun Lām or Moon Lām are an extra part of the nouns, and removing them gives you the indefinite version of the noun:

ٱلنَّاس	»	نَاس
The people		people



However, there are certain words that cannot be broken down like this, which means that Sun Lām is an integral part of the word that cannot be removed or detached. These words are:

ٱلَّذِى	»	لَذِى ⊗
The one who		

ٱلَّتِي	»	لَتِى ⊗
The one who		

ٱلَّذِينَ	»	لَذِينَ ⊗
The ones who		

ٱلَّـَٔىِ	»	لَّـَٔىِ ⊗
The ones who		

The Honored Word ٱللَّهُ also belongs to this list, but there are more details to learn about this word which will be important in knowing how to pronounce it properly.

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Lām of the Honored Word ٱللَّه

The word ٱللَّهُ contains two lāms one after the other. To understand which one we pronounce, we should first understand the makeup of the Honored Word.

إِلَه » الـإِلَه » ٱللَّهُ

*It is important to know that this is **one** of the theories about the origin of the Honored Word, there are other views on how the word is formed, but discussing the other views is outside the scope of this book.*

This chart shows one of the theories of how the Honored Word is derived. As many scholars explained, the Honored Word is derived from the word إِلَه , but when the definite article was added to it, Hamzat Al-Qaṭ‘ was dropped. This resulted in two lāms following one another: the first lam from ٱلـ and the second one from the word إِلَه.

This means that the **first lām** in the Honored Word is Lām Shamsyyah (Sun Lām) because the letter directly after it is also lām (which is a trigger letter of Lām Shamsyyah), and so the lām of the definite article was assimilated (fused) with the lām of the Honored Word.



When scholars say that the Honored Word is 'derived', it does not mean that words preceded Allāh . But rather, they are trying to understand the makeup of the word.

Pronunciation of Lām of the Honored Word ٱللَّه

Understanding the makeup of the Honored Word, helps us realize that any discusson on the lām of the Honored Word, is only about **the second lām,** since the first lām is dropped (like any other Lām Shamsyyah).

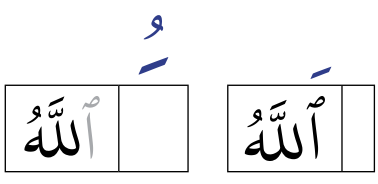
That second lām in the Honored Word ٱللَّهُ can be pronounced in two ways:

1. **Dark (Heavy) /l/** - compared to /l/ in the word ‘luck’. In Arabic, it is called تَفخِيم or full-mouth.
2. **Light /l/** - compared to /l/ in the word ‘list’. In Arabic, it is called تَرقِيق or empty-mouth.

Using either 'heavy' or 'light' /l/ depends on the letter coming before it.

The word ‘mufakhkham’ مُفخَّم refers to the way a letter is pronounced, in this context, it is dark /l/. More on this topic in Chapter 12.

If the lām in the word ٱللَّهُ is preceded by a fat-ḥah or ḍammah, the lām is pronounced as a heavy /l/ (mufakhkham)



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Examples:

706 1 أَلَمْ تَرَوْا۟ كَيْفَ خَلَقَ ٱللَّهُ سَبْعَ سَمَٰوَٰتٍ طِبَاقًا

707 2 كَذَٰلِكَ يُضِلُّ ٱللَّهُ مَن يَشَآءُ

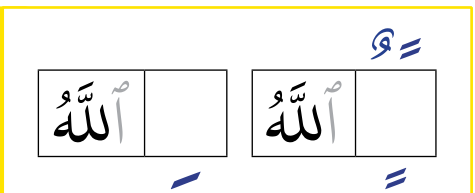
708 3 ٱللَّهُ ٱلصَّمَدُ

From these examples, we can observe the following:

- In the first two examples, the lām in the word ٱللَّهُ was preceded by either fat-ḥah or ḍammah. Therefore, the lām was pronounced as (mufakhkham) a dark /l/.
- In the third example (or whenever you start at the word ٱللَّهُ), the lām will still be preceded by fat-ḥah since, you will have to pronounce Hamzat Al-Waṣl, which (as we learned in Chapter 6) receives fat-ḥah when it is part of the definite article ٱلـ.

The word 'muraqqaq' مُرقَّق means that the letter will be pronounced lightly.

If the word ٱللَّهُ is preceded by a (kasrah) or any kind of tanwīn (and you kept on reading), the lām is pronounced as a light /l/ (muraqqaq)



Examples:

709 4 مَن يَهْدِ ٱللَّهُ فَهُوَ ٱلْمُهْتَدِ ۖ

710 5 لِمَ تَعِظُونَ قَوْمًا ٱللَّهُ مُهْلِكُهُمْ

711 6 قُلْ هُوَ ٱللَّهُ أَحَدٌ ۝١ ٱللَّهُ ٱلصَّمَدُ

1 Nūh, 15
2 Al-Muddathir, 31
3 Al-Ikhlās, 2
4 Al-A'rāf, 178
5 Al-A'rāf, 164
6 Al-Ikhlās, 1-2

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712

لِلَّهِ مَا فِي ٱلسَّمَٰوَٰتِ وَمَا فِي ٱلۡأَرۡضِۗ [7]

From these examples, we can observe the following:

- In all four examples, the Honored Word ٱللَّهُ was preceded by either kasrah, or tanwīn, and we did not start at it. Therefore, it should be pronounced with a light /l/.
- These rules will **not** be activated if you did **not** start reading from before the Honored Word. In other words, If you started reciting at the word ٱللَّهُ then these rules will not be applied; instead, the lām will be preceded by fat-ḥah, and thus, the first set of rules will apply.
- In the fourth example, when the preposition لِـ is added to the word ٱللَّهُ it will also cause the lām to be pronounced with a light /l/.



Muṣ-ḥaf of Sultan Baybars II which dates back to 14th century - British Museum

7 Al-Baqarah, 284

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CHAPT

SUN LETTERS VS

ت ث ج ح خ د ذ ر ز س ش
ص ض ط ظ ع غ ف ق ك ل م ن ه و ى

THE REST OF 14 LETTERS

SUN LETTERS + ٱلـ

✗ Dropped

ٱلسَّمَآءِ

ٱهْدِنَا ٱلصِّرَٰطَ

The ـلـ is dropped (fully assimilated), because there is a sun letter following it

Shaddah

No Sukoon/ any symbols

ٱلصِّرَٰطَ

ER 7

MOON LETTERS



أ ب ت ث ج ح خ د ذ ر ز س ش
ص ض ط ظ ع غ ف ق ك ل م ن ه و ى

THEY FORM ⬇ THE MNEMONIC

إِبْغِ حَجَّكَ وَ خَفْ عَقِيمَهُ

MOON LETTERS + ٱلْـ

☑ Pronounced

أَعْطَيْنَٰكَ ٱلْكَوْثَرَ ✓

ٱلْقَرْيَةَ ✓

→ The ـلْ is pronounced normally

No Shaddah ← → Sukoon symbol

ٱلْكَوْثَرَ



DISCUSSION

Follow these steps to learn Chapter 7 effectively:

1. Study the rules of lām Sākinah. It is important to have studied chapter 6 before doing the following exercises.
2. Use the attached poster to remember the characteristics of Sun and Moon Lām.
3. Don't forget to check your answers in the answer key (page 177)

Task 1: Determine if the following statementes are (true) or (false) depending on your understanding of Chapter 7.

1. Lām should be pronounced as a light /l/ as in the word 'link'. ( )
2. Words in Arabic cannot start with a sākin (consonant). ( )
3. The lām in the Honored Word ٱللَّهُ can have different pronunciation depending on the word before it. ( )
4. The definite article ٱلـ is always an extra addition to the noun. ( )
5. In certain cases, the definite article is completely dropped and not pronounced. ( )
6. In certain cases Sun Lām may not be followed by a letter with shaddah. ( )

Task 2: In the following āyah, the word can be pronounced in two different ways.

قُلْ هُوَ ٱللَّهُ أَحَدٌ ﴿١﴾ ٱللَّهُ ٱلصَّمَدُ

1. What are the two ways to pronounce it?
2. Why is there a difference in the pronunciation of the Honored Word.

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Task 3: In the following āyah.

وَٱللَّهُ هُوَ ٱلسَّمِيعُ ٱلْعَلِيمُ

We notice that the lām of the definite article has two different shapes: once with a sukūn symbol and another time without any symbols.

1. Why is there a difference?
2. Does that difference affect the pronunciation of the lām?

Task 4: Decide which words have Sun Lām, and which have Moon Lām. Then pronounce them accordingly.

ٱلظَّٰلِمِينَ ٱلْمَلَٰٓئِكَةِ ٱلْبَرْقُ ٱلْءَاخِرِ ٱلدِّينِ

ٱلْجَٰهِلِينَ ٱلنَّٰظِرِينَ ٱلصَّٰلِحَٰتِ ٱلْخَيْرَٰتِ بِٱلْمَعْرُوفِ

Challenge Question **Observe the following chart:**

لـ + ٱللَّهُ = لِلَّه

When we add a particle to the Honored Name, it would seem like the word has lost a letter rather than a letter was added to it. Why does this happen?

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8

Nūn Sākinah

In this chapter you will learn:

- What is Ghunnah?
- What is Nūn Sākinah?
- What are the four rules of Nūn Sākinah?
  - » Iẓhār
  - » Idghām
  - » Iqlāb
  - » Ikh'fā'

ORIENTATION

One of the most important components in beautifying and perfecting your Qur'ān recitation is the proper application of the rules of Nūn Sākinah. It is that nasal sound that sets the recitation of the Qur'ān apart from any other text and makes it stand out even if you do not understand Arabic. This nasal sound is called 'nasalization' in phonetics terms, and in tajweed terms it is called '**ghunnah**'.

What is 'Ghunnah'?

Ghunnah is a nasal sound that is produced by letting the air pass through the nasal cavity (i.e., your nostrils). It is the same sound that is produced when humming. That nasal sound or ghunnah is an intrinsic part of pronouncing two letters in Arabic: nūn ن and mīm م. In other words, you cannot possibly pronounce these two letters in whichever position they come without applying that nasal sound.

*From here onwards, when we use the word **'ghunnah'** we will always mean the tajweed meaning: extending the nasal sound for two ḥarakāt*[1]

However, in **Tajweed terminology**, when we use the word 'ghunnah' it always refers to the prolonged nasal sound that is applied in certain situations based on the rules of Nūn and Mīm Sākinah. This ghunnah is always prolonged/ extended for roughly one second, which is about 2 counts/ ḥarakāt as we learned in chapter 4.

Ghunnah (in Tajweed) = prolonging nasal sound for 2 counts [1]

What is 'Nūn Sākinah'?

Nūn Sākinah refers to the letter nūn that is free from all tashkīl symbols, which means that it has sukūn. Nūn Sākinah may appear in the Qur'ān in three different ways:

Tanwīn literally means adding nūn to the end of nouns. That's why, the rules of Nūn Sākinah applies to Tanwīn too.

نْ	ن	ـً ـٍ ـٌ
Nūn with sukūn symbol on top of it	**Nūn without any tashkīl symbols at all**	**Tanwīn at the end of nouns**

In this chapter, whenever we use the phrase **Nūn Sākinah**, we would always be referring to these three. When any of these three shapes of Nūn Sākinah is used in the Qur'ān, it will require you to apply one of these four rules:

It is very important that you learn and study these four rules of Nūn Sākinah, in the same order, as these rules are built on top of each other.

1	2	3	4
Iẓhār	**Idghām**	**Iqlāb**	**Ikh'fā'**
إِظْهَار	إِدْغَام	إِقْلَاب	إِخْفَاء

1 Typically, ghunnah has different degrees and it cannot be measured by harakat, but for the sake of simplifying the concept, we quanify its length for 2 harakat or a little more.

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How to apply the rules of Nūn Sākinah?

Before we start tackling each of these four rules, it is important to know that these four rules are triggered depending on which letters come after Nūn Sākinah. Therefore, each of these rules have a set of letters that you should learn and keep track of in order to know which rule you should apply. Using the infographic posters at the end of this chapter, can be particularly helpful in getting the hang of these rules quickly.

Finally, the more you recite the Qur'ān, the faster applying these rules will become a second nature, so do not be alarmed or discouraged if you find this a bit overwhelming in the beginning.

1 Iẓhār

In Arabic, the word 'Iẓhār' (إِظْهَار) literally means **'manifestation'** or **'making something obvious or clear'**. In Tajweed terminology, Iẓhār refers to manifesting or pronouncing Nūn Sākinah clearly without prolonging or shortening the sound of nūn at all; you basically pronounce a normal consonant /n/ sound.

There are six letters that trigger Iẓhār:

أ - هـ - ع - ح - غ - خ

DID YOU KNOW?

The common thing among the letters of Iẓhār is that they come from the throat while nūn is pronounced from tip of the tongue. This means that merging or assimilating them with nūn is impossible because of how far they are articulated from each other. Therefore, showing the nūn clearly, is the only option that can be applied.

Study the following examples:

801

2 وَمِنْ أَهْلِ ٱلْمَدِينَةِ مَرَدُوا۟ عَلَى ٱلنِّفَاقِ لَا تَعْلَمُهُمْ ۖ نَحْنُ نَعْلَمُهُمْ

We see here a case of Nūn Sākinah with tanwīn (adding nūn to the end of the word):

802

3 قُلْ أَرَءَيْتَكُمْ إِنْ أَتَىٰكُمْ عَذَابُ ٱللَّهِ بَغْتَةً أَوْ جَهْرَةً هَلْ يُهْلَكُ

803

4 وَلَعَبْدٌ مُّؤْمِنٌ خَيْرٌ مِّن مُّشْرِكٍ

2 At-Tawbah, 101
3 Al-An'ām, 47
4 Al-Baqarah, 221

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804 أَلَمْ يَعْلَمُوٓاْ أَنَّ ٱللَّهَ هُوَ يَقْبَلُ ٱلتَّوْبَةَ عَنْ عِبَادِهِۦ [5]

805 وَمِنْ حَيْثُ خَرَجْتَ فَوَلِّ وَجْهَكَ شَطْرَ ٱلْمَسْجِدِ ٱلْحَرَامِ [6]

806 وَنَزَعْنَا مَا فِي صُدُورِهِم مِّنْ غِلٍّ [7]

In case of Iẓhār, Nūn Sākinah will take unique shapes that makes it easier for you to detect the cases of Iẓhār even if you cannot remember the six letters of Iẓhār.

Iẓhār will NOT look like this	Iẓhār will look like this
نـ	نْ
ـنو	ـنْو
ـنـ	ـنْ
ـنـ	ـنْ

Remember

These symbols are unique to any Arabic Muṣ-ḥaf, but not for Urdu or Turkish Muṣ-ḥaf as they use the same symbols for all types of tanwīn. That is why, if you are starting to learn the tajweed of the Qur'ān, it might be easier to use an Arabic Muṣ-ḥaf to make use of these tips, which makes learning easier and faster.

5 At-Tawbah, 104
6 Al-Baqarah, 150
7 Al-A'rāf, 43

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2 Idghām

The word Idghām in Arabic (إدغام) means **'merging'** or **'assimilating'**. This means that for this rule, the Nūn Sākinah will be merged or assimilated with the letter that comes after it so that they become one. In other words, when you apply Idghām, two letters will be pronounced as one doubled letter (with shaddah).

There are six letters that trigger Idghām:

TIP

ي - ر - م - ل - و - ن

These letters form the mnemonic:

يَرْمَلُون

To understand more how Idghām works, study the following chart:

807

Idghām case	Before Assimilation	After assimilation	Pronounced as
مِن رَّبِّكَ	ن + ر	رّ	مِرَّبِّكَ
مِن وَال	ن + و	وّ	مِوَّال

There are two types of Idghām:

1. **Idghām with ghunnah**
2. **Idghām wihout ghunnah**

Idghām with ghunnah

Idghām with ghunnah (إدغَام بِغُنَّة) refers to assimilation **with** nasalization. You apply this type of Idghām when Nūn Sākinah is followed by:

ي - ن - م - و

These letters form the mnemonic:

يَنْمُو

Use the mnemonic to easily remember this rule

*Remember: the word **'ghunnah'** refers to extending the nasal sound for two ḥarakāt*

In this type of Idghām you submerge the Nūn Sākinah into the subsequent letter (one of the ينمو letters). When the two letters are assimilated, the nūn disappears completely except for its nasalization feature, which is the ghunnah. You extend that nasal sound 'ghunnah' for two counts.

To practically understand how to perform Idghām with ghunnah, study the following case:

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808 مَن يَعْمَل

In this example:

- The first word ends with Nūn Sākinah
- The second word starts with one of ينمو letters, which is yā'.
- This means that the assimilated version will be pronounced as:

مَـــيَّـــعْمَل

Apply ghunnah here (by letting air through nostrils while prolonging the letter ى for two harakāt)

Study more examples for Idghām with ghunnah:

Assimilation may only be applied if you keep on reading and link between the highlighted words.

	ينمو	Example	How it is pronounced
809	ى	وَيْلٌ يَوْمَئِذٍ لِّلْمُكَذِّبِينَ [8]	وَيْلُيَّوْمَئِذ
810	ن	كَمَا بَدَأْنَآ أَوَّلَ خَلْقٍ نُّعِيدُهُۥ [9]	خَلْقِنُّعِيدُه
811	م	فَهُم مِّن مَّغْرَمٍ مُّثْقَلُونَ [10]	مِّمَّغْرَمٍمُّثْقَلُونَ
812	و	وَهُوَ عَلَىٰ كُلِّ شَىْءٍ وَكِيلٌ [11]	شَيْءٍوَّكِيلٌ

8 Al-Mursalāt, 15
9 Al-Ambiyā', 104
10 Al-Qalam, 46
11 Az-Zumar, 62

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We should not forget that when pronouncing nūn with shaddah نّ we should always apply **Idghām with ghunnah**, since in theory nūn with shaddah is essentially Nūn Sākinah followed by another nūn:

نْ + نَ = نَّ

And since ن is one of the ينمو letters, then we must apply Idghām with ghunnah, which means that we must extend the nūn with ghunnah for two ḥarakāt, like in these examples:

813 12 إِنَّ ٱلَّذِينَ كَفَرُواْ سَوَآءٌ عَلَيۡهِمۡ

814 13 وَمِنَ ٱلنَّاسِ مَن يَقُولُ ءَامَنَّا بِٱللَّهِ

Idghām without ghunnah

Idghām wihout ghunnah (إدغَام بِغَير غُنَّة) refers to the assimilation of Nūn Sākinah **without** nasalization (ghunnah). You apply this type of Idghām when Nūn Sākinah is followed by:

ر - ل

Study the following examples:

	ر / ل	Example	How it is pronounced
815	ر	14 أَنَّهُ ٱلۡحَقُّ مِن رَّبِّكَ	مِرَّبِّكَ
816	ل	15 هَبۡ لِي مِن لَّدُنكَ ذُرِّيَّةً طَيِّبَةً	مِلَّدُنكَ
817	ل	16 إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَأٓيَةً لَّكُمۡ	لَأَيَتَلَّكُمَ

12 Al-Baqarah, 6
13 Al-Baqarah, 8
14 Al-Hajj, 54
15 Āl-i ʿimrān, 38
16 Al-Baqarah, 248

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EXCEPTION

In these FOUR words, we do not apply either Idghām with ghunnah or Idghām without ghunnah even though Nūn Sākinah is followed by any of the يَرمَلُون letters:

818

دُنْيَا صِنْوَان قِنْوَان بُنْيَان

We may only apply Iẓhār on these FOUR words; in other words, you will pronounce the nūn normally without assimilation or merging.

Revise comparison table on page 88

Interestingly, when you follow the rule of how Iẓhār looks in the Qur'ān, you will have no problem with these exceptions, and you will not mispronounce them since Nūn Sākinah in these FOUR words all look like this: نْ and not like this ن

3 Iqlāb

The word Iqlāb (إِقلَاب) literally means 'transformation' or 'conversion'. In terms of Tajweed terminology, Iqlāb refers to the conversion of the letter nūn to م with ghunnah. This happens when Nūn Sākinah is followed by the letter ب. **This can occur within one word but also between two separate words.**

There are two things to keep in mind when applying Iqlāb in the Qur'ān:

1. **Applying ghunnah:** Applying Iqlāb requires ghunnah which is the extended nasal sound of two ḥarakāt.
2. The produced م which is converted from Nūn Sākinah is a real م which should be pronounced as a regular م.

Let us observe the following examples to understand this even better:

819 وَيَقْتُلُونَ ٱلْأَنۢبِيَآءَ بِغَيْرِ حَقٍّ [17]

820 مَا مِن شَفِيعٍ إِلَّا مِنۢ بَعْدِ إِذْنِهِۦ [18]

821 وَأَخَذْنَا ٱلَّذِينَ ظَلَمُواْ بِعَذَابٍۭ بَـِٔيسٍۭ بِمَا كَانُواْ يَفْسُقُونَ [19]

822 وَٱللَّهُ رَءُوفٌۢ بِٱلْعِبَادِ [20]

17 Āl-i ʿimrān, 112
18 Yūnus, 3
19 Al-Aʿrāf, 165
20 Al-Baqarah, 207

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From the previous examples, we can learn the following:

1. Iqlāb occurred in a single word as in ٱلْأَنۢبِيَآءَ but also between two words as in مِنۢ بَعْدِ
2. The symbol of Iqlāb (م) can appear on top of the word مِنۢ بَعْدِ and also below the word بَصِيرٌۢ بِمَا in case of tanwīn kasrah.
3. With each instance of Iqlāb we should apply ghunnah of two counts.



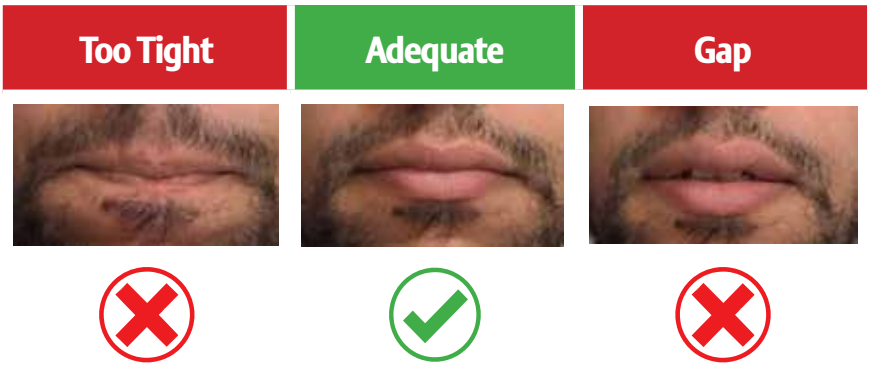
Revise Qur'ānic symbols page 11 &21

You should not mix up these two symbols of mīm in the Qur'ān:

م	مـ
Iqlāb	**Mandatory stop**

How to perform Iqlāb PROPERLY

When performing Iqlāb, you should always remember that the converted mīm of Iqlāb is an actual mīm, which is pronounced by touching the lips (without pressing them too tightly). This chart will demonstrate the proper shape of the lips when performing the mīm of Iqlāb.



This chart also demonstrates the common mistake of leaving a gap between the lips when performing Iqlāb. There should be no gap between the lips when pronouncing mīm, and at the same time, your lips should not be too tightly pressing against one another.

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4 Ikh'fā'

In Arabic, Ikh'fā' (إِخفَاء) means 'concealing' or 'hiding' something, and in terms of tajweed, Ikh'fā' refers to the **concealment or partial articulation** of Nūn Sākinah. Ikh'fā' is triggered, when Nūn Sākinah is followed by one of these 15 letters:

ت - ث - ج - د - ذ - ز - س - ش -
ص - ض - ط - ظ - ف - ق - ك

TIP

These fifteen letters are easily remembered when you know that they are the remaining letters of the Arabic alphabet apart from the **six letters of Iẓhār**, **the six letters of Idghām** and the **one letter of Iqlāb**.

How does 'concealing' Nūn Sākinah work?

To understand how to apply Ikh'fā' on Nūn Sākinah properly, we first need to remember how to pronounce nūn with Iẓhār (pronouncing nūn normally).

When we pronounce nūn normally, we do that by performing 2 actions:

Alveolar ridge is the area behind the upper front teeth.

1. Tip of the tongue touching the **alveolar ridge.**
2. Ghunnah - air coming out of nostrils.

When applying Ikh'fā' on Nūn Sākinah, you will essentially 'conceal' the first characteristic of nūn (which is the tongue placement) while keeping the second one (the ghunnah). And you will replace that first characteristic of nūn with the shape of the subsequent letter of Ikh'fā'.

This means that when performing Ikh'fā' on Nūn Sākinah, you will do that by performing 2 actions:

1. Shaping your mouth to the Ikh'fā' letter after Nūn Sākinah.
2. Ghunnah of two ḥarakāt.

Example:

823

مَن تَابَ

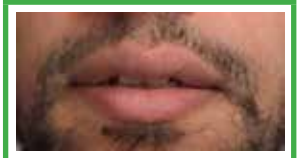
In this instance you will perform Ikh'fā' by:

1. **First:** applying ghunnah for two ḥarakāt **while** shaping your mouth of the letter ت
2. **Second:** pronouncing ت normally and as a separate letter.

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Shape of the mouth when performing Ikh'fā'

Gap between lips



Performing the Ikh'fā' requires that there is a small gap between the lips which occurs when performing the ghunnah of two ḥarakāt. The shape of the mouth may differ depending on the subsequent letter. If lips are pressing against one another, then this is not be a proper Ikh'fā'.

Let us consider the following examples:

824 21 إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ يَأۡمُرُكُمۡ أَن تَذۡبَحُواْ بَقَرَةٗۖ

825 22 كَذَٰلِكَ قَالَ ٱلَّذِينَ مِن قَبۡلِهِم

826 23 كُلُواْ مِن ثَمَرِهِۦٓ إِذَآ أَثۡمَرَ

827 24 خُذۡ مِنۡ أَمۡوَٰلِهِمۡ صَدَقَةٗ تُطَهِّرُهُمۡ

828 25 وَلَا يُنفِقُونَ نَفَقَةٗ صَغِيرَةٗ

We can learn the following from these examples:

1. Both Nūn Sākinah and the subsequent letter of Ikh'fā' are pronounced as two letters, not one letter.
2. There is **no** stress or shaddah to be applied on Ikh'fā'.
3. The ghunnah of Ikh'fā' must be extended for two ḥarakāt.
4. The ghunnah of Ikh'fā' should also be associated with the **makhraj** of the subsequent letter. *But what does that mean?*

A 'makhraj' is the articulation point at which a sound is produced.

This means that the **sound of ghunnah** that precedes the letter of Ikh'fā' is not the same for every letter of Ikh'fā'. This is because we shape the mouth to that particular letter that follows the Nūn Sākinah which in turn affects the characteristic of the ghunnah sound produced. To understand this even further, consider the following two examples:

21 Al-Baqarah, 67
22 Al-Baqarah, 118
23 Al-An'ām, 141
24 At-Tawbah, 103
25 At-Tawbah, 121

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829

مَن سَبَقَ

The letter of Ikh'fā' here is sīn, **which is a light letter,** so Ikh'fā' in this case will require:

1. **First:** applying ghunnah for two ḥarakāt **while shaping your mouth of the letter** س
2. **Second:** pronouncing س normally and as a separate letter.

The result would be a **light ghunnah** that suits س.

Now compare this case of Ikh'fā' to the next:

830

The letter of Ikh'fā' here is ṣād, **which is a heavy letter,** so Ikh'fā' in this case will require:

1. **First:** applying ghunnah for two ḥarakāt **while shaping your mouth of the letter** ص
2. **Second:** pronouncing ص normally and as a separate letter.

The result would be a **heavy ghunnah** that suits ص.

لَمَن صَبَرَ

Therefore, if Ikh'fā' is applied on a light letter, the ghunnah should also be light, and if Ikh'fā' is applied on a heavy letter, the ghunnah should also be heavy.

CAUTION

Articulators of ك and ق are the back of the tongue making contact with the soft palate. The sounds are produced from between these two parts.

831

When Ikh'fā' is applied on the letters ك and ق, these two cases of Ikh'fā' will be closer to Iẓhār than Ikh'fā' in terms of how you perform Ikh'fā'. In other words, in these two cases, you have to make sure to apply Ikh'fā' without leaving a gap between the articulators of ك and ق.

Listen to the following examples, and compare the correct pronunciation to the common mistake:

ق مِن قَبۡلُ

ك مِنكُمۡ

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CHAP

NUN SAKIN

IẒHAR

Pronounce CLEAR Nun

أ - هـ - ع

ح - غ - خ

Ghunnah

Shaddah

IDGH'ĀM

FULLY Assimilate Nun

TRIGGE

ي ر م ل و ن

ينمو

رل

Ghunnah

Ghunnah

Shaddah

Shaddah

TER 8

NAH RULES

IQLĀB

Convert to م

IKHFĀ'

ONLY Pronounce
Ghunnah THEN Ikhfa' letter

R LETTERS

	ب	ت - ث - ج - د - ذ - ز - س - ش ص - ض - ط - ظ - ف - ق - ك (ALL THE OTHER LETTERS)
	Ghunnah	Ghunnah
	Shaddah	Shaddah



DISCUSSION

Follow these steps to learn Chapter 8 effectively:

1. Study the four rules of Nūn Sākinah as indicated in the chapter.
2. Study the letters of each rule by heart; use the attached poster to easily access them and remember which letter trigger which rule.
3. If you have difficulty applying all four rules at once, then start applying one rule at a time and then move to the next till you have covered all four.

Task 1: Identify & highlight every Nūn Sākinah in the following āyāt.

.1 وَإِنَّ لَكَ مَوْعِدًا لَّن تُخْلَفَهُۥ

.2 وَٱذْكُرُوٓاْ إِذْ أَنتُمْ قَلِيلٌ مُّسْتَضْعَفُونَ

.3 وَقَٰتِلُوهُمْ حَتَّىٰ لَا تَكُونَ فِتْنَةٌ وَيَكُونَ ٱلدِّينُ كُلُّهُۥ لِلَّهِ

.4 وَإِمَّا تَخَافَنَّ مِن قَوْمٍ خِيَانَةً فَٱنۢبِذْ إِلَيْهِمْ عَلَىٰ سَوَآءٍ

Task 2: Match the correct set of letters to the rule of Nūn Sākinah (There is one option too many.)

1. Idghām	a. ی ر م ل و ن
2. Ikh'fā'	b. ی ن م و
3. Iẓhār	c. ب
4. Idghām met ghunnah	d. ل ن ع م ر
5. Idghām zonder ghunnah	e. أ ه غ خ ح
6. Iqlāb	f. ت ط ض ظ
	g. ر ل

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Task 3: Decide which case of Nūn Sākinah should you apply on the following āyāt and then recite it accordingly.

1. إِنَّهُۥ هُوَ ٱلسَّمِيعُ ٱلْعَلِيمُ
2. وَقَالُواْ لَوْلَا نُزِّلَ عَلَيْهِ ءَايَةٌ مِّن رَّبِّهِۦ
3. كَأَنَّهُم بُنْيَٰنٌ مَّرْصُوصٌ
4. وَأَخِى هَٰرُونُ هُوَ أَفْصَحُ مِنِّى لِسَانًا فَأَرْسِلْهُ مَعِىَ رِدْءًا يُصَدِّقُنِىٓ
5. وَإِنِّى لَأَظُنُّهُۥ مِنَ ٱلْكَٰذِبِينَ
6. قُلْ أَتَعْبُدُونَ مِن دُونِ ٱللَّهِ مَا لَا يَمْلِكُ لَكُمْ ضَرًّا وَلَا نَفْعًا
7. أَوْ يَخَافُوٓاْ أَن تُرَدَّ أَيْمَٰنٌۢ بَعْدَ أَيْمَٰنِهِمْ
8. إِنَّمَا يَسْتَجِيبُ ٱلَّذِينَ يَسْمَعُونَ وَٱلْمَوْتَىٰ يَبْعَثُهُمُ ٱللَّهُ ثُمَّ إِلَيْهِ يُرْجَعُونَ



Single-Volume Qur'an, circa 1550-60, Istanbul, attributed to Ahmed Karahisari.

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9

Mīm Sākinah

In this chapter you will learn:

- What is Mīm Sākinah?
- What Mīm Sākinah looks like in the Qur'ān.
- Ikh'fā' of Mīm Sākinah.
- Idghām of Mīm Sākinah.
- Iẓhār of Mīm Sākinah.



ORIENTATION

*Revise the definition of ghunnah. You can revisit **chapter 8** to refresh your memory about its meaning and application.*

There are a lot of similarities between Mīm Sākinah and Nūn Sākinah: both of them are nasal sounds, they both involve the use of **ghunnah**, and generally, understanding the rules of Mīm Sākinah depends on your understanding of the rules of Nūn Sākinah because of their similar division and application. Mīm Sākinah also represents a very important element in embellishing your tajweed and your Qur'ān recitation.

What is 'Mīm Sākinah'?

Similar to Nūn Sākinah, Mīm Sākinah refers to the unvowelled mīm which means that it is a mīm with sukūn on it. In the Muṣ-ḥaf, Mīm Sākinah will appear in one of two forms:

Mīm Sākinah

مْ	م
Mīm with sukūn symbol on top	**Mīm without any tashkīl symbols at all**

When any of these two shapes of Mīm Sākinah is used in the Qur'ān, it will require you to apply one of these three rules:

1	2	3
Ikh'fā'	**Idghām**	**Iẓhār**
إِخْفَاء	إِدْغَام	إِظْهَار

It is very important that you learn and study these three rules of Mīm Sākinah in the exact same order as indicated here, since these rules are put in a certain order that makes it logical and easier to move from one rule to another.

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1 Ikh'fā'

In the case of Mīm Sākinah, Ikh'fā' also means concealment. However, this type of Ikh'fā' is slightly different from that of Nūn Sākinah. The Ikh'fā' of Mīm Sākinah is called **'Ikh'fā' Shafawi'** which means 'Labial concealment', since for this type of concealment you will only be using your lips. The Ikh'fā' of Mīm Sākinah has one single trigger letter which is:

ب

How does the 'concealing' Mīm Sākinah actually work?

To apply Ikh'fā' on Mīm Sākinah, the letter mīm as well as the trigger letter ب will come from the same place directly after one another as one letter. So you start by pronouncing the mīm, and before completely pronouncing mīm, you start pronouncing bā' directly afterwards. The following chart will simplify the process of pronouncing the Ikh'fā' of Mīm Sākinah:



(2) Then opening the lips with the pronunciation of bā'

(1) Starting with mīm by slightly pressing the lips

When applying this rule, you should note the following:

- Ikh'fā' of Mīm Sākinah only occurs between two words, and never within the same word.
- When applying Ikh'fā', you should also apply ghunnah of two ḥarakāt.
- This rule is nearly identical to the rule of conversion (Iqlāb) from the rules of Nūn Sākinah, which—as covered previously—is the conversion of the nūn to a mīm before the letter bā' and its articulation with concealment (Ikh'fā') and nasalization (ghunnah).

DID YOU KNOW?

The reason behind this rule is that the letters bā and mīm are identical in their makhraj (where they are pronounced) and share most of their attributes, and therefore, the Ikh'fā' is the easiest way of articulating the two in combination.

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Let us consider the following examples:

901 1 خُذُواْ مَآ ءَاتَيۡنَٰكُم بِقُوَّةٖ وَٱسۡمَعُواْ

902 2 تَرۡمِيهِم بِحِجَارَةٖ مِّن سِجِّيلٖ

903 3 إِنَّ رَبَّهُم بِهِمۡ يَوۡمَئِذٖ لَّخَبِيرُۢ

How to perform Ikh'fā' Shafawi PROPERLY

Similar to performing Iqlāb, Ikh'fā' should also be pronounced with your lips touching (without pressing them too tightly), this means that there is no gap between the lips. This chart will demonstrate the proper shape of the lips when pronouncing the mīm of Ikh'fā'.

Too Tight	Adequate	Gap
		
✗	✓	✗

2 Idghām

Idghām (or 'assimilation') of Mīm Sākinah is the exact same concept that we have learned in chapter 8 with Nūn Sākinah, but with Mīm Sākinah it is much simpler since it involves one trigger letter which is:

م

When this happens, the first mīm is assimilated into the second mīm, and they are pronounced in turn as one doubled mīm with a ghunnah of two counts. Study the following examples:

1 Al-Baqarah, 93
2 Al-Fīl, 4
3 Al-'adiyāt, 11

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904 فِي قُلُوبِهِم مَّرَضٌ [4]

905 كُلَّمَآ أَضَآءَ لَهُم مَّشَوْا۟ [5]

The same pronunciation is performed when mīm has shaddah مَّ since we will have to apply Idghām. Don't forget that mīm with shaddah is essentially Mīm Sākinah followed by another mīm:

مَّ = مَ + م

906 وَمَا ٱللَّهُ بِغَٰفِلٍ عَمَّا تَعْمَلُونَ [6]

907 فَأَيْنَمَا تُوَلُّوا۟ فَثَمَّ وَجْهُ ٱللَّهِ [7]

Remember

When mīm or nūn have shaddah: مّ نّ , you will have to extend the ghunnah even if you stop at a word ending with them. In practice, this type of ghunnah is the heaviest type and should be the clearest type of ghunnah. Study these examples:

908 فَيَوْمَئِذٍ لَّا يُسْـَٔلُ عَن ذَنۢبِهِۦٓ إِنسٌ وَلَا جَآنٌّ [8]

909 فَٱقْذِفِيهِ فِى ٱلْيَمِّ فَلْيُلْقِهِ ٱلْيَمُّ بِٱلسَّاحِلِ [9]

In these examples we learn the following:

- If the reciter stops at the words جَآنٌّ or ٱلْيَمُّ, then you must extend the ghunnah of nūn or mīm to show that this letter has shaddah.
- The same rule applies if you keep on reading, and the ghunnah should not be affected.

4 Al-Baqarah, 10
5 Al-Baqarah, 20
6 Al-Baqarah, 74
7 Al-Baqarah, 115
8 Ar-Rahmān, 39
9 Tāhā, 39

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3 Iẓhār

The last rule of Mīm Sākinah, is the rule of Iẓhār, which is manifestation or showing Mīm Sākinah. This rule is triggered when Mīm Sākinah is followed by any of the remaining alphabet. So, basically every other letter except ب or م.

How is the 'Iẓhār' of Mīm Sākinah performed?

Performing Iẓhār is essentially pronouncing the mīm normally, like the English consonant /m/. There is no extended ghunnah, no elongation or anything of the sort, except pronouncing the mīm normally, which can be observed in these examples:

910 ٱلۡحَمۡدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ ٱلۡعَٰلَمِينَ [10]

911 إِن كُنتُمۡ صَٰدِقِينَ [11]

There is also an easy way through which you can quickly recognize the rule of Iẓhār. Study the differences between the shape of mīm (in Arabic Muṣ-ḥafs) when it is in the state of Iẓhār, and when it is in the state of Idghām or Ikh'fā':

Compare to how Nūn Sākinah with Iẓhār looks like (on page 88)

Idghām and Ikh'fā' like this	Iẓhār will look like this
مـ	مْ

Study these examples:

912 وَجَعَلۡنَا لَهُۥ نُورٗا يَمۡشِي بِهِۦ فِي ٱلنَّاسِ [12]

913 وَهُوَ وَلِيُّهُم بِمَا كَانُواْ يَعۡمَلُونَ [13]

In these examples we observe:

- When Mīm Sākinah is in a state of Iẓhār, it is used with the diacritic مْ.
- When we had to apply Ikh'fā' on Mīm Sākinah, it was used without any diacritics مْ.

10 Al-Fātihah, 2/1
11 Al-A'rāf, 194
12 Al-An'ām, 122
13 Al-An'ām, 127

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CHAP

MEEM SĀKI

IKHFĀ'

START with Mim
END with Ba'

TRIGGER

ب

وَلَا تَأْكُلُوٓاْ أَمْوَٰلَكُم بَيْنَكُم بِٱلْبَٰطِلِ

Ghunnah

Shaddah

IDGH

Fully Assi

TRIGGER

م

One word

م + م

لِمَّا

Ghunnah

Shaddah

TER 9

NAH RULES

H'ĀM

milate Mim

IẒHAR

Pronounce clear Mim

LETTERS

Two words

مَّ + م



Ghunnah

Shaddah

THE REST OF ALPHABET

ٱلْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ ٱلْعَٰلَمِينَ

Ghunnah

Shaddah



DISCUSSION

Follow these steps to learn Chapter 9 effectively:

1. Study the rules Mīm Sākinah only after studying the rules of Mīm Sākinah.
2. Use the attached poster while practicing the rules of Mīm Sākinah.

Task 1: Determine if the following statements are (true) or (false) depending on your understanding of Chapter 9.

1. Mīm Sākinah will always require you to extend its ghunnah. ( )
2. Iẓhār and Iqlāb can be applied on Mīm Sākinah just like Nūn Sākinah. ( )
3. Ikh'fā' of Mīm Sākinah requires leaving no gap between the lips. ( )
4. Mīm with shaddah is also a case of Mīm Sākinah. ( )
5. The length of the ghunnah of Mīm Sākinah depends on its position in the sentence. ( )
6. Mīm Sākinah cannot come at the beginning of a word. ( )

Task 2: Choose the correct case of Mīm Sākinah for each of the following āyāt.

1- قُلْ أَرَءَيْتَكُمْ إِنْ أَتَىٰكُمْ عَذَابُ ٱللَّهِ

a- Iẓhār
b- Ikh'fā'
c- Idghām

2- وَمَآ أَنتُم بِمُعْجِزِينَ

a- Iẓhār
b- Ikh'fā'
c- Idghām

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3- وَكُفۡرِهِم بِـَٔايَٰتِ ٱللَّهِ وَقَتۡلِهِمُ ٱلۡأَنۢبِيَآءَ

a- Iẓhār
b- Ikh'fā'
c- Idghām

4- وَإِن مِّنۡ أَهۡلِ ٱلۡكِتَٰبِ إِلَّا لَيُؤۡمِنَنَّ بِهِۦ قَبۡلَ مَوۡتِهِۦۖ

a- Iẓhār
b- Ikh'fā'
c- Idghām

5- تَرۡمِيهِم بِحِجَارَةٖ مِّن سِجِّيلٖ

a- Iẓhār
b- Ikh'fā'
c- Idghām

6- هُوَ أَنشَأَكُم مِّنَ ٱلۡأَرۡضِ

a- Iẓhār
b- Ikh'fā'
c- Idghām

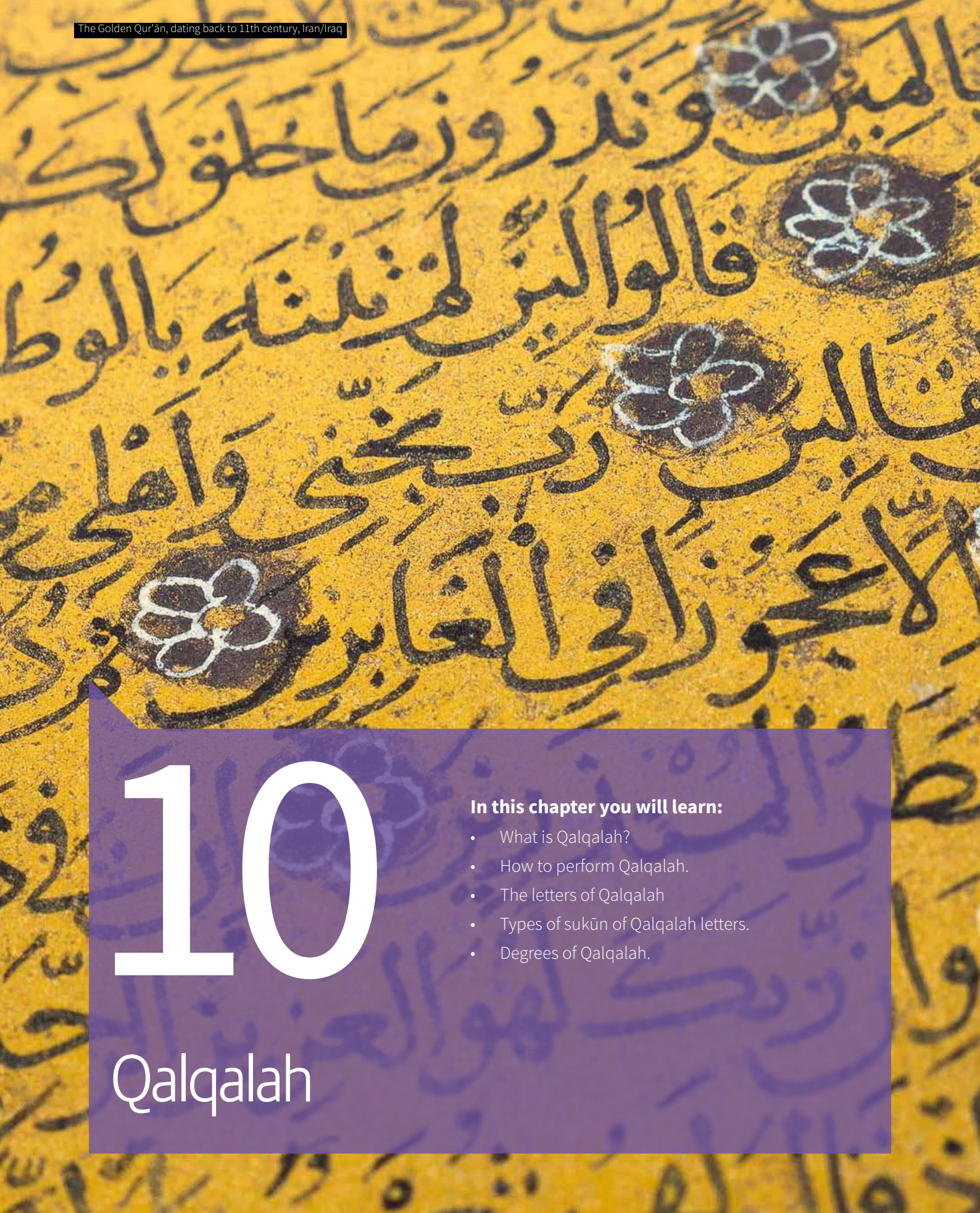
7- إِنَّ رَبَّهُم بِهِمۡ يَوۡمَئِذٖ لَّخَبِيرُۢ

a- Iẓhār
b- Ikh'fā'
c- Idghām

Challenge Question **How many 'Mīm' should you pronounce in this āyah?**

وَعَلَىٰٓ أُمَمٖ مِّمَّن مَّعَكَۚ

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The Golden Qur'ān, dating back to 11th century, Iran/Iraq

10

Qalqalah

In this chapter you will learn:

- What is Qalqalah?
- How to perform Qalqalah.
- The letters of Qalqalah
- Types of sukūn of Qalqalah letters.
- Degrees of Qalqalah.

Orientation



In Arabic, vowelled letters are produced by *parting* of two articulators, while letters with no vowels (sākin) are produced by *collision* of two articulators; in other words, two articulators close in on one another. However, with certain letters, this motion causes the articulation point to completely close. This results in the complete imprisonment of the sound (to the point that it is not distinguishable anymore), and it also causes discomfort when pronouncing these letters. That's why, Arabs used Qalqalah to get over this problem.

Articulator: is an organ used to make sounds, like tongue, lips, hard palate, soft palate, ..etc.

What is 'Qalqalah'?

The word Qalqalah قَلقَلَة literally means shaking/disturbance. Arabs would use this word to refer to a boiling pan, which is not still, but it is not moving either; rather, it is in a state of disturbance between movement and sukūn. That is exactly the idea of Qalqalah as a tajweed term: it is a state of a sound between complete sukūn (pure consonant) and vowel state. So Arabs, due to the annoyance and difficulty in pronouncing certain letters, they would apply Qalqalah on these letters.

The letter of Qalqalah are five:

Learn the Mnemonic to remember which letters receive Qalqalah

ق - ط - ب - ج - د

They form the Mnemonic

قُطْبُ جَدّ

Throughout this chapter, we will be using the term **'Qalqalah Letters'**. This term would always refer to these five letters.

How can you apply 'Qalqalah'?

The letters of Qalqalah would normally be pronounced by two articulators coming against one another, causing the sound to be trapped behind the articulation point. Applying Qalqalah is essentially freeing that trapped sound from behind the articulation point. In other words, Qalqalah letters (when they are in sukūn state) are pronounced in a way similar to how vowelled letters are pronounced, but **without** any corresponding movement of the mouth and jaw that is associated with vowelled letters.

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Here's a chart that explains how Qalqalah falls between the two states of being vowel and having sukūn:

Vowel Mechanism	Qalqalah Mechanism	Sukūn Mechanism
1. **Parting of two articulators.** 2. Jaw/ lip movement: • Fat-ḥah: opening jaws • Ḍammah: rounding lips • Kasrah: lowering jaw	1. **Parting of two articulators.** 2. **No jaw movement (only releasing trapped sound)**	1. Collision of two articulators. 2. **No jaw movement (only releasing trapped sound)**
		
The jaw movement of when pronouncing مَ	**The opening of mouth releasing Qalqalah sound when pronouncing** بْ	**The collision of lips in the letter mīm with sukūn when pronouncing** مْ

This chart illustrates how Qalqalah shares with vowels producing the sound by parting of two articulators, and at the same time it shares with sukūn the fact that there is no jaw movement when producing the sound. That's why Qalqalah is a state between sukūn and being a vowel in which you release the trapped sound without opening your jaw.



It is important to point out that Qalqalah letters differ in how you release their trapped sound. Each Qalqalah letter releases their trapped sound from their point of articulation. In other words, in the highlighted picture, we see the release of the trapped sound of بْ which happens from the lips. However, if you want to apply Qalqalah on دْ then the sound will be released at the alveolar ridge, since دْ is pronounced by pressing the tip of the tongue against the alveolar ridge. Therefore, the shape of the mouth differs according to the makhraj of each Qalqalah letter.



Qalqalah may occur in the middle or at the end of the word, but it is impossible to happen at the beginning of the word. This is because Qalqalah only applies when the Qalqalah letter has sukūn, and words in Arabic cannot start with sukūn.

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When can you apply 'Qalqalah'?

Qalqalah can be applied only when any of the Qalqalah letters are in a state of sukūn. There are two types of sukūn in the Qur'ān:

Original Sukūn السُّكُون الأَصلِي	Temporary sukūn السُّكُون العَارِض
This sukūn will always have the sukūn symbol on the Qalqalah letter This type of sukūn is not affected by stopping at or continuing to read the word; it will always be sukūn	Temporary sukūn occurs only when you stop at a word This type of sukūn disappears if you keep on reading without stopping.
قَالَ فَٱهْبِطْ مِنْهَا	قُلْ أَعُوذُ بِرَبِّ ٱلْفَلَقِ
The letter ط ,will be pronounced with Qalqalah, regardless of stopping or linking to the word after.	The letter قِ will be pronounced with Qalqalah, only if you stop at the word ٱلْفَلَقِ. If you keep on reading, there will be **no** Qalqalah at all.

What other rules related to temporary sukūn? Revise chapters 3 and 5

1001

Study the following examples:

1002

1 لَآ أُقْسِمُ بِهَٰذَا ٱلْبَلَـدِ

1003

2 كَذَٰلِكَ نَطْبَعُ عَلَىٰ قُلُوبِ ٱلْمُعْتَدِينَ

We can learn the following from these examples:

- The highlighted Qalqalah letters ق and ط will always receive Qalqalah, since they both have **original Sukūn.**
- However, د and ب will receive Qalqalah only if you stopped at these words, since **temporary sukūn** will then be generated.

TIP

1004

To check if you are performing Qalqalah properly, pronounce these:

أَطْ أَدْ أَبْ

- If you hear a muffled sound with no (audible) difference between them, then Qalqalah is not applied correctly since the sound is not released enough or at all.
- If you do, however, hear a clear difference between these combinations, then the sound is released properly.

1 Al-Balad, 1
2 Yūnus, 74

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Do all Qalqalah cases have the same degree?

We distinguish between two main degrees of Qalqalah: Major and Minor Qalqalah. In this context, the word 'degree' refers to the amount of air released following the sounds in question. This is determined by a number of factors, so each degree of Qalqalah has specific conditions:

Major Qalqalah	Minor Qalqalah
• Occurs only at the **end** of words. • The letter may have **shaddah** or **not**. • You **stop** at that word.	• Occurs only in the **middle** of words. • (OR) Occurs at the **end** of words **when linked to the next word**.



It is also logical that when Qalqalah occurs is in the middle of your recitation, you would have the weakest form of Qalqalah since the released air will be slightly overshadowed by the sounds that follows. Unlike the cases of stopping at a word ending with Qalqalah.

Study the following examples for **Major Qalqalah**:

1005 وَجَآءَتۡ سَكۡرَةُۢ ٱلۡمَوۡتِ بِٱلۡحَقِّۖ [3]

1006 قُلۡ هِيَ مَوَٰقِيتُ لِلنَّاسِ وَٱلۡحَجِّۗ [4]

1007 وَهُوَ ٱلۡغَفُورُ ٱلۡوَدُودُ [5]

1008 بَلِ ٱلَّذِينَ كَفَرُواْ فِي تَكۡذِيبٖ [6]

Study the following examples for **Minor Qalqalah**:

1009 لَقَدۡ خَلَقۡنَا ٱلۡإِنسَٰنَ فِيٓ أَحۡسَنِ تَقۡوِيمٖ [7]

1010 فَأَوۡحَىٰٓ إِلَىٰ عَبۡدِهِۦ مَآ أَوۡحَىٰ [8]

3 Qāf, 19
4 Al-Baqarah, 189
5 Al-Burūj, 14
6 Al-Burūj, 19
7 At-Tīn, 4
8 An-Najm, 10

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From these examples, we notice that applying Qalqalah is situational, which means that depending on the situation at hand, you decide if you should apply Qalqalah or not, and which degree of Qalqalah you should apply:

- If you do **not** stop at the words بِٱلْحَقِّ , وَٱلْخَيْرِ, ٱلْوَدُودُ, تَكْذِيبٍ then there is no Qalqalah at all of any degree. The reason is that when we do not stop, there is no 'temporary sukūn', and when there is no sukūn, there is no Qalqalah.
- Although the word لَقَدْ ends with a Qalqalah letter that has sukun, we will **not** apply **major** Qalqalah since we did not stop at دْ, so it came in the middle of the speech.

CAUTION

When performing Minor Qalqalah, you should be careful not to let the Qalqalah letter be affected by the letter pronounced before it or after it. It is, for example, a common mistake to pronounce:

1011 خَلَقْنَا as خَلَقَنَا and عَبْدِهِۦ as عَبِدِهِۦ

CAUTION

Applying Qalqalah on any letter other than the five Qalqalah letters is a mistake, and should not be performed.
Study and listen to the following mistakes and their correction:

1012 [9] إِيَّاكَ نَعْبُدُ وَإِيَّاكَ نَسْتَعِينُ

1013 [10] إِلَّآ إِبْلِيسَ أَبَىٰ وَٱسْتَكْبَرَ

1014 [11] وَسَيُجَنَّبُهَا ٱلْأَتْقَى

In these examples, the possible mistake have been highlighted in red. Compare and contrast between the correct and incorrect pronunciation.

Although these mistakes do not change the meaning of words, it is a mistake to apply random letter characteristics on letters that do not require them.

9 Al-Fātihah, 5
10 Al-Baqarah, 34
11 Al-Layl, 17

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CHAP

QALQ

ST

BET

VOWEL

QALQALAH

VOWELLED

ب ج د

جَدّ)

ORIGINAL

NO Qalqalah

لَخَٰطِـِٔينَ

قَالَ أَبُوهُمْ

ALWAYS Apply
Anywhere in

وَتَصَدَّقْ عَلَيْنَآ ۖ

TER 10

ALAH

TATE
WEEN

CONSONANT

LETTERS

ق ط

TEMOPRARY
SUKOON

(قُطْب

SUKOON

- ONLY When Stopping
- End of Words ONLY

Qalqalah
the word

أَفَتَطْمَعُونَ

قَالَ لَا تَثْرِيبَ

ٱلْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ

DISCUSSION

Follow these steps to learn Chapter 10 effectively:

1. Study the rules of Qalqalah and memorize the letters of Qalqalah.
2. Use the attached poster to remember the rules of Qalqalah.
3. Try and apply all the previously learned rules so far along with Qalqalah.

Task 1: Determine if the following statementes are (true) or (false) depending on your understanding of Chapter 10.

1. There are only two types of sukūn. ( )
2. Qalqalah is always applied on letters with sukūn. ( )
3. There is one degree of Qalqalah when applied on a letter. ( )
4. Qalqalah is a state between real sukūn and temporary sukūn. ( )
5. Applying Qalqalah on a non-Qalqalah letter is a clear mistake. ( )

Task 2: Study the following āyah and answer the questions that follow.

وَمَن يُعَظِّمْ شَعَـٰٓئِرَ ٱللَّهِ فَإِنَّهَا مِن تَقْوَى ٱلْقُلُوبِ

1. This āyah contains two instances of Qalqalah; what are they?
2. One of these cases can be dropped. Which case is it? When would it be dropped?

Task 3: Study the following āyah and answer the questions that follow.

جَزَآءً مِّن رَّبِّكَ عَطَآءً حِسَابًا

1. Does this āyah contain Qalqalah; why? Why not?
2. Mention two Tajweed rules you have studied that you can find in this āyah.

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Task 4: Do these āyāt contain (possible) Qalqalah?

1. إِنَّ لِلْمُتَّقِينَ مَفَازًا ﴿٣١﴾ حَدَآئِقَ وَأَعْنَٰبًا
2. حَتَّىٰٓ إِذَا هَلَكَ قُلْتُمْ لَن يَبْعَثَ ٱللَّهُ مِنۢ بَعْدِهِۦ رَسُولًا
3. لَّيْسَ عَلَى ٱلْأَعْمَىٰ حَرَجٌ وَلَا عَلَى ٱلْأَعْرَجِ حَرَجٌ
4. ذَٰلِكُم بِمَا كُنتُمْ تَفْرَحُونَ فِى ٱلْأَرْضِ بِغَيْرِ ٱلْحَقِّ
5. وَأَذِّن فِى ٱلنَّاسِ بِٱلْحَجِّ يَأْتُوكَ رِجَالًا وَعَلَىٰ كُلِّ ضَامِرٍ يَأْتِينَ مِن كُلِّ فَجٍّ عَمِيقٍ

Challenge Question **Recite Sūrah At-Tāriq and afterwards listen to a recitation of that sūrah, and compare your application of Qalqalah.**

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11 Assimilation

In this chapter you will learn:

- Types of sukūn in the Qur'ān
- Types of assimilation
- Assimilating identical letters
- Assimilating similar letters.

ORIENTATION

The default articulation of any letter in the Qur'ān is 'Iẓhār' which is a clear pronunciation of the letter. In certain cases, letters get assimilated or merged into one another to make their pronunciation easier and more sound. Assimilating or merging letters only occurs when they have sukūn. In any Arabic Muṣ-ḥaf, when a letter has sukūn, it appears in one of **two states**:

Urdu and Turkish Muṣ-ḥafs do apply different rules in that respect.

With Sukūn symbol	Without any symbols
بْ	ب

One of the major signs of 'Iẓhār' in the Qur'ān is the sukūn diacritic ْ which indicates that the letter will be fully and completely pronounced.

However, when a letter has sukūn without the diacritic ْ, it either indicates Idghām, Ikh'fā', or Iqlāb. In other words, it is an indication of the application of a special rule on the letter. Since this chapter is concerned with letter assimilation, this type of letters is the main focus of this chapter.

Letters that have sukūn without a diacritic come <u>in four categories</u>.

- **Sun Lām**
  - Full Assimilation (Idghām)
  - This is called (Idghām Shamsi) إِدغَامٌ شَمسِيّ and we discussed its rules fully in **Chapter 7**
- **Nūn/ Mīm Sākinah**
  - Assimilation (Idghām)
  - Merging (Ikh'fā')
  - Iqlāb (Conversion)
  - The rules of Nūn Sākinah and Mīm Sākinah were explained in **Chapter 8** and **Chapter 9**
- **Identical Letters**
  - Full Assimilation (Idghām)
- **Similar Letters**
  - Full/ Partial Assimilation (Idghām)

These types of assimilation will be discussed in this chapter

EXCEPTION

Natural Madd letters have sukūn without the diacritic ْ and yet we apply Iẓhār on them, and we pronounce them fully.

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What is the difference between identical letters and similar letters?

Identical letters	Similar letters
Identical letters are the exact same letters even if have a different diacritic.	Similar letters share either the point of articulation 'makhraj' or they share a characteristic
ك كَ These letters are identical because they are exactly the same with a different diacritic.	ت ط These two letters are similar because they share the point of articulation, but are different in their characteristics

Identical Letters

When two identical letters follow one another and the first of which has sukūn, **only the second letter will be pronounced with shaddah**. This means that the first of the two identical letters will be **fully assimilated** into the second letter; thus the shaddah (duplication).

Study the following examples:

1101

1 فَلَا يُسۡرِف فِّي ٱلۡقَتۡلِۖ

1102

2 وَإِذَا جَآءُوكُمۡ قَالُوٓاْ ءَامَنَّا وَقَد دَّخَلُواْ بِٱلۡكُفۡرِ

Assimilation between two words will not occur, when stopping at the first of the two words (so not linking it to the word that follows) and you will pronounce the first word fully with Iẓhār.

In these examples, we can observe the following:

- The first of the two identical letters has no diacritic on top or under it, and therefore it is fully assimilated into the second letter.
- The final result is that the phrases are pronounced as يُسۡرِفِّي and قَدَّخَلُواْ respectively.

Assimilation may also occur within the same word (so two identical letters in one word), like these examples:

1103

3 وَمَن يُكۡرِههُّنَّ

1104

4 أَيۡنَمَا تَكُونُواْ يُدۡرِككُّمُ ٱلۡمَوۡتُ

In these examples, we can observe the following:

- The first of the two identical letters has no diacritic, which is an indication of assimilation.
- After assimilation, these words are pronounced as يُكۡرِهُنَّ and يُدۡرِكُّمُ respectively.

1 Al-Isrā', 33
2 Al-Mā'idah, 61
3 An-Nūr, 33
4 An-Nisā', 78

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CAUTION

Identical letters are not always assimilated; there are two instances where identical letters cannot be assimilated:

1. **The first of the two identical letters does not have sukūn.**

1105

نُؤْمِنُ بِبَعْضٍ وَنَكْفُرُ بِبَعْضٍ [5]

1106

مِنۢ بَعْدِ إِكْرَٰهِهِنَّ [6]

In these examples, there aren't any case of assimilation in spite of the occurrence of two identical letters one after the other. The reason is that the first letter has no sukūn.

2. **The two identical letters are و or ى**

1107

لَّقَدْ كَانَ فِى يُوسُفَ [7]

1108

إِنَّ ٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُواْ وَعَمِلُواْ ٱلصَّٰلِحَٰتِ [8]

The letters و and ى must not be assimilated because they are not identical though they seem that they are:

What are Madd letters? What are their conditions? Revise Chapter 4

- The first ى in the word فِى is a Madd letter which is pronounced at an articulation point (makhraj) different from the يُـ in the word يُوسُفَ since it is not a Madd letter.
- Similarly the letter و in the word ءَامَنُواْ is a Madd letter which is pronounced at a makhraj different from وَ .

In other words, they are the same letter, but they do not produce the same sound - compare the sound of the letter '**u**' in: '**u**niversity' and '**u**mbrella'. We cannot argue that these words start with a different letter, but at the same time, we cannot claim that they sound the same. Similarly, the letters و and ى have different pronunciation when they function as Madd letters from when they function as līn letters or semi-vowels.

5 An-Nisā', 150
6 An-Nūr, 33
7 Yūsuf, 7
8 Hūd, 23

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Similar Letters

When similar letters follow one another and the first of which has sukūn, they get **fully or partially assimilated** depending on the strength of the first of the two letters. This means that the second letter will be pronounced with shaddah since the first of the two letters is assimilated into it.

There are 8 cases of full assimilation and 1 case of partial assimilation:

The best strategy to learn these cases is by learning them through listening to the examples.

1 ت + ط

- The letter ت has sukūn without a sukūn symbol and it is followed by ط which is a similar letter.
- The two letters become fully assimilated into the letter ط with shaddah.
- This case of assimilation **only** happens between the **two words**.

1109

وَقَالَت طَّآئِفَةٌ مِّنْ أَهْلِ ٱلْكِتَٰبِ [9]

The two words should be pronounced as وَقَالَطَّآئِفَةٌ

2 ذ + ظ

- The two letters become fully assimilated into the letter ظ with shaddah.
- This case of assimilation only happens between two words.
- These are the only **two** cases of this type of assimilation in the Qur'ān.

1110

وَلَن يَنفَعَكُمُ ٱلْيَوْمَ إِذ ظَّلَمْتُمْ أَنَّكُمْ فِى ٱلْعَذَابِ مُشْتَرِكُونَ [10]

We should pronounce the two words as إِظَّلَمْتُمْ

1111

وَلَوْ أَنَّهُمْ إِذ ظَّلَمُوٓاْ أَنفُسَهُمْ جَآءُوكَ فَٱسْتَغْفَرُواْ ٱللَّه [11]

We should pronounce the two words as إِظَّلَمُوٓا

9 Āl-i ʻimrān, 72
10 Az-Zukhruf, 39
11 An-Nisā', 64

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3 ب + مّ

If these letters are reversed like this: م + ب
What would we call this rule?

1112

- The two letters become fully assimilated into the letter مّ with shaddah.
- This is the only case of this type of assimilation in the Qur'ān:

12 يَٰبُنَيَّ ٱرۡكَب مَّعَنَا وَلَا تَكُن مَّعَ ٱلۡكَٰفِرِينَ

We should pronounce the two words as ٱرۡكَّمَّعَنَا

4 ق + كّ

- The two letters become fully assimilated into the letter كّ with shaddah.
- This is the **only** case of this kind of assimilation:

1113

13 أَلَمۡ نَخۡلُقكُّم مِّن مَّآءٖ مَّهِينٖ

We should pronounce the two words as نَخۡلُكُّم

5 د + تّ

- The two letters become fully assimilated into the letter تّ with shaddah.
- This case of assimilation only happens between the two words and one word.

1114

14 قَد تَّبَيَّنَ ٱلرُّشۡدُ مِنَ ٱلۡغَيِّۚ

We should pronounce the two words as قَتَّبَيَّن

1115

15 وَلَآ أَنَا۠ عَابِدٞ مَّا عَبَدتُّمۡ

We should pronounce the two words as عَبَتُّمۡ

12 Hūd, 42
13 Al-Mursalāt, 20
14 Al-Baqarah, 256
15 Al-Kāfirūn, 4

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6 ت + دّ

- The two letters become fully assimilated into the letter دّ with shaddah.
- This case of assimilation **only** happens between **two words**.
- There are only **two** instances of this type of assimilation in the Qur'ān.

1116

فَلَمَّآ أَثۡقَلَت دَّعَوَا ٱللَّهَ رَبَّهُمَا [16]

We should pronounce the two words as أَثۡقَلَدَّعَوَا

7 ل + رّ

- The two letters become fully assimilated into the letter رّ with shaddah.
- This case of assimilation **only** happens between **two words**.

1117

بَل رَّفَعَهُ ٱللَّهُ إِلَيۡهِۚ [17]

We should pronounce the two words as بَرَّفَعَهُ

8 ث + ذّ

- The two letters become fully assimilated into the letter ذّ with shaddah.
- This case of assimilation the **only** case of this type of assimilation.

1118

إِن تَحۡمِلۡ عَلَيۡهِ يَلۡهَثۡ أَوۡ تَتۡرُكۡهُ يَلۡهَثۚ ذَّٰلِكَ مَثَلُ ٱلۡقَوۡمِ [18]

We should pronounce the two words as يَلۡهَثۡ ذَّٰلِكَ

16 Al-A'rāf, 189
17 An-Nisā', 158
18 Al-A'rāf, 176

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1 ط + تّ

- The assimilation between these two letters is a **partial assimilation**, which means that both letters **will still be pronounced but only partially.**
- Partial assimilation happens because of how strong the characteristics of ط are, which means it is not possible to fully assimilate it into ت.
- Partial assimilation is performed by starting to pronounce ط (with no Qalqalah) but then you release the sound as would normally do when pronouncing ت.
- This case of assimilation only happens between the two words but also within the same word.

1119 لَئِنۢ بَسَطتَ إِلَيَّ يَدَكَ لِتَقۡتُلَنِي [19]

1120 مَا فَرَّطتُمۡ فِي يُوسُفَ ۖ [20]

1121 فَمَكَثَ غَيۡرَ بَعِيدٖ فَقَالَ أَحَطتُ بِمَا لَمۡ تُحِطۡ بِهِۦ [21]

CAUTION

When assimilation exists between two words, this assimilation will not be pronounced unless you keep on reading. If you stop at the end of the first word, you will fully pronounce that last letter.

So in this āyah:

1122 يَٰبُنَيَّ ٱرۡكَب مَّعَنَا وَلَا تَكُن مَّعَ ٱلۡكَٰفِرِينَ [22]

If you had to perform an emergency stop at the word ٱرۡكَب then you will fully pronounce the letter ب at the end of the word, and assimilation will only happen when you connect it to the word after it مَّعَنَا.

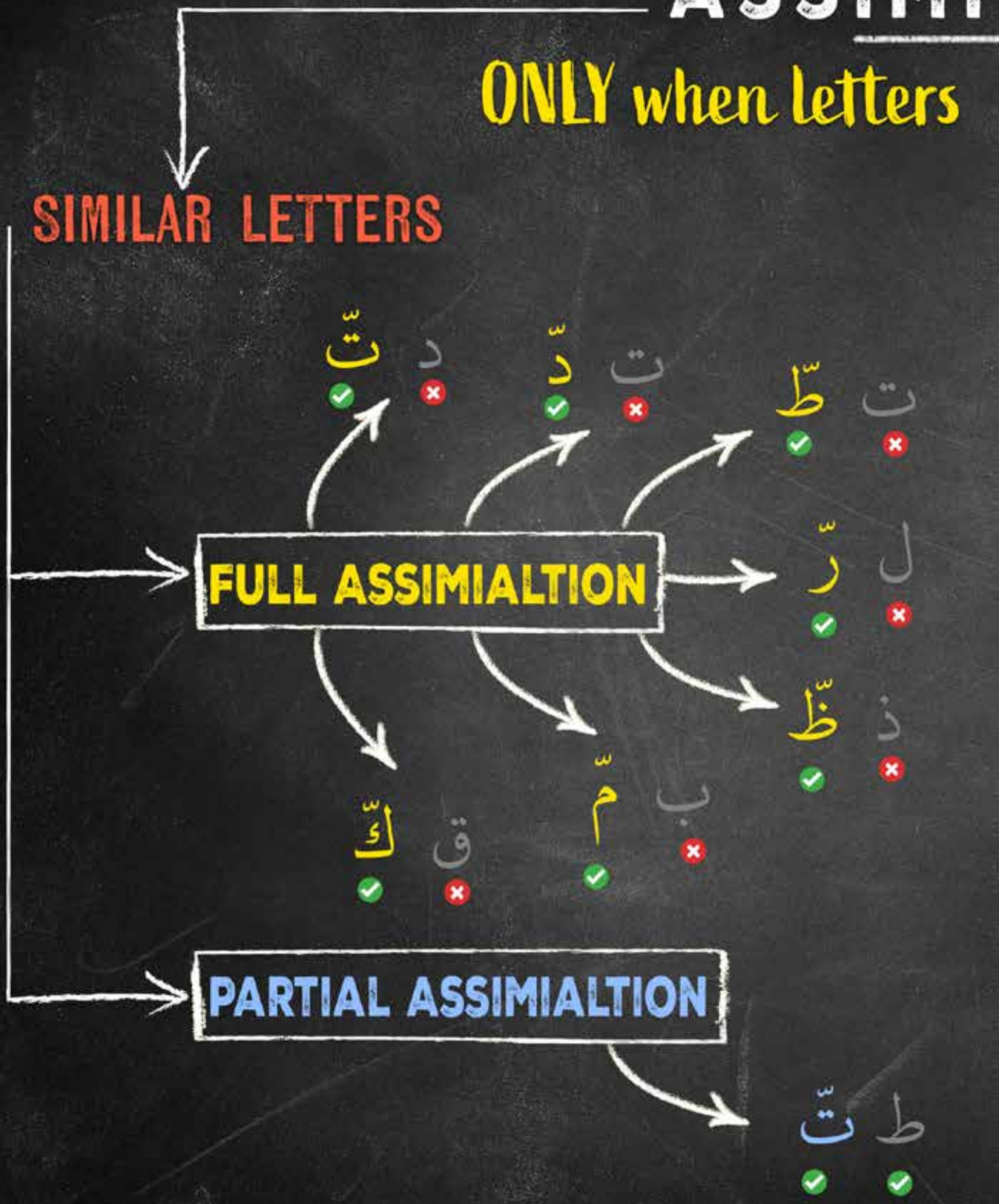
19 Al-Mā'idah, 28
20 Yūsuf, 80
21 An-Naml, 22
22 Hūd, 42

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CHAP

ASSIMI

ONLY when letters



TER 11

LATION

have NO Symbols

IDENTICAL LETTERS





DISCUSSION

Follow these steps to learn Chapter 11 effectively:

1. Study the two new cases of assimilation and revise (if necessary) the first two cases of assimilation from chapters 6, 7, 8 and 9.
2. Use the attached poster to remember the combinations of assimilation.

Task 1: Match the āyah on the left with the proper condition on the right (you may choose more than one condition from the right if the āyah requires it.)

1	وَٱلَّذِينَ هُمۡ لِلزَّكَوٰةِ فَٰعِلُونَ	a	Sun Lām Assimilation
2	وَذَا ٱلنُّونِ إِذ ذَّهَبَ مُغَٰضِبًا	b	Nūn/ Mīm Assimilation
3	وَهُوَ ٱلَّذِى يُحۡىِۦ وَيُمِيتُ	c	Identical Letter Assimilation
4	يُسَبِّحُ لَهُۥ فِيهَا بِٱلۡغُدُوِّ وَٱلۡأَصَالِ	d	Similar Letters Assimilation
5	لَن نَّصۡبِرَ عَلَىٰ طَعَامٍ وَٰحِدٍ	e	No Assimilation
6	قَدۡ جَآءَتۡكُم مَّوۡعِظَةٌ		
7	قَد تَّبَيَّنَ ٱلرُّشۡدُ مِنَ ٱلۡغَىِّۚ		
8	مَا فَرَّطتُمۡ فِى يُوسُفَ		

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Task 2: Answer the following questions for each of these āyāt.

1. Which ones contain one or more types of assimilation?
2. What kind of assimilation is it?
3. If you found none, why is there no assimilation?

1 فَمَا رَبِحَت تِّجَٰرَتُهُمۡ وَمَا كَانُواْ مُهۡتَدِينَ

2 أَيۡنَمَا تَكُونُواْ يُدۡرِككُّمُ ٱلۡمَوۡتُ

3 وَظِلَٰلُهُم بِٱلۡغُدُوِّ وَٱلۡأٓصَالِ

4 ٱذۡهَب بِّكِتَٰبِي هَٰذَا

5 وَلَوۡ أَنَّهُمۡ إِذ ظَّلَمُوٓاْ أَنفُسَهُمۡ

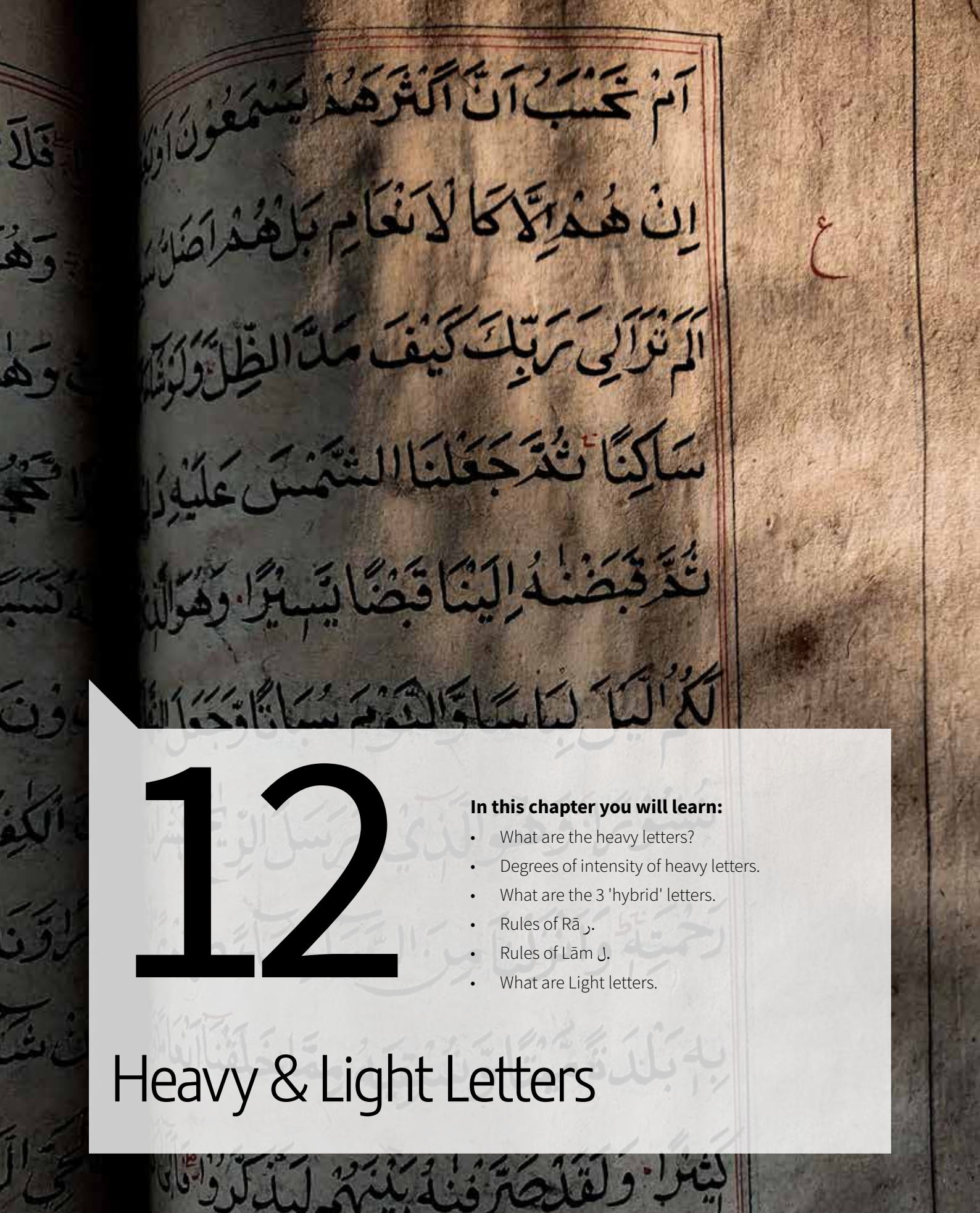
6 وَلَٰكِن يُؤَاخِذُكُم بِمَا عَقَّدتُّمُ ٱلۡأَيۡمَٰنَۖ

7 وَقُل رَّبِّ زِدۡنِي عِلۡمًا

8 لَئِنۢ بَسَطتَ إِلَيَّ يَدَكَ لِتَقۡتُلَنِي

Task 3: Mention two signs through which we can identify a case of assimilation easily.

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12

In this chapter you will learn:

- What are the heavy letters?
- Degrees of intensity of heavy letters.
- What are the 3 'hybrid' letters.
- Rules of Rā ر.
- Rules of Lām ل.
- What are Light letters.

Heavy & Light Letters

Orientation

Each letter in the Arabic alphabet produces a sound that is either heavy or light. Heavy and light letters are also referred to as 'Full-mouth letters' and 'Empty-mouth letters' which gives an indication as to how these letters should be pronounced. In Arabic, the heaviness of a letter is called تَفخِيم 'Tafkhīm' and lightness of a letter is called تَرقِيق 'Tarqīq'. The concept of تَفخِيم and تَرقِيق deals with the inherent characteristics of letters in Arabic. This means that the improper application of these characteristics may potentially affect or even change the meaning of the āyah. Therefore, not applying the attributes of heaviness and lightness on your recitation can actually lead to making a clear mistake.

What's the difference between a hidden mistake and a clear mistake?

Check Chapter 1

Letters in Arabic are, therefore, divided in three categories:

Throughout this chapter, the degree of color will also indicate the degree of heaviness and lightness of a letter

Heavy Letters	Hybrid Letters	Light Letters
7 letters	3 letters	19 letters
خ ص ض غ ط ق ظ	ا ل ر	The rest of alphabet
These letters are **always** heavy letters	These letters can function as heavy and light letters	These letters are **always** light letters

Heavy Letters

There are **seven** letters that must be pronounced heavily - with 'tafkhīm':

خ ص ض غ ط ق ظ

They form the mnemonic:

خُصَّ ضَغطٍ قِظ

Use the mnemonic to easily remember which letters are pronounced as heavy letters.

Like in these examples:

1201

1 وَٱلضُّحَىٰ

1202

2 غَيْرِ ٱلْمَغْضُوبِ

1 Ad-Duhā, 1
2 Al-Fātihah, 7

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Strictly speaking, there are five degrees of 'tafkhīm' but the most noticeable difference for the beginner's ears is between the first and last degree.

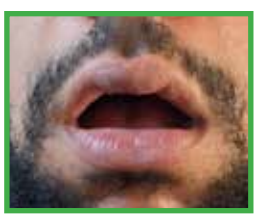
There are majorly **two degrees** of intensity of the heavy letters:

Least Heavy	Heaviest
Heavy letters are at the lowest degree when they have 'kasrah'. They come closer to being a light letter than heavy at this point.	Heavy letters are at the highest degree of intensity and fullness when followed by 'alif'.
صِرَٰطَ ٱلْقِيَٰمَةِ ٱلْخِزْىَ طِينًا	صَٰبِرُونَ ٱلْقَارِعَةُ خَٰسِرِينَ ٱلطَّآمَّةُ

1203

CAUTION

One of the most common mistakes that many beginners make while trying to apply 'tafkhīm' on a letter, is rounding the lips when producing the sound. Here is a comparison between the proper and wrong shape of the mouth for the word: خَيْر



Proper Shape (no rounding)



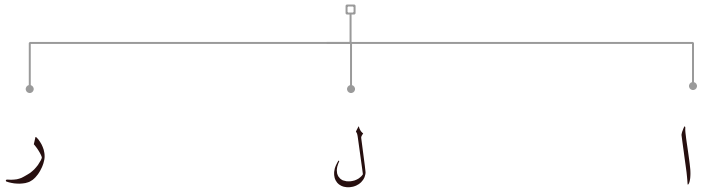
Wrong Shape (Rounded lips)

Applying 'tafkhīm' should rather be performed by making your mouth as hollow from the inside as possible to allow the sound to fill all of the inside of your mouth. This is achieved by raising the back of the tongue while pronouncing the letter. This movement creates a concave shape of the tongue creating the 'heaviness' of the letter.

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Hybrid Letters

There are three letters that can function as **both heavy and light letters**:



Rules of alif ا



It is important to emphasize that these rules apply only to alif ا, **not hamzah**. In Arabic, **Hamzah** is a light letter, and cannot be used as a heavy letter at all. To remember the possible shapes and forms of Hamzah in Arabic, revise Chapter 6: Hamzah.

Alif can function as a **heavy letter**, and therefore, pronounced as /ɑ/ as in c**a**r, but it can also be a **light letter** and so, it would be pronounced as /æ/ as in c**a**t. This is determined by the nature of the letter preceding alif.

This means that if alif was preceded by a heavy letter, it would be pronounced as a heavy letter, and if it was preceded by a light letter, it would be pronounced as a light letter. Study the following examples:

Light Alif	**Heavy Alif**
1204 نَادَىٰ	يُخَٰدِعُونَ
Alif is pronounced with تَرقِيق here because the letter ن came before it. The letter ن does not belong to the seven letters of heavy letters or hybrid letters, so it is a light letter.	Alif is pronounced with تَفخِيم here because the letter خ came before it, which is one of the seven heavy letters.
1205 إِيَّاكَ	ٱلضَّآلِّينَ

Alif will still follow the rule normally even if it has a Madd, or it was preceded by a shaddah, it has no effects on the application of the rule whatsoever.

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Rules of Rā ر

The letter ر is a heavy letter by default. In other words, the name of the letter ر is pronounced with a heavy sound, and it mostly used in the Qur'ān as a heavy ر. However, **there are 4 cases in which ر is pronounced as a light letter:**

1 **If the rā ر had a kasrah**

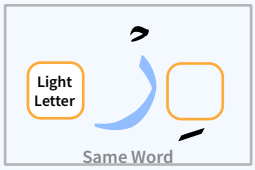


Regardless of the context, the letter rā ر is pronounced as a light letter if it has a kasrah, like what we see in these examples:

1206

رِزقًا فَرِحَ رِجَالٌ

2 **If the rā ر had a sukūn, followed a letter with kasrah, and no heavy letter came after it (in the same word)**



As shown in the chart, the letter rā ر is pronounced as a light letter if it meets these three conditions:

1. Rā ر has a sukūn.
2. It was preceded by a letter that has an **original kasrah** in the same word.
3. It was followed by a light letter.

Like what we see in these examples:

1207

أُمِرْتُ شِرْعَةً فِرْعَوْنَ

3 **If the rā ر had a sukūn at the end of a word and the letter before also had sukūn, and the letter before it had kasrah**



Rā ر is pronounced **as a light letter** when stopping at a word ending with it when the letter before it has sukūn and the letter before that has kasrah; like in these examples:

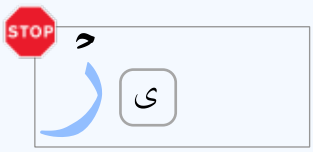
1208

ٱلذِّكْرِ ٱلسِّحْرَ حِجْرٍ

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What is the difference between original sukūn and temporary sukūn?

4 If the rā ر had a sukūn at the end of a word and preceded by an unvowelled yā'



When stopping at a word ending with rā ر, this causes the temporary sukūn on it at the end of the word. When it is then preceded by yā', we pronounce rā ر as a light letter. Here are some examples demonstrating this rule:

1209

بِخَيْرٍ بَصِيرٌ خَبِيرٌ

This also means if you do not stop at rā ر in these conditions, or if there is a vowel on top of the yā', then rā ر will be pronounced normally as a heavy letter.

TIP

The best way to master the rules of rā ر is to focus on these four rules above, and anything that does not follow these four patterns, it would mean that rā ر is in its default state of being a heavy /full-mouth letter.

The other cases of rā ر used as a heavy letter in its default state, which is much more common, occur when rā ر:

1	2	3	4	5
رُ	رَ	Heavy Letter رْ Same Word	ٱرْ	STOP رُ رَ
Has fat-ḥah or ḍammah	Has sukūn and preceded by a letter with fat-ḥah or dammah	Has sukūn and followed by a heavy letter	Has sukūn and preceded by Hamzat Al-Waṣl	Has (temporary)sukūn, and preceded by sukūn, but the letter before has fat-ḥah or ḍammah
مَّعْرُوفًا	أَرْبَعَةَ	مِرْصَادًا	ٱرْتَابُوٓاْ	وَٱلْفَجْرِ
تَرَكَ	ٱلْقُرْبَىٰ	قِرْطَاسٍ	ٱرْجِعُوٓاْ	عَشْرٍ
1210	1211	1212	1213	1214

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Rules of Lām ل

The letter ل is pronounced as a light letter in the entire Qur'ān, which means that we pronounce it like the typical English /l/ as in the word (**l**ook). study these examples:

1215

3 وَعَنَتِ ٱلۡوُجُوهُ لِلۡحَيِّ ٱلۡقَيُّومِۖ

1216

4 ٱللَّهُ لَآ إِلَٰهَ إِلَّا هُوَ ٱلۡحَيُّ ٱلۡقَيُّومُۚ

However, there is one single exception to this rule, and that is the Honored Word, ٱللَّهُ.

The rules of pronouncing the lām in the Honored Word were extensively explained in Chapter 7. Since the Honored Word is the only exception to this rule, lām is pronounced as a light letter in every other position.

Light Letters

The third category of letters in Arabic is light letters. And these letters actually make up the majority of Arabic Alphabet. It is, therefore, recommended to only study the first two categories: Heavy letters and Hybrid letters, and any other letter other than the ten letters of these two categories would automatically fall under the light category.

Study the following examples for empty mouth letters.

1217

5 فَقَدِ ٱسۡتَمۡسَكَ بِٱلۡعُرۡوَةِ ٱلۡوُثۡقَىٰ

1218

6 أَلَمۡ تَرَ كَيۡفَ فَعَلَ رَبُّكَ بِعَادٍ

These examples also show the difference in frequency between heavy and light letters, which clearly demonstrates that the majority of letter pronunciation in the Qur'ān depends on light letters.

3 Tāhā, 111
4 Āl-i ʿimrān, 2
5 Al-Baqarah, 256
6 Al-Fajr, 6

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Disassociating letters from each other

The concept of dissociating or freeing letters from each other refers to the ability to pronounce heavy and light letters properly when they are in close proximity to each others without getting affected by the letters before or after them. This concept of separating or dissociating letters from each other is essential in tajweed to maintain the correct pronunciation and preserve the integrity of each word in the Qur'ān.

Study these examples:

خَلَقَ　　نَصِيرٌ　　ٱلْمُطَلَّقَٰتُ

In these examples, we observe that in certain cases, light letters are surrounded by heavy letters (خَلَقَ) and sometimes heavy letters are surrounded by light letters (نَصِيرٌ) and sometimes you have to keep switching between heavy and light letters (ٱلْمُطَلَّقَٰتُ).

It important to know that these situation may cause some pronunciation mistakes, and therefore, learners should pay extra attention when dealing with such words.

You can also practice these words using the following steps:

It would also help if you listen to a recording of the words you want to practice to compare what they should sound like in context.

1 Pronounce the letter you want to separate on its own. This helps you to maintain the shape of the tongue when it is added to other sounds with different characteristics:

ـلَـ　　ـصِـ　　ـطَـ

2 Pronounce that letter along with the letter that follows it. This helps you practice the first combination separately.

لَق　　صِيرٌ　　لَّق

3 Pronounce the letter before it on its own.

خَـ　　كَـ　　مُـ

4 Pronounce both parts from step 2 & step 3 with a short pause in between them.

خَـ لَق　　كَـ صِيرٌ　　مُـ طَلَّق

5 Now pronounce the word or the syllable by maintaining the same sounds.

خَلَقَ　　نَصِيرٌ　　ٱلْمُطَلَّقَـٰتُ

Listen to the five stages of practice to apply on other words as well.

1219　　1220　　1221

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CHAPT

HEAVY LETTERS

(خُصَّ ضَغْطٍ قَظّ)

خ ص ض غ ط ق ظ

LEAST HEAVY

خِص ضِغِط قِظ

HEAVIEST

خص ضغط قظ +

HYBRID

ا

ل

HEAV

أَخْرِجْ

فِرْعَوْنَ

Light

الحِجْرِ

رُ

End of the Word

خَبِير

رُ

HEAVY IN THE WORD اللَّه UNLESS:

اللَّهِ قُلِ ٱللَّهُ

اللَّهِ قَوْمًا ٱللَّهُ

TER 12

& LIGHT LETTERS

THE REST OF ALPHABET

LETTERS

ر

Y UNLESS:

ـِـر

Same Word

ـِـرْ

ـِـ

ـِـ ى

ا

HEAVY

LIGHT

ا Heavy

ا Light

ٱلطَّآمَّةُ

ٱلْقُرْءَانُ

مَقَامَ

كِتَابٌ



DISCUSSION

Follow these steps to learn Chapter 12 effectively:

1. Study the heavy, light and hybrid letters.
2. Use the attached poster to remember the rules to apply heavy and light letters.

Task 1: Choose the correct answer; letters of tafkhīm are:

a خص ضط قظ only

b خص ضغظ قط + ل ا ر

c خص ضغظ قط + ل ر

d خص ضغظ قط + ل ر

e خص ضغظ قط + ر

Task 2: Decide if the highlighted words should be.

(1) Heavy (Tafkhīm state)

(2) Light (Tarqīq state)

(3) Can be both heavy and light

زُرْتُمُ	ر	ٱلْعَٰلَمِينَ	ا
قِرْطَاسٍ	ر	خَٰلِدِينَ	خ
مِرْصَادًا	ر	سُبْحَٰنَكَ ٱللَّهُمَّ	ل
فِرْقٍ	ر	ٱلْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ	ل
ٱلْقُرْءَانُ	ا	رِزْقًا	ر

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Task 3: Choose the correct answer: To pronounce the word قَالَ which mouth shape is the correct one?

a.   **.b**

Challenge Question **Study the following āyāt; decide which letters are light and which are heavy, then recite the āyah out loud accordingly.**

وَٱذۡكُرۡ فِي ٱلۡكِتَٰبِ مَرۡيَمَ إِذِ ٱنتَبَذَتۡ مِنۡ أَهۡلِهَا مَكَانٗا شَرۡقِيّٗا

فَخَلَفَ مِنۢ بَعۡدِهِمۡ خَلۡفٌ أَضَاعُواْ ٱلصَّلَوٰةَ وَٱتَّبَعُواْ ٱلشَّهَوَٰتِۖ فَسَوۡفَ يَلۡقَوۡنَ غَيّٗا

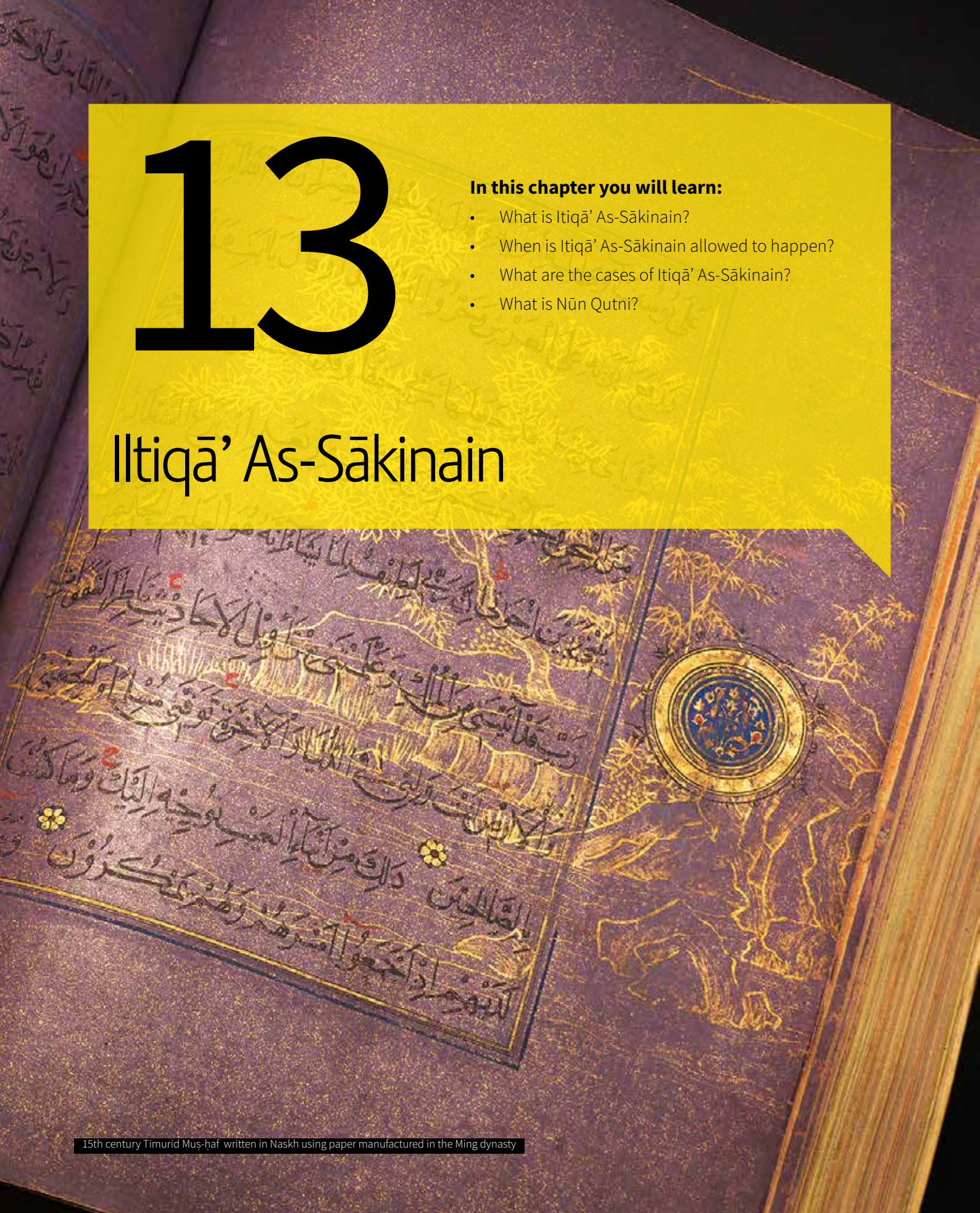
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13

Iltiqā' As-Sākinain

In this chapter you will learn:

- What is Itiqā' As-Sākinain?
- When is Itiqā' As-Sākinain allowed to happen?
- What are the cases of Itiqā' As-Sākinain?
- What is Nūn Qutni?



15th century Timurid Muṣ-ḥaf written in Naskh using paper manufactured in the Ming dynasty

ORIENTATION



Itiqā' As-Sākinain (اِلتِقَاءُ السَّاكِنَين) literally means, 'two consecutive consonants', and in terms of Tajweed, it refers to the rule which prevents two **consonants** from following one another.

A consonant is any letter that is free from ـَ ـُ ـِ whether it has sukūn symbol ـْ or no symbols at all.

Revise Chapter 11 to revise the types of letters with sukūn

In Arabic, it is not possible for two consonants to follow one another just like when the two south poles of a magnet repel. The reason for this is that the pronunciation of such words becomes too heavy, and so Arabs avoid pronouncing two consecutive consonants, and they would replace the sukūn on the first of the two with a short vowel so that the word can be read easily.

'Itiqā' As-Sākinain' can happen in two situations in the Qur'ān:

- **Within the same word**
- **Between two words**

Same Word

While the rule of 'Itiqā' As-Sākinain' prevents two consonants from following one another, if this happens within the same word, it does not cause any problems, and it is pronounced normally without any changes. The reason is that there are always elements that lessen the heaviness resulting from two consonants following one another within the same word. This case occurs in two situations:

1301

1 Temporary sukūn preceded by original sukūn

وَٱلۡعَصۡرِ ⟵ وَٱلۡعَصۡرۡ

لِإِيلَٰفِ قُرَيۡشٍ ⟵ لِإِيلَٰفِ قُرَيۡشۡ

وَإِيَّاكَ نَسۡتَعِينُ ⟵ وَإِيَّاكَ نَسۡتَعِينۡ

Remember: Madd letters and Līn letters are always in a state of sukūn.

In such cases, if the letter before last contains an original sukūn ـْ and you stop at that word, you would end up with two consecutive consonants, like when stopping on the word وَٱلۡعَصۡرِ or قُرَيۡشٍ or نَسۡتَعِينُ.

1302

2 Madd letter followed by shaddah

ٱلضَّآلِّينَ

جَآنٌّ

This case was also explained in Chapter 5, and it is a case called

Since the three Madd letters (و ا ى) are always in a state of sukūn, **when they are followed by shaddah** (which contains a letter with sukūn), it causes two consecutive consonants as well.

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DID YOU KNOW?

It is even possible to have **three** consecutive consonants within the same word, and it would still be acceptable and pronounced normally. Observe this word:

ٱلْجَآنَّ	When stopping at it	ٱ ل ْ ج َ ا ن ّ ن

This word ends with a duplicated نّ, So when stopping at it, the first ن has an original sukūn, and the second ن will have temporary sukūn and they are preceded by a a Madd letter which is always in a state of sukūn.

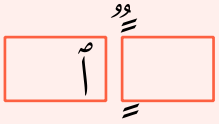
Two Words

The Qur'ān contains many cases where a word ends with consonant, and the word after starts with a consonant, but most of these cases of 'Iltiqā' As-Sākinain' have been prevented in the muṣ-ḥaf in advance, like these examples:

1303 مَّنِ ٱهْتَدَىٰ لَكُمُ ٱلْيَوْمَ أَم ٱرْتَابُوٓاْ

The tashkīl of these cases of 'Iltiqā' As-Sākinain' have already been adjusted to prevent two consonants from following one another, and so you should just read them as they are. However, there are two cases in the Qur'ān that cannot be prevented by adding tashkīl symbols:

1 When Tanwīn is followed by Hamzat Al-Waṣl ٱ



The first case of 'Iltiqā' As-Sākinain' occurs when a word ends with a **tanwīn** (which is essentially a Nūn Sākinah), and the word after starts with **Hamzat Al-Waṣl** ٱ. The reason why 'Iltiqā' As-Sākinain' happens is that Hamzat Al-Waṣl ٱ is always followed by a letter with sukūn, and when you keep on reading, Hamzat Al-Waṣl is dropped.

Preventing this type of 'Iltiqā' As-Sākinain' is done by adding kasrah to the Nūn Sākinah (tanwīn) at the end of the first word.



Pronounced as



1304 نُوحٌ ٱبْنَهُ — نُوحُنِ بْنَهُ

1305 وَأَمْوَٰلٌ ٱقْتَرَفْتُمُوهَا — وَأَمْوَٰلِنِ قْتَرَفْتُمُوهَا

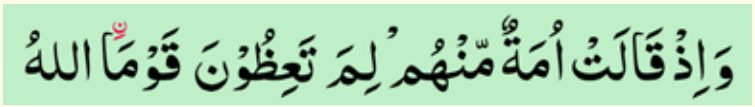
1306 ٱلْمُلْكُ يَوْمَئِذٍ ٱلْحَقُّ لِلرَّحْمَٰنِ — **Pronounced as** — يَوْمَئِذِنِ لْحَقُّ

1307 لِمَ تَعِظُونَ قَوْمًا ٱللَّهُ — قَوْمِنِ ٱللَّهُ

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Remember

In Urdu and Turkish Muṣ-ḥafs, this particular rule of 'Iltiqā' As-Sākinain' is given the name **'Nūn Qutni'** and it is indicated in the Muṣ-ḥaf as a small Nūn on top of the tanwīn:



In Arabic Muṣ-ḥaf, however, this symbol is not included.

2 When a Madd letter is followed by Hamzat Al-Waṣl ٱ

وای ٱ

The second case of 'Iltiqā' As-Sākinain' occurs when a word ends with a **Madd letter**, and the word after starts with **Hamzat Al-Waṣl** ٱ.

Remember: Madd letters are always in a state of sukūn.

Preventing this type of 'Iltiqā' As-Sākinain' is done by completely dropping the Madd letter at the end of the first word.

1308

وَقَالَا ٱلْحَمْدُ — **Pronounced as** — قَالَ ٱلْحَمْدُ

In this example, the alif at the end of the word قَالَا is dropped, so there won't be Madd at the end of that word. It is important to know that this only happens in case you link the two words together. This means if you stopped at the word قَالَا you will pronounce the alif at the end of the word normally with its Natural Madd.

Notice how Hamzat Al-Waṣl is also dropped when you keep on reading. Revise Chapter 6

More examples:

1309 وَلَا ٱلضَّآلِّينَ — **Pronounced as** — وَلَضَّآلِّينَ

1310 ذُو ٱلْفَضْلِ — ذُلْفَضْلِ

1311 يَفْتَرِى ٱلْكَذِبَ — يَفْتَرِلْكَذِبَ

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CHAPT

ILTIQA' AS

Preven
Two Consecutiv

SAME WORD

Madd Letter



ٱلضَّآلِّينَ

جَآنٌّ

Temporary Sukoon



وَٱلْعَصْرِ

قُرَيْشٍ

NO CHANGES TO YOUR RECITATION

ER 13

-SAKINAIN

ting
e Consonants

TWO WORDS

Madd Letter

ـَا ـٓ	ـُو ـٓ

ذُو ٱلْفَضْلِ

وَلَا ٱلضَّآلِّينَ

Tanween

ـٍ	ـٓ

نُوحٌ ٱبْنَهُ

قَوْمًا ٱللَّه

Remove Madd Letter

ذُلْفَضْلِ

وَلَضَّآلِّينَ

Add kasrah to Tanween

نُوحنِ بْنَهُ

قَوْمنِ ٱللَّه



DISCUSSION

Follow these steps to learn Chapter 13 effectively:

1. Study the rules of Itiqā' As-Sākinain.
2. Use the attached poster as practicing the Qur'ānic symbols in the coming exercises.
3. Try and find more examples that follow the rules of Itiqā' As-Sākinain and analyze them.

Task 1: Determine if the following statements are (true) or (false) according to what you learned in chapter 12.

1. Itiqā' As-Sākinain must always be avoided ( )
2. Itiqā' As-Sākinain is a secondary tajweed rule that can be skipped ( )
3. When a long vowel is followed by Hamzat Al-Waṣl it always triggers Itiqā' As-Sākinain ( )

Task 2: Recite the following āyah whilst avoiding Itiqā' As-Sākinain.

1 وَإِذْ قَالُواْ ٱللَّهُمَّ

2 أَفِى ٱللَّهِ شَكٌّ فَاطِرِ ٱلسَّمَٰوَٰتِ وَٱلْأَرْضِ ۖ

3 يَٰصَٰحِبَيِ ٱلسِّجْنِ

4 وَبَشِّرِ ٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُواْ وَعَمِلُواْ ٱلصَّٰلِحَٰتِ

5 كَلَّا ۖ لَيُنۢبَذَنَّ فِى ٱلْحُطَمَةِ

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Challenge Question **Study the following āyah:**

إِذْ نَادَىٰهُ رَبُّهُۥ بِٱلْوَادِ ٱلْمُقَدَّسِ طُوًى ﴿١٦﴾ ٱذْهَبْ إِلَىٰ فِرْعَوْنَ

1. Stopping at the end of āyah 16, how would you recite the words ٱذْهَبْ and طُوًى ?
2. If you do **not** stop between the āyāt, how would you recite this excerpt?
3. Try and explain your choices using the rules you studied so far.

Challenge Question **Study the following āyah:**

جَنَّٰتِ عَدْنٍ ٱلَّتِى وَعَدَ ٱلرَّحْمَٰنُ عِبَادَهُۥ بِٱلْغَيْبِ ۚ إِنَّهُۥ كَانَ وَعْدُهُۥ مَأْتِيًّا ﴿٦١﴾
لَّا يَسْمَعُونَ فِيهَا لَغْوًا إِلَّا سَلَٰمًا ۖ

1. Recite this exerpt while **only** stopping at (بِٱلْغَيْبِ ۚ).
2. List 3 different tajweed rules that you have you learned so far?

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14

Disjointed Letters

In this chapter you will learn:

- What are disjointed letters?
- The three categories of disjointed letters.
- Disjointed letters of Natural Madd.
- Disjointed letters of Madd Lāzim.
- Disjointed letters that are not elongated.

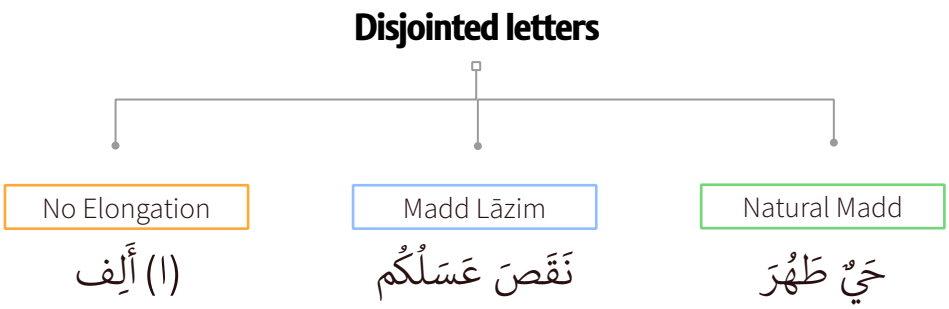
Orientation

Disjointed letters or in Arabic 'Al-Hurūf Al-Muqaṭṭa'ah' (الحُرُوفُ المُقَطَّعَة) are sets of Arabic letters that are found only at the beginning of 29 sūrahs of the Qur'ān. These letters are also called (فَوَاتِح) or *'openers'* since they form the opening of the sūrahs they appear in.

The most common combinations of disjointed letters are حمّ الٓر الٓمٓ

There are many views as to what they mean, but the most common view is that these letters are mentioned – and Allāh knows best – to refer to the miraculous nature of the Qur'ān, which implies that all mankind is unable to match it, even though it is composed of the letters that they use in their daily speech.

When it comes to reciting these disjointed letters, they are categorized into three groups according to how long they are elongated. These groups are named after the mnemonic of this group of letters:





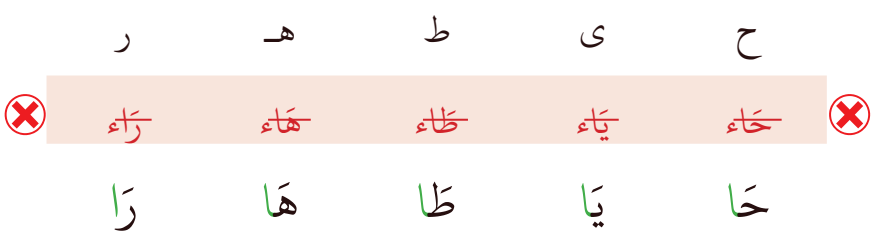
The letters of this category are:

ح ى ط هـ ر

These letters are pronounced following the pattern of Natural Madd, which means that you extend the alif in each of these letters for 2 counts (ḥarakāt). These letters should not be pronounced as regular alphabet with hamzah at the end of it, but they are pronounced without hamzah as follows:

Notice when ى is used as a separate letter in the Qur'ān, it never receives two dots under it. More on that letter on page 165

1401



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Study this example:

1402

طَهَ

Pronounced as: طَا هَا

From this example, we can see that each letter is pronounced as a separated word containing a long vowel, which **must be elongated** for 2 counts.

DID YOU KNOW?

There is only one Sūrah in the Qur'ān that starts with a combination of two of the letters of حَيٌّ طَهُرَ which is surah طَهَ

Madd Lāzim

نَقَصَ عَسَلُكُم

The letters of this category are:

ن ق ص ع س ل ك م

The letter ع may also be extended for 2 or 4 counts but for the sake of simplifying the rule, we have only highlighted one possibility which is treating it the same way as the rest of the group it belongs to.

All these letters will appear in the Qur'ān with a Madd symbol on top ~ indicating that they must be elongated. This elongation is the same as the one we have learned in chapter 5 which is **Madd Lāzim**. This Madd is generated because a Madd letter (و ا ی) is followed by a letter with sukūn. That's why, **all** these letters **must be extended for 6 ḥarakāt (counts)**. Similar to the previous set of letters, these letters should be pronounced as words, which are indicated in the following chart:

ن	ق	ص	ع	س	ل	ك	م
نُوْن	قَآف	صَآد	عَيْن	سِيْن	لَآم	كَآف	مِيْم

1403

Here is an example for this group of letters, together with the previous one:

1404

كٓهيعٓصٓ

Pronounced as: كَآف هَا يَا عَيْن صَآد

Remember

The sukūn in these disjointed letters is an original sukūn, which means that whether you stop at them or link them to what comes next, they remain in the state of sukūn, and you will still have to extend them.

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No Elongation — (ا) أَلِف

What is the difference between 'alif' and 'hamzah'
Revise page 162

This letter only appears at the beginning of a disjointed letter combination, and it is never used in the middle, or at the end of a combination. The name of letter ‘alif’ is made up of أ ل ف which do not contain Madd letters and as a result there is no Madd in it, so it is pronounced as ‘alif’ without any elongation whatsoever.

Here are some examples with all the disjointed letters:

1405 الٓمٓ — **Pronounced as:** أَلِف لَآم مِيم

1406 حٰمٓ ﴿١﴾ عٓسٓقٓ ﴿٢﴾ — **Pronounced as:** حَا مِيم عَيْن سِيْن قَاف

1407 الٓمٓرٰ — **Pronounced as:** أَلِف لَآم مِيم رَا

1408 طٰسٓمٓ — **Pronounced as:** طَا سِيْن مِيم

From these examples, and the previous ones, we notice that since these letters are pronounced as words, we must apply the rules of Tajweed that we have learned so far on these words:

- Between عَيْن سِيْن the word عَيْن ends with Nūn Sākinah, and the word after سِيْن starts with س which means there is a case of Ikh’fā’ that you must apply when pronouncing this set of disjointed letters.
- At the end of the combination كٓهيعٓصٓ the word صَاد ends with the letter د with sukūn, which means that you should apply **Qalqalah** to the د in that case.

Which degree of Qalqalah is this?

- In the combination الٓمٓ there is a case of Idghām of mīm between لَآم مِيم so we pronounce just one mīm with a ghunnah of two counts.
- Moreover, letters will be pronounced according to their attribute of being a heavy and light letters as well.

DID YOU KNOW?

The name of every letter of the alphabet starts with its own letter: ب starts with باء and ح starts with حاء and so on, except for أَلِف which actually starts with hamzah and not alif, since no word may start with alif.

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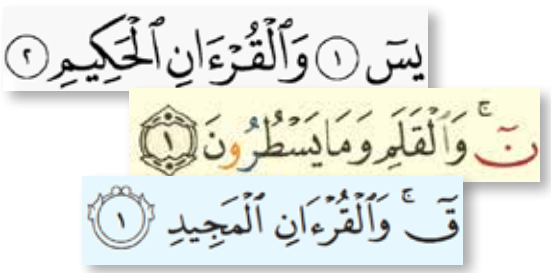
Here is a chart that highlights the practical application of Tajweed rules on some disjointed letters:

		Spelled as:		Pronounced as:	
1409	الٓمٓ		أَلِف لَآم مِيم		أَلِف لَآمِّيم
1410	طٰسٓمٓ		طَا سِين مِيم		طَا سِيِّمِّيم

Combining disjointed letters with the following āyah

You may link between the disjointed letter(s) and whatever follows it, whether that is an āyah or not. This means you are not stopping/ pausing after reading the disjointed letters.

If you do choose to link the disjointed letters, you have to pay attention to two things:



1. In sūrah Āl-i-Imrān:

Linking the letter to the word after means that there is a case of Iltiqā' As-Sākinain (since mīm ends with sukūn, and lām in the following word also has sukūn). Therefore, the mīm will lose its sukūn, and it will turn into fat-ḥah. This means that mīm will only have Natural Madd of two counts, which means you will pronounce it as such:

1411

الٓمٓ ﴿١﴾ ٱللَّهُ لَآ إِلَٰهَ إِلَّا هُوَ ٱلۡحَيُّ ٱلۡقَيُّومُ



أَلِف لَآمِّيمَاللَّهُ

Remember

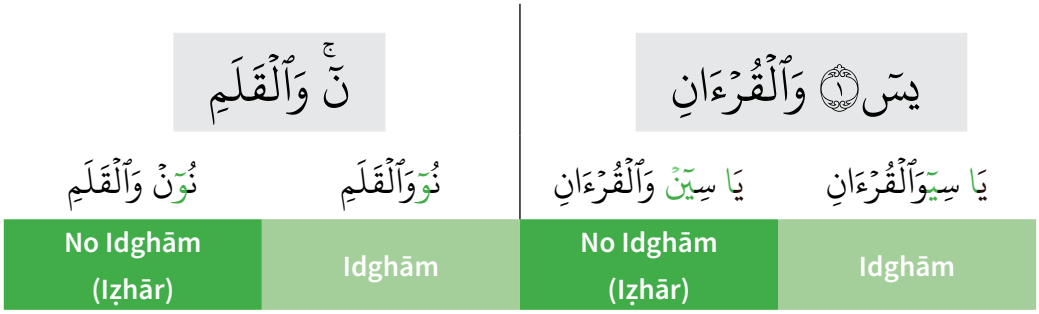
It is always better to stop at the end of each āyah since that is the sunnah of the Prophet, and it is easier to perform.

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There is more to this rule than just which one is more common than the other. It is related to the Tarīq of the Riwāyah that is being used. However, discussing the differences between Turuq is outside the scope of this handbook.

2. In sūrah Ya-Sin and sūrah Al-Qalām:

At the end of the disjointed letters ن and يٰسٓ, there is a case of Nūn Sākinah. If you link between the disjointed letter and what comes after it, then you may apply Idghām on the Nūn Sākinah. You may also apply Iẓhār on the Nūn Sākinah (pronouncing the Nūn fully) without merging or Idghām whatsoever. The latter case, which is applying Iẓhār on the Nūn) is the more commonly used.



There are four Sūrahs in the Qur'ān that are named after the Huruf Muqaṭṭaʿāt at their openings, they are: طٰهٰ (Ṭā-Hā), يٰسٓ (Yā-Sīn), صٓ (Ṣād) and قٓ (qāf)

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CHAP

DISJOINTE

ٱلْمُقَطَّعَة

ا

NO MADD

Pronounce 'alif'

الٓمٓر

(أَلِف لَآمّيم رَا)

عَسَلُكُم

(ع س ل ك م

MADD

SIX HA

عٓسٓقٓ

(عَيّن سيّن قآف)

TER 14

ED LETTERS

ٱلْحُرُوفُ

نَقَصَ

(ن ق ص

LAZIM

RAKAT

طَسَّمَ

(طَاسِيمّيم)

حَيَّ طَهُر

(ح ى ط هـ ر)

NATURAL MADD

TWO HARAKAT

طَهَ

(طَا هَا)

15

Important Comparisons

In this chapter you will learn:

- The difference between hamzah vs alif
- The difference between ـه vs ـة vs ت
- The difference between (ـى)ى vs (ـيـ)ئ



Folio from a Qur'ān, sura 15-91:14; sura 5-92:1. Iran, Abbasid period, 11th century

Hamzah vs. Alif

There are many theories among Arabic grammarians and linguists on whether hamzah and alif are the same or they are indeed two different letters. However, The more correct view, which is also adopted by the majority of scholars and linguists, states that hamzah and alif are **not** the same, because of how many differences there are between them. To name a few: they are pronounced from different articulation points, they look different, and they even have different functions. Therefore, knowing these differences is crucial to a proper understanding of many tajweed rules.

These are the differences between Hamzah and Alif:

Rules of Hamzah and its kinds are comprehensively explained in chapter 6. Check for more examples.

Hamzah	Alif
The first letter in the Arabic alphabet, which produces the 'glottal stop' sound	The 26th letter in the Arabic alphabet. And as an alphabet, it is indicated as لا.
Comes in different forms depending on the context and/ or case ending: ئ ء ؤ إ أ ٱ ذِئْب / شِيء / يُؤْمِنُ / إِيمَان / أَحْمَد / ٱسْم	Has only one form with its variations depending on its position: ـا ـا ـآ ـآ سَجَى / جَاء / فَاز / قَرَار
Can occur anywhere in the word: beginning, middle and end.	Can**not** occur at the beginning of the word, so only in the middle or at the end.
Accepts all variations of diacritics: أَ أُ إِ ؤَ ءَ ءُ ءِ ئَ including tanwīn: أً أٌ إٍ ءً ءٌ ءٍ	can**not** accept any diacritics at all. It does have sukūn, but even that is not indicated on the top of the letter.
Is a consonant that does not contain any elongation, and it cannot be elongated	Is a vowel with Natural Madd of two harakāt, and can be extended for up to 6 harakāt depending on the context.

DID YOU KNOW?

Sometimes hamzah is 'metaphorically' named alif for ease of use, and also for beginners. That's why, when naming the Arabic alphabet we start by saying (alif) for this letter (ا), while in fact we should call this hamzah.

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ـه VS ـة VS ت

When you recite the Qur'ān, you will find that there are many words that end with these letters. The problem with these three letters is that two of them look very similar, and two of them sound identical in certain situations, sometimes they function in much the same way, but sometimes not. This comparison should highlight the function of each of these three, and what the differences are between them in pronunciation when they are used in the Qur'ān.

ـه

This is the 26th letter of the Arabic alphabet. It is pronounced as /h/ at all times, whether it occurred at the beginning, middle or end of the word, and whether you stop at a word ending with it or you keep on reading.

وَفَوَٰكِهَ مِمَّا يَشۡتَهُونَ
لَا رَيۡبَۛ فِيهِۖ

1501

These examples show that ـهـ always produces /h/ sound. Importantly, when ـهـ occurs at the end of the word, it takes this shape ـه **(notice the absence of any dots on top of the letter)**. When this happens, the ـه is still pronounced as /h/ with no changes whether you stop at the word ending with it, or you keep on reading.

ة / ـة

This 'letter'[1] is called tā' marbūṭah تَاءٌ مَربُوطَة which **only** occurs at the end of words, and never at the beginning or middle. So, it will always take these shapes[2] ـة/ة **(notice it has two dots on top of its symbol)**

وَيُقِيمُونَ ٱلصَّلَوٰةَ
ٱشۡتَرَوُاْ ٱلضَّلَٰلَةَ بِٱلۡهُدَىٰ
بَعُوضَةً فَمَا فَوۡقَهَاۚ

1502

From these examples, we see:

- When you **stop** at a word ending with tā' marbūṭah, you **pronounce it as /h/**.
- When you **keep on** reading, you **pronounce it as /t/**.

That's why, tā' marbūṭah looks like ـه in some sense, but also like ت.

ت

This is the third letter in the alphabet, and it is pronounced as /t/ at all times, whether it occurred at the beginning, middle or end of the word, and whether you stop at a word ending with it or you keep on reading.

وَقَالَتِ ٱلۡيَهُودُ لَيۡسَتِ
هُدَى لِّلۡمُتَّقِينَ

1503

In these examples, the letter ت functions as it should since it is pronounced as /t/ in every position and state.

1 We're calling it a letter metaphorically, but it is not a separate letter of the alphabet.
2 This depends on the letter before it, whether it can be connected to it or not.

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The rules of pronouncing these letters always apply to the entire Qur'ān, even if the Muṣ-ḥaf seems to follow different writing rules for certain words, study these examples:

1504

3 وَإِنِ ٱمْرَأَةٌ خَافَتْ

4 إِذْ قَالَتِ ٱمْرَأَتُ عِمْرَٰنَ

In this example, we can observe the following:

- One word was written in two different ways: ٱمْرَأَةٌ and ٱمْرَأَتُ
- If you keep on reading, this word would be pronounced exactly the same: ending with /t/
- If you stop at these words, they will be pronounced differently:
  - » Stopping at ٱمْرَأَتْ: the word ends with /t/ sound
  - » Stopping at ٱمْرَأَةْ: the word ends with /h/ sound

Remember: You cannot just randomly stop at words if there is no valid reason.

Another Example with the same differences:

1505

5 وَٱذْكُرُواْ نِعْمَةَ ٱللَّهِ عَلَيْكُمْ

6 ٱذْكُرُواْ نِعْمَتَ ٱللَّهِ عَلَيْكُمْ

1506

7 رَحْمَةً مِّنۢ بَعْدِ ضَرَّآءَ

8 إِنَّ رَحْمَتَ ٱللَّهِ قَرِيبٌ

It is also noticeble to see if a word ending with tā' marbūṭah receives any suffixes (addition to the end of the word), the tā' marbūṭah will turn into ت and the rules of ت will then apply to that word. Study these examples:

1507

وَكَانَتِ ٱمْرَأَتِي عَاقِرًا 9

وَيُتِمُّ نِعْمَتَهُۥ عَلَيْكَ 10

سَيُدْخِلُهُمُ ٱللَّهُ فِي رَحْمَتِهِۦ 11

3 An-Nisā', 128
4 Āl-i 'imrān, 35
5 Al-Mā'idah, 7
6 Al-Mā'idah, 11
7 Yūnus, 21
8 Al-A'rāf, 56
9 Maryam, 5
10 Yūsuf, 6
11 At-Tawbah, 99

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ى vs ـى

This comparison highlights these two letters and their use only at the end of the word. If they are used anywhere else in the word, they don't cause any confusion.

ى(ـى)

- This letter is called alif maqṣūrah أَلِفٌ مَقصُورة which is a variation of the Madd alif used only at the end of words.
- Notice the dagger alif on top of the alif maqsūrah, which is an indication that the pronunciation of this letter is the same as a regular alif at the end of the word.
- This means that words that end with ى will be pronounced with elongation of at least two or four ḥarakāt, depending on their positioning.

1508

وَلَا يَشۡفَعُونَ إِلَّا لِمَنِ ٱرۡتَضَىٰ

1509

وَكَفَىٰ بِنَا حَٰسِبِينَ

فَرَجَعُوٓاْ إِلَىٰٓ أَنفُسِهِمۡ

1510

ى(ـى)

This letter appears in two ways in the Qur'ān:

- **With tashkīl symbol:**

If there is any tashkīl symbol on top or under this letter, it will automatically be pronounced as a normal yā' ى.

قَالَ هِيَ عَصَايَ
ٱلسَّامِرِيُّ
لِلۡحَيِّ ٱلۡقَيُّومِ

- **Without tashkīl symbol:**

If it has no symbols on top or under it, then it is a case of **Iltiqā' As-Sākinain**[12]:

» If you keep on reading, you will not pronounce it.

» If you stop then the pronunciation of this last letter is determined by the tashkīl on the letter before it:

ى◌ِ	ى◌َ
If the letter before has **kasrah**, then it is **yā'**	If the letter before has **fat-ḥah**, then it is **alif maqsūrah**
عَن ذِكۡرِي	فَتَعَلَى ٱللَّهُ
وَكَذَٰلِكَ نَجۡزِي	وَأَسَرُّواْ ٱلنَّجۡوَى

12 This concept was explained in detail in chapter 13: *Iltiqā' As-Sākinain*

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1511 13 وَتَرَى ٱلنَّاسَ سُكَٰرَىٰ وَمَا هُم بِسُكَٰرَىٰ

1512 14 وَٱدْعُ إِلَىٰ رَبِّكَ ۖ إِنَّكَ لَعَلَىٰ هُدًى مُّسْتَقِيمٍ

In these examples we observe the following:

- Whenever alif maqsūrah has 'dagger alif' symbol on top, it means that alif maqsūrah will always be pronounced as alif, whether you stop at the word or you keep on reading.
- But if alif maqsūrah has **no symbols** on it, like in the word تَرَى then it is only pronounced if you **stop** at the word. If you **continue** reading, then alif maqsūrah will be completely dropped.
- **Don't forget:** Alif maqsūrah is a Madd letter, that must be elongated for 2 ḥarakāt or more if it is a case of Secondary Madd.

1513 15 إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ لَقَوِىٌّ عَزِيزٌ

1514 16 فَأُوَٰرِىَ سَوْءَةَ أَخِى

1515 17 وَلَا تَشْتَرُوا۟ بِـَٔايَٰتِى ثَمَنًا قَلِيلًا

1516 18 إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ لَا يَهْدِى ٱلْقَوْمَ ٱلظَّٰلِمِينَ

In these examples we observe the following:

- Whenever yā' has any tashkīl symbol on it, it will always be pronounced, whether you stop at the word or you keep on reading.
- If yā' has no tashkīl symbols like in the word, then it is only pronounced when you **stop** at that word. If you **keep on** reading it is not pronounced at all.
- **Don't forget:** yā' can be used as a Madd letter if it was preceded by a letter with kasrah. In that case, you must elongate yā' for two ḥarakāt.

13 Al-Hajj, 2
14 Al-Hajj, 67
15 Al-Hajj, 40
16 Al-Ma'idah, 31
17 Al-Baqarah, 41
18 Al-An'ām, 144

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16

Special Cases

In this chapter you will learn:

- The special cases pertaining to the following words:

مَجْرٖىهَا - ءَاْعْجَمِيٌّ - تَأْمَنَّا - يَسْتَحْيِۦ - ٱئْتُونِى- تَفْتَؤُاْ - ٱلِٱسْمُ



Folio from the "Blue" Qur'ān, 9th10-th century. Ink, gold, and silver (now oxidized) on blue-dyed parchment, 9th10-th century

Orientation



So far we have discussed the majority of Tajweed rules which apply to 98% of the entire Qur'ān. There are, however, some rules that are applied on one single word in the entire Qur'ān, or in other cases, applied on a very limited number of cases. Therefore, in this chapter, we will highlight these few cases to learn how you can deal with them, without having to dive deeper into each of these rules because they do not have wider application in the Qur'ān, according to the Riwāyah of Hafṣ 'an 'āṣim.

For many of these cases you will notice that the symbol • or ◊ is used to indicate that this word follows a special rule that only applies on that particular word, or to state that this word requires a special pronunciation that has to be followed audibly and not just by reading that word.

Here is the list for the most important special cases in the Qur'ān:

1601

1 مَجۡرٖىٰهَا

Sūrah Hūd, 41

Pronouncing this word following the regular rules will not enable you to pronounce it correctly according to the Riwāyah of Hafs 'an 'āsim. In order to pronounce it correctly, you need to apply 'Imālah' or in Arabic إِمَالَة which affects this word in two ways:

1. The first alif in the word will be pronounced in a way that sounds something between alif and yā'.
2. The rā in this word will be pronounced as a light letter, and not as a heavy rā as the rule suggests.

1602

وَقَالَ ٱرۡكَبُواْ فِيهَا بِسۡمِ ٱللَّهِ مَجۡرٖىٰهَا وَمُرۡسَىٰهَآۚ

Following the audio example is most essential in this case to imitate the pronunciation of this word.

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1603

2 ءَأَعْجَمِيٌّ

Sūrah Fuṣṣilat, 44

The letter with special pronunciation in this case is the letter hamzah. The rule applied on this particular word is called 'tas-heel' or in Arabic تَسْهِيل which literally means 'easing'. In this case, you will ease the pronunciation of hamzah; that's why, there is a full circle symbol on top of the hamzah. The purpose of the special pronunciaion of this word is to make it easier to pronounce three consecutive deep throat sounds one after another. Applying tas-heel on this word is done by following these two points:

1. The first hamzah and the 'ain (highlighted in green) are both pronounced normally, like any other case.
2. The second hamzah (highlighted in red & with full circle on it) will not have a 'stopping' feature. Instead, it will be pronounced in a way that is between alif and hamzah.

1604

وَلَوْ جَعَلْنَٰهُ قُرْءَانًا أَعْجَمِيًّا لَّقَالُوا۟ لَوْلَا فُصِّلَتْ ءَايَٰتُهُۥٓ ۖ ءَأَعْجَمِىٌّ وَعَرَبِىٌّ ۗ

1605

3 تَأْمَنَّا

Sūrah Yūsuf, 11

The letter with special pronunciation in this case is the letter nūn. The rule applied on this particular word is called 'Ishmām'[1] or in Arabic إِشمَام which means 'pursing lips[2]'.

To apply ishmām properly on this particular case, you will:

1. Pronounce mīm normally with Iẓhar, there is nothing special here.
2. After mīm, you will pronounce the duplicated nūn with ghunnah of two counts.
3. Right before the ghunnah ends (before you pronounce alif), you will purse lips.

1606

قَالُوا۟ يَٰٓأَبَانَا مَا لَكَ لَا تَأْمَنَّا عَلَىٰ يُوسُفَ

Following the video example (using the companion app) is very important in this case to hear and see the proper execution.

1 There is a second way to pronounce this word using 'ikhtilās' إختِلَاس but discussing this method is not included in this level of the Tajweed course, but rather in the advanced level.

2 Shaping lips in an 'O' formation

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1607

4 يَسْتَحْيِۦ

Several Āyāt

If you keep on reading and link this word to the word after it, you should pronounce **two yā'**: one yā' at the end of the word, and the yā' symbol ۦ after it. This is the expected application when you keep on reciting. However, the special rule of this word is that when stopping at it, you will still pronounce the **two yā'**, with the second yā' elongated for two ḥarakāt due to 'Natural Madd'. So the exception here is that the yā' symbol ۦ will be pronounced whether you stopped at the word or you kept on reading.

1608

يَسْتَضْعِفُ طَآئِفَةً مِّنْهُمْ يُذَبِّحُ أَبْنَآءَهُمْ وَيَسْتَحْيِۦ نِسَآءَهُمْ ۚ

This rule is applied to all the variations of the root ح ـ ي ـ و , which are:

يُحْيِ ٱللَّهُ	كَيْفَ تُحْيِ ٱلْمَوْتَىٰ	هُوَ يُحْيِۦ وَيُمِيتُ	فَيُحْيِۦ بِهِ ٱلْأَرْضَ	نُحْيِ ٱلْمَوْتَىٰ

Remember

Sometimes, the second yā' (the symbol ۦ) is not written due to "Iltiqā' As-Sākinain", as we explained in chapter 13. In this case, you will still pronounce the second yā' (the symbol ۦ) when stopping at the word, even if you can't see the symbol written.

Notice how we deal with this example:

1609

كَذَٰلِكَ يُحْيِ ٱللَّهُ ٱلْمَوْتَىٰ

There are four more cases in the Quran that follow the exact same rule:

1610	وَلِيِّۦ yūsuf, 101	أَنتَ وَلِيِّۦ فِي ٱلدُّنْيَا وَٱلْآخِرَةِ ۖ
1611	وَلِيِّۦَ Al-A'rāf, 196	إِنَّ وَلِيِّۦَ ٱللَّهُ ٱلَّذِي نَزَّلَ ٱلْكِتَٰبَ ۖ
1612	تَلْوُۥاْ An-Nisā', 135	وَإِن تَلْوُۥاْ أَوْ تُعْرِضُواْ فَإِنَّ ٱللَّهَ كَانَ بِمَا تَعْمَلُونَ خَبِيرًا
1613	فَأْوُۥاْ Al-Kahf, 16	وَإِذِ ٱعْتَزَلْتُمُوهُمْ وَمَا يَعْبُدُونَ إِلَّا ٱللَّهَ فَأْوُۥاْ إِلَى ٱلْكَهْفِ

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1614

5 ٱئۡتُونِي

Al-Ahqāf, 4

This word starts with two consecutive hamzahs one after the other: Hamzat Al-Waṣl followed by hamzah al-qaṭ‘. There are two ways to pronounce this word, and in both of them you will only pronounce **one** of these two hamzahs, and never both at the same time:

1615	If you start at it	ٱئۡتُونِي	**You pronounce it as:** اِيتُونِي
1616	If you linked it to the word before	فِي ٱلسَّمَٰوَٰتِ ٱئۡتُونِي	فِي ٱلسَّمَٰوَٰتِ ئۡتُونِي

1617

6 تَفۡتَؤُاْ

Yūsuf, 85

This word ends with hamzah on wāw وُ which is pronounced as a hamzah with ḍamma ءُ if you keep on reciting. Moreover, if you want to stop at that word, you will pronounce the hamzah on wāw as a hamzah with a sukūn ء. This means that in both cases, the wāw is ignored and not pronounced at all, whether you stopped at the word, or you kept on reading.

1618

قَالُواْ تَٱللَّهِ تَفۡتَؤُاْ تَذۡكُرُ يُوسُفَ

There are other examples that end in the same way, and they are pronounced in the same way:

1619

يَبۡدَؤُاْ ٱلۡخَلۡقَ	ٱللُّؤۡلُؤُ وَٱلۡمَرۡجَانُ

The same rule applies when a word ends with hamzah on yā':

1620

ٱلۡبَارِئُ ٱلۡمُصَوِّرُ	يَسۡتَهۡزِئُ بِهِمۡ	ءَانَآيِ ٱلَّيۡلِ	تِلۡقَآيِ نَفۡسِيَ

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When we say that you are 'stopping at' a certain word, we do not mean/ imply that you may stop randomly in the middle of an āyah. This type of stops is only allowed if you have to (e.g. taking a breath), or if you are being tested by your teacher. Other than that, you should follow the stopping rules as explained in Chapter 3.

1621

7 ٱلِٱسۡمُ

Al-Hujurāt, 11

The word ٱسۡمُ starts with Hamzat Al-Waṣl, and when definite article is added to it to define the noun, another Hamzat Al-Waṣl was added to the beginning of the word. This may create a special situation depending on how you read it:

- **If you keep on reading** then you will drop both hamzahs, and you will only pronounce lām with kasrah:

1622

بِئۡسَ ٱلِٱسۡمُ ٱلۡفُسُوقُ **You pronounce it as:** بِئۡسَلِسۡمُ ٱلۡفُسُوقُ

- **If you want to start at this word,** then you will only pronounce the first hamzat Waṣl, and the second one will be dropped:

1623

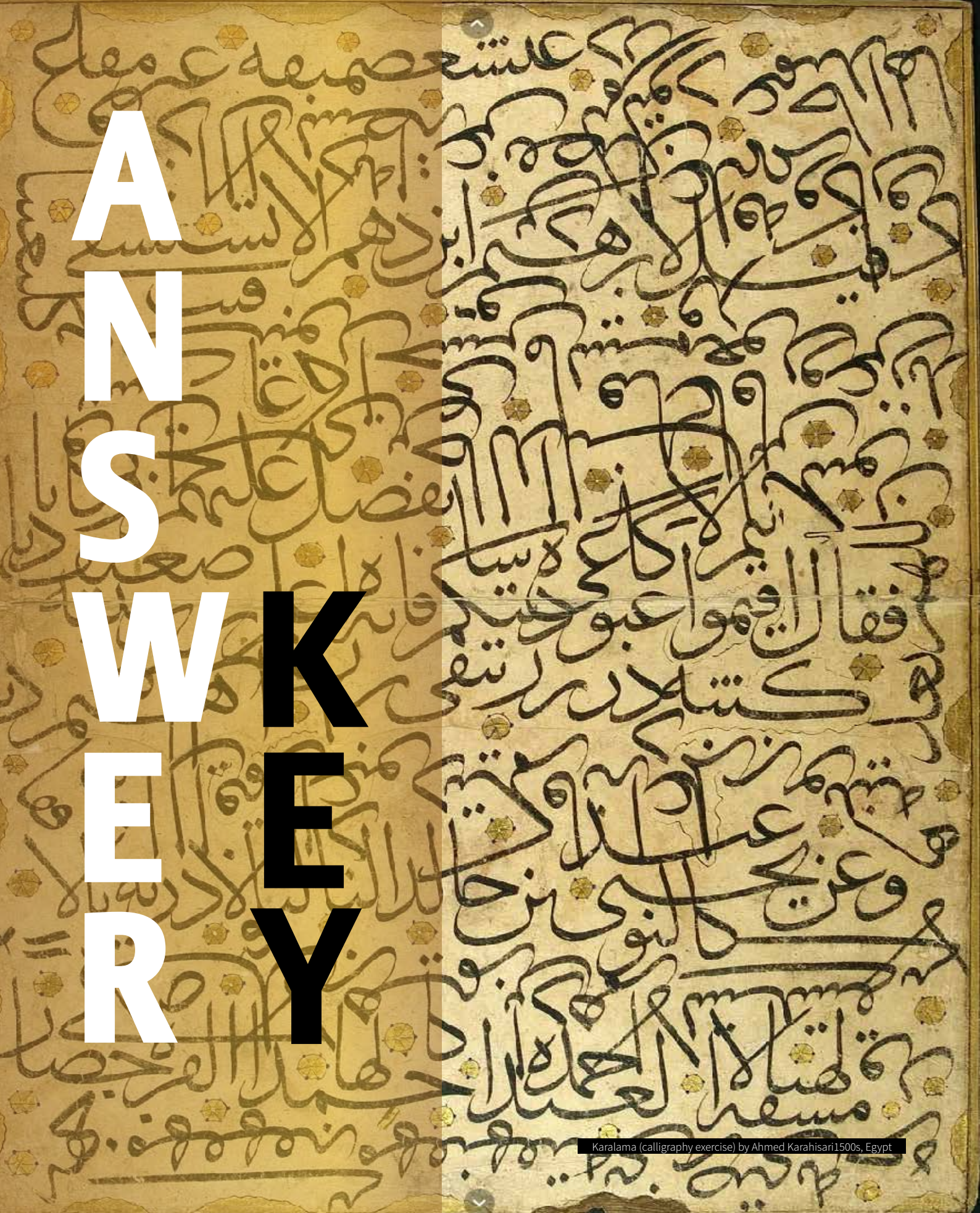
ٱلِٱسۡمُ ٱلۡفُسُوقُ **You pronounce it as:** اَلِسۡمُ ٱلۡفُسُوقُ

The application of this rule occures **only once** in the Qur'ān which is the above mentioned case.



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ANSWER KEY



Karalama (calligraphy exercise) by Ahmed Karahisari1500s, Egypt

Chapter Two

1-b 2-f 3-g 4-h 5-k 6-m 7-l 8-a 9-n 10-e 11-c 12-d

Chapter Three

Task 1

Stopping at the word عَلَيْهِمْ is not the best practice because if you start at the word غَيْرِ you would be starting a sentence with a word that has kasrah, and in Arabic this cannot happen. It is therefore better to not stop and recite the last āyah in one go.

Task 2

You should avoid starting after the word قَالُوٓاْ because if you started at the word ءَامَنَّا it would take these words from their context, which is that they were said by a certain group of people.

Task 3

Stopping at a word ending with tanwīn fat-ḥah like سَوَآءٌ means that you must add alif after the hamzah سَوَآءا. If there is not tanwīn fat-ḥah then there is special additions needed, and you would pronounce it without the tanwīn.

Chapter Four

Task 1

1- False - Only wāw and yā' can both function as Madd letters and līn letters but alif can only function as Madd letter.

2- False - Yes it is possible to end with Madd letters: يَهدِى ends with Madd letter that should be extended for 2 counts.

3- True - will be further explained in Chapter 5

4- True - every single alif is extended at least for 2 counts.

5- False - If it is a Madd letter then it should be elongated for at least 2 counts.

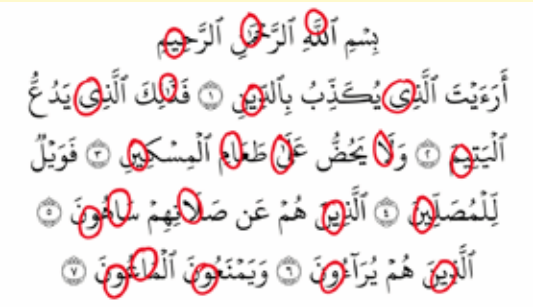
6- False - Madd letters have sukūn but without any symbols.

7- True.

8- False - It contains Natural Madd when you stop at it, then you will extend wāw for two counts, if you keep on reading, then there is no Madd.

Task 2

There are 22 cases of Natural Madd:


بِسْمِ ٱللَّهِ ٱلرَّحْمَٰنِ ٱلرَّحِيمِ
أَرَءَيْتَ ٱلَّذِى يُكَذِّبُ بِٱلدِّينِ ۝١ فَذَٰلِكَ ٱلَّذِى يَدُعُّ
ٱلْيَتِيمَ ۝٢ وَلَا يَحُضُّ عَلَىٰ طَعَامِ ٱلْمِسْكِينِ ۝٣ فَوَيْلٌ
لِّلْمُصَلِّينَ ۝٤ ٱلَّذِينَ هُمْ عَن صَلَاتِهِمْ سَاهُونَ ۝٥
ٱلَّذِينَ هُمْ يُرَآءُونَ ۝٦ وَيَمْنَعُونَ ٱلْمَاعُونَ ۝٧

Two cases of līn letters: أَرَءَيْتَ - فَوَيْلٌ

Task 3

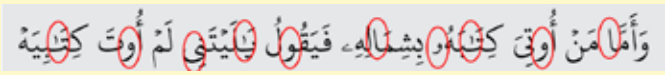
عَالِيَةٍ	فَأَمَّا	قَالُوٓاْ	حَتَّىٰ
فَعَّالٌ	يَلُوذُنَ	إِلَىٰٓ	جُوعٍ

Task 4

فَكَيْفَ	إِلَيْهِ	شَىْءٍ
مَّوْعِظَةٌ	ٱصْطَفَيْتُكَ	

Chapter Five

Task 1


وَأَمَّا مَنْ أُوتِيَ كِتَٰبَهُۥ بِشِمَالِهِۦ فَيَقُولُ يَٰلَيْتَنِى لَمْ أُوتَ كِتَٰبِيَهْ

Task 2

(قَالُواْ) Natural Madd in (alif) and (wāw) of 2 ḥarakāt

(سَوَآءٌ) Secondary Madd – mandatory Madd of 5 ḥarakāt

(عَلَيْنَآ) Secondary Madd – optional Madd of 4 ḥarakāt

(ٱلْوَٰعِظِينَ) Natural Madd in (alif) and (yā') of 2 ḥarakāt

Task 3

The word is: بِٱلْغَيْبِ

Yes. In the word يُنفِقُونَ

Task 4

1- We apply Natural Madd on ءَامَنْتُمْ– with 2 ḥarakāt

We apply temporary Madd on عَلَيْهِ with 2, 4 or 6 ḥarakāt

2- Natural Madd – 2 ḥarakāt

3- مَآ Optional Madd – 2 or 4 ḥarakāt

أَنَاْ If you stop at it = 2 ḥarakāt - If you keep reading = drop the alif completely.

4- All cases of Natural Madd of 2 ḥarakāt.

If you stop at لَغَفُورٌ or رَّحِيمٌ then it is a case of temporary Madd (2, 4 or 6 ḥarakāt).

5- For both cases, we apply Natural Madd – 2 ḥarakāt.

6- For لِيَزْدَادُوٓاْ we apply disconnected Madd or Natural Madd – 4 or 2 ḥarakāt.

For إِيمَٰنًا and إِيمَٰنِهِمْ We apply Natural Madd – 2 ḥarakāt.

Task 5

First way: if you stopped at the word هُوَ you will pronounce the wāw with Natural Madd, because it is then treated as a Madd letter.

Second way: If you keep on reading and you didn't stop at هُوَ then there will be no Madd in the wāw, and you will pronounce it with fat-ḥah, so as a semi-vowel.

The reason for the difference is that the wāw in this word in particular has fat-ḥah on it. If you stopped at it, that fat-ḥah will be turned into a sukūn, and therefore, the wāw will meet the requirements of being a Madd letter, but when you keep on reading, the fat-ḥah will be pronounced and it will not be a Madd letter anymore. Revise Chapter 4 to remember the conditions of the Madd letter.

Chapter Six

Task 1

1-

(إِذَا) Hamzat Al-qat' with kasrah

(ٱلتَّرَاقِىَ) Hamzat Al-Waṣl

(أَنَّهُۥ) Hamzat Al-qat' with fat-ḥah

(ٱلْفِرَاقُ) Hamzat Al-Waṣl

(ٱلْتَفَّتِ) Hamzat Al-Waṣl

(ٱلسَّاقُ) Hamzat Al-Waṣl

(بِٱلسَّاقِ) Hamzat Al-Waṣl

(إِلَىٰ) Hamzat Al-qat' wit kasrah

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(يَوْمَئِذٍ) Hamzat Al-qat' with kasrah

(ٱلْمَسَاقُ) Hamzat Al-Waṣl

2- The best way is to pause at the symbol س without taking a breath before we continue to the word رَاقٍ.

3- The word ٱلتَّرَاقِي can end with a Natural Madd of 2 ḥarakāt (in case of stopping). We can also read it without any Madd at the end of it if we kept on reading. Check explanation Task 5 – Chapter 4.

Task 2

These are the words containing Hamzat Al-qat':

ٱلصَّٰبِـُٔونَ - مَلَٰٓئِكَة – ٱلْإِنجِيلَ - ٱلْأَخِرِ يُؤْفَكُونَ - أُوْلَٰٓئِكَ – لَبِئْسَ – تَفْتَؤُاْ – أَخْطَأْنَا

These are the words containing Hamzat Al-Waṣl:

ٱلصَّٰبِـُٔونَ – ٱلْإِنجِيلَ - ٱلْأَخِرِ – بِٱلْمَعْرُوفِ

Task 3

The word ٱرْكُضْ should start with dammadh.

Task 4

(ٱرْتَضَىٰ) kasrah

(ٱشْكُرُوا۟) dammah

(ٱشْمَأَزَّتْ) kasrah

(ٱرْتَقِبُوٓا۟) kasrah

(ٱرْكَب) kasrah

(ٱجْعَلْ) kasrah

(ٱدْخُلُوا۟) dammah

(ٱصْطَفَىٰ) kasrah

(ٱغْفِرْ) kasrah

(ٱسْتَزَلَّهُمُ) kasrah

Chapter Seven

Task 1

1- True (except in the word Allāh)

2- True

3- True

4- False (some words have the definite article as an integral part of the word)

5- True

6- False (it will always be followed by a shaddah).

Task 2

1. First way to pronounce it is with a heavy lām (in a case of starting at it)

Second way to pronounce it is with a light lām (in case you kept on reading)

2. If you start at the Honored Word, you will pronounce it normally with a heavy lām because there is no letter to be pronounce before.

If you kept on reading from āyah (1) there will be a tanwīn pronounced before the Honored Word, and therefore you will pronounce it with a light lām.

Task 3

1- The first lām is Sun Lām

The second lām is Moon Lām

2- Yes, Sun Lām is not pronounced and the letter after has shaddah while Moon Lām is pronounced fully.

Task 4

Sun Lām words: ٱلظَّٰلِمِينَ - ٱلدِّينِ - ٱلنَّٰظِرِينَ - ٱلصَّٰلِحَٰتِ

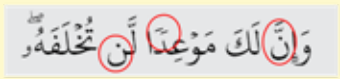
Moon Lām words: ٱلْمَلَٰٓئِكَةِ - ٱلْبَرْقُ - ٱلْأَخِرِ - ٱلْجَٰهِلِينَ - ٱلْخَيْرَٰتِ – بِٱلْمَعْرُوفِ

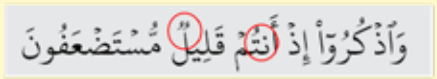
Challenge Question

The lām in the Honored Word is a Sun Lām (according to many scholars), so the first lām (Sun Lām) is not pronounced. Therefore, when you add a particle to the beginning of the word (lām) the definite article is removed, and the lām is added لِلَّهِ. More detailed explanation: https://bit.ly/Lamext

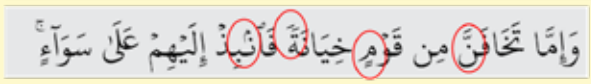
Chapter Eight

Task 1









Task 2

1- a

2- f

3- e

4- b

5- g

6-c

Task 3

1- إِنَّهُۥ: Idghām with ghunnah (nūn with shaddah)

2- ءَايَةً: Idghām with ghunnah

3- كَأَنَّهُم: Idghām with ghunnah (nūn with shaddah) + بُنْيَٰنٌ: Iẓhār

4- لِسَانًا: Ikh'fā' – رِدْءًا: Idghām with ghunnah

5- وَإِنِّى: Idghām with ghunnah (nūn with shaddah) + لَأَظُنُّهُۥ: Idghām with ghunnah (nūn with shaddah)

6- مِن: Ikh'fā' + ضَرًّا: Idghām with ghunnah

7- أَن: Ikh'fā' + أَيْمَنُ: Iqlāb

8- إِنَّمَا: Idghām with ghunnah (nūn with shaddah)

Chapter Nine

Task 1

1- False (ghunnah in terms of tajweed is extending the nasal sound for two ḥarakāt)

2- False (Iqlāb cannot be applied on Mīm Sākinah)

3- True

4- True

5- False (the ghunnah of Mīm Sākinah is two counts regardless of where it is in the sentence)

6- True

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Task 2

1- a

2- b

3- b

4- a

5- b

6- c

7- a + b

Challenge questions

There are 5 Mīms following one another.

Chapter Ten

Task 1

1- True

2- False on the five letters قطب جد

3- False (There are two degrees depending on where they come in the word, though there is small differences between them)

4- False (it is a state between vowel and sukūn)

5- False (Not applying Qalqalah is a subtle mistake that does not change the meaning of the word)

Task 2

1- First case: تَدْعُونَآ

Second case: مُرِيبٍ (only in case of stopping at that word)

2- The case of مُرِيبٍ can be dropped in case you kept on reading.

Task 3

1- No Qalqalah can be found in this āyah- Qalqalah letters found in this āyah do not have sukūn on them.

2- different answers.

Task 4

1- No Qalqalah

2- Qalqalah يَبْعَثُ

3- Qalqalah in حَرَجٌ - ٱلْأَعْرَجِ - حَرَجٌ (ONLY if you stopped at these words)

4- Qalqalah ٱلْحَقِّ (ONLY in case of stopping)

5- Qalqalah بِٱلْحَجِّ - فَجٍّ - عَمِيقٍ (ONLY in case of stopping)

Chapter Eleven

Task 1

1- a

2- b+c

3- e

4- e

5- c + b

6- c + b

7- d + a

8- e

Task 2

1- identical assimilation

2- identical assimilation

3- no assimilation – The first letter و has kasrah under it so it cannot be assimilated.

4- identical assimilation

5- Similar letter assimilation

6- Similar letter assimilation

7- Similar letter assimilation

8- Nūn Sākinah assimilation + Similar letter assimilation

Task 3

1- The letter has no diacritics on it

2- The letter after it has shaddah

Chapter Twelve

Task 1

Correct answer: e

The reason is that the letter rā is originally a heavy letter unlike lām and alif which are originally light letters. There are certain cases where the rā becomes light.

Task 2

Light ا	ٱلْعَٰلَمِينَ	Heavy ر	زُرْتُمُ
Heavy خ	خَٰلِدِينَ	Heavy ر	قِرْطَاسٍ
Heavy ل	سُبْحَٰنَكَ ٱللَّهُمَّ	Heavy ر	مِرْصَادًا
Light ل	ٱلْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ	Heavy/light ر	فِرْقٍ
Light ر	رِزْقًا	Heavy ا	ٱلْقُرْءَانُ

Task 3

Correct answer: a

Chapter Thirteen

Task 1

1- False – if it came in the same word, it does not have to be avoided

2- True

3- True

Task 2

1- قَالُ لَّهُمَّ

2- أَفِ ٱللَّهِ

3- No case of Itiqā' As-Sākinain

4- وَعَمِلُ صَّٰلِحَٰتِ

5- فِ لْحُطَمَةِ

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Index

The numbers in the index stand for page numbers

Actions of recitation	32
Al-alifāt as-Sabʿ	20
Alif	164, 167
Alif khinjariyyah	16
Alif maqsūrah	167
Āyah	8
Case ending	37
Conditional silent alif	20
Connected madd	53
Connecting madd	58
Degrees of heaviness	137
Degrees of qalqalah	117
Disassociating letters	142
Disconnected madd	53
Discontinuing recitation	37
Disjointed letters	156
Ending recitation	37
Gap between lips	95, 97, 106
Ghunnah	88, 104
Hamzat al-Qatʿ	66, 164
Hamzat al-Waṣl	67
Heavy alif	138
Heavy letters	136
Huruf muqaṭṭaʿah	156
Hybrid letters	138
Identical letters assimilation	125, 127
Idghām	91, 106, 124
Idghām with ghunnah	91
Idghām without ghunnah	93
Ikhfā'	96, 105
Iltiqā as-Sakinain	148
Iltiqā as-Sakinain (same word)	148
Iltiqā' as-Sakinain (Two words)	149
Imālah	170
Interconnected stop	12
Iqlāb	92
Ishmām	169
Iẓhār	89, 108
Lām of Allāh	80, 141
Laḥn jali	3
Laḥn	3
Laḥn khafi	4
Lām of definite article	76
Lām Qamaryyah	77, 124
Lām Sākinah	76
Lām Shamsyyah	77, 124
Licence to stop	24
Light alif	138
Līn letter	44, 60
Madd	44
Madd before hamzah	53
Madd before sukūn	56
Madd lāzim	56, 157
Madd length	46
Madd letter	44
Madd munfasil	53
Madd muttasil	53
Madd symbol	52
Madd tabīʿī	46, 156
Major connecting madd	58
Major Qalqalah	117
Mandatory stop	11
Medium qalqalah	117
Mīm Sākinah	104
Minor connected madd	58
Minor Qalqalah	117
Moon lām	77, 124
Muṣ-ḥaf	5
Names of Qur'ān	5
Natural madd	46, 156
Necessary madd	56
Nūn quṭni	150
Nūn sākinah	88, 124
Origin of the Honored word	80
Original sukūn	116
Partial assimilation	130
Pausing recitation	33
Permissible stop	14
Qalqalah	114
Qalqalah mechanism	115
Qilā	14
Qur'ān	5
Recitation	7
Resuming recitation	34
Rukūʿ	25
Rules of alif	138
Rules of lām	141
Rules of Rā	139
Saktah	15
Secondary madd	52

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Shape of mouth	137
Shapes of hamzah	66, 164
Silā	13
Silent letters	19
Similar letters assimilation	125, 127
Starting recitation	32
Stop & continue	33
Stop & repeat	34
Stopping recitation	33
Stopping symbols	11
Strong qalqalah	117
Sujūd	22
Sukūn mechanism	115
Sun lām	77, 124
Sunnah stop	11
Sūrah	8
Symbol of yā'	17
Tā' marbūṭah	165
Tafkhīm	136
Tajweed	2
Tartīl	8
Tas-hīl	171
Tashkīl of hamzat al-Waṣl	68
Tashkīl of verbs	69
Temporary madd	57
Temporary sukūn	116
The Seven Alifs	20
Two consecuative sukun	148
Uthmāni Codex	6
Uthmāni symbols	16
Verse	8
Vowel mechanism	115
Weak qalqalah	117
إِبغِ حَجَّكَ وَ خَف عَقِيمَه	77
حَيٌّ طَهُرَ	156
خُصَّ ضَغطٍ قِظ	136
قُطب جَدّ	114
نَقَصَ عَسَلُكُم	156, 157
يَرمَلُون	91
يَنمُو	91

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